

Barapullah Phase III to be completed by June 30: Minister

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi's long-delayed Barapullah Phase III corridor is expected to be completed by June 30, Public Works Department Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said on Tuesday after inspecting the project site and reviewing the progress of construction work with senior officials.

The minister said the remaining work is moving at a fast pace, and the corridor will soon be ready for inauguration. The project, which remained stalled for nearly a decade because of technical, environmental, and procedural hurdles, has now entered its final stage.

Once operational, the corridor is expected to provide major relief from traffic congestion in several parts of East



and Central Delhi. The project will improve connectivity between Sarai Kale Khan, Mayur Vihar, NH-24, DND Flyway, and Ring Road.

During the inspection, Parvesh Sahib Singh said the government has been closely monitoring the project to ensure there are no further delays. "Barapullah Phase III is not just another flyover project. It is an important

mobility corridor that will improve traffic movement across Delhi," the minister said. He added that every technical and administrative issue linked to the project was monitored carefully to speed up the remaining work.

The project is also expected to become a major landmark in urban infrastructure development because it includes a dedicated cycle

track. Officials said this would be the first flyover corridor in India designed with a separate cycling lane.

Apart from improving vehicle movement, the corridor will also include pedestrian-friendly infrastructure and modern urban features aimed at promoting sustainable transport. One of the major engineering features of the project is the bridge structure constructed over the Yamuna floodplain. According to officials, special care was taken to ensure that the natural flow of the river remains unaffected.

The bridge has been designed with pillar spans extending up to 125 metres in certain sections. Officials said this reduces obstruction within the active river zone and minimises environmental impact.

DMRC starts work on major elevated corridor plan in south Delhi

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) has initiated feasibility studies and prepared a detailed project report (DPR) for a network of elevated corridors, underpasses and road redesigns connecting Saket, Sangam Vihar, Khanpur, Pul Prahladpur and Badarpur.

The proposed project aims to improve connectivity between Sangam Vihar, Saket, Khanpur, Maa Anandmayee Marg, Pul Prahladpur and Badarpur — stretches that witness heavy congestion daily due to dense residential clusters, roadside parking and increasing vehicular pressure, according to an official.

This could improve daily commutes on South Delhi's heavily congested Mehrauli-



Badarpur (MB) Road in the coming years.

The DPR and feasibility exercise for the proposed traffic overhaul — comprising elevated roads, underpasses, subways and redesigned stretches is expected to be completed within four months and consultancy work for preparing the DPR has been estimated at around ₹1.47 crore, while

the larger six-lane elevated corridor and underpass project is planned at an estimated cost of ₹1.471 crore.

He said the project is being planned as an integrated corridor alongside existing and proposed Delhi Metro infrastructure to minimise land use and improve traffic movement on one of south Delhi's busiest arterial roads.

The proposal includes a

nearly 5-km elevated corridor from Sangam Vihar to Maa Anandmayee Marg, along with another 1.1-km elevated stretch from Pul Prahladpur towards Badarpur.

An additional 1.9-km section between Maa Anandmayee Marg and Pul Prahladpur will be redesigned under the Unified Traffic and Transportation Infrastructure (Planning and Engineering) Centre (UTTIPEC) compliant street planning norms, according to the official.

The alignment is expected to connect major junctions and densely populated areas along MB Road, including Saket G-Block, Ambedkar Nagar, Khanpur and Pul Prahladpur, while also integrating with existing flyovers and Metro corridors in the area, he said.

Thieves break into DRDO scientist's home, steal ₹50 lakh

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Thieves broke into the residence of a senior Defence Research and Development Organisation scientist inside the Scientist Hostel at the DRDO Timarpur complex in North Delhi and made off with gold ornaments, silver articles, expensive watches, cash, and foreign currency worth between ₹45 lakh and ₹50 lakh.

The complex is guarded by 24 security personnel and equipped with multiple CCTV cameras, yet the culprits entered, committed the theft, and escaped without being caught. The victim, Seema Gautam, a senior scientist posted in Delhi, had been away on leave since May 15,



having travelled to Chandigarh to meet her husband, who is posted as Joint Director with DRDO in Chandigarh, and their five-year-old daughter.

The theft came to light on May 23 when a neighbour noticed the door of Gautam's flat standing open and alerted her. Gautam filed a complaint at the Timarpur police station the same night.

Local police, along with the Crime Branch and forensic teams, inspected the

premises immediately and began collecting evidence.

According to the FIR, the burglars broke open an iron cupboard inside the flat to access jewellery and other valuables. The stolen items include approximately ₹15,000 in cash, foreign currency amounting to 20 pounds and 50 dirhams, and an extensive list of jewellery and watches.

Specific items mentioned in the FIR are a necklace set, six bangles, seven chains, five rings, four sets of earrings, a nose pin, a silver anklet, 20 grams of silver coins, children's jewellery, two Daniel Klein watches, and a Titan watch. The total value of the stolen items is estimated by police at between ₹45 lakh and ₹50 lakh.

Government raises ration card income limit to ₹2.5 lakh

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Delhi Cabinet has approved a major expansion of ration card eligibility under the Public Distribution System, increasing the annual income limit from ₹1.2 lakh to ₹2.5 lakh. The decision is expected to bring lakhs of additional low-income families under the subsidised ration scheme.

The announcement was made on Tuesday by Food and Supplies Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa, who said the move was aimed at strengthening food security and ensuring welfare benefits reach more deserving households in the capital.

The Delhi Government has also announced plans to introduce a Central Bank Digital Currency based ration distribution system to

improve transparency and reduce leakages in the public distribution network.

Speaking about the Cabinet decision, Sirsa said the earlier income ceiling had become unrealistic in the present economic conditions.

"Even an annual income of ₹1 lakh is below the minimum wage level for a family today. Keeping this in mind, the government has increased the income eligibility limit to ₹2.5 lakh so that more families can receive subsidised ration benefits," the minister said.

Officials said the revision follows a recent announcement by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta regarding the expansion of welfare coverage under the Public Distribution System. The income limit had earlier been raised from ₹1 lakh to ₹1.2 lakh before the latest increase to ₹2.5 lakh.

The Government believes



the revised ceiling will allow a larger section of economically weaker families to qualify for ration cards and receive support through subsidised foodgrain distribution. Alongside the expansion of eligibility, the Delhi Government is also preparing to roll out a digital ration delivery mechanism based on CBDC, or Central Bank Digital Currency.

Under the proposed system, subsidy amounts

linked to ration entitlements will be transferred directly into the digital wallets of beneficiaries instead of relying only on physical foodgrain distribution.

Beneficiaries will then be able to use the digital currency to purchase ration from authorised fair price shops after Aadhaar-based verification through electronic point-of-sale systems.

Officials said all transactions under the new model

will be digitally recorded, making the process more transparent and accountable. The minister said the CBDC-enabled system would reduce mismanagement and improve the efficiency of subsidy delivery.

"The aim is to provide greater transparency, flexibility, and dignity to beneficiaries while reducing leakages in the system," Sirsa said.

According to officials, the digital model will gradually be integrated into ration shops and connected with banking systems. Private banks may also be linked to the system at a later stage.

The Government said the proposed mechanism would offer several advantages, including real-time tracking of subsidy transactions, improved audit systems, and easier monitoring of benefit distribution.

Govt to redevelop five city roads into model corridor

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Delhi Government has planned to take up redevelopment work on five city roads, which will be transformed into 'model corridors' free of dust, with greenery and pedestrian-friendly.

The five stretches proposed for development includes Minto Road-ITO-Karkardooma, Minto Road-Aruna Asaf Ali Marg-Jawahar Lal Nehru Marg-Delhi Gate, Netaji Subhash Marg-Shanti Van-Mahatma Gandhi Marg (along Yamuna)-ITO-IT Estate Metro Station, Dhaura Kuan-Jail Road/Cariappa Marg-Tilka Nagar Crossing, and Uttam Nagar-Tilak Nagar-Rajouri Garden on Najafgarh Road.

A review meeting was headed by Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu, along with road-owning agencies and the School of Planning and Architecture (SPA), working on the decongestion plan.



The LG, who chaired a meeting to review the progress made so far on Tuesday by way of coordination between SPA and the respective road-owning agencies, emphasised that the transformation being undertaken should aim at making these extremely traffic-heavy stretches totally free of road dust and resultant ambient air pollution, as was being outlined by the CAQM.

He stressed that the exercise should succeed in bringing the people of the city close to these stretches of roads so as to instil ownership of these public assets in

them. This in turn will ensure safety and security as well as proper maintenance, apart from providing much-needed open recreational spaces, the LG said.

Components of this corridor redevelopment proposal include foolproof stormwater drainage that ensures that no flooding takes place, which in turn will lead to silt not being left behind.

Ultimately, with flooding getting controlled, while commuting and traffic will be smoother during rains, the absence of silt would ensure that there is no dust pollution and development of a scientific green central verge, with grass carpeting and piped watering facility, that will again terminate silt spilling out when tankers are used for watering. This, apart from achieving dust control, will also result in ending traffic congestion caused by the movement of slow-moving watering tankers.

Additionally, development of integrated pedestrian pathways with cycle tracks interspersed with public utilities and resting shelters, movable vendor spaces integrated with cultural/informal craft bazaars for the nighttime economy, quality street lighting, short-duration parking, security surveillance for the safety of women and children, etc.

The LG also directed SPA to come up with designs that ensure that the pavements are paved in a manner where the material is adequately porous to facilitate water seepage and yet be strong enough to require minimal maintenance.

Govt deploys rapid response teams ahead of Bakrid

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Delhi Government has deployed rapid response teams across all 13 districts of the capital to monitor animal transportation, sale, and welfare measures ahead of Bakrid, Development Minister Kapil Mishra said on Tuesday.

The teams, formed under the Animal Husbandry Unit, carried out inspections in several parts of North-West, North-East, North, Central, South-West, and West Delhi. Officials also conducted awareness drives regarding government guidelines linked to animal sacrifice during the festival.

According to the government, the teams have been directed to ensure strict compliance with animal welfare laws and take immediate action in case of violations. Development Minister Kapil Mishra said the Delhi Government has issued clear instructions that no illegal sacrifice will be allowed



Rapid Response Teams have been formed in all districts to monitor activities and ensure compliance with all animal welfare rules and government advisories

— KAPIL MISHRA, DEVELOPMENT MINISTER

during Bakrid. He said the sacrifice of cows, calves, camels, and other prohibited animals remains completely banned. "Rapid Response Teams have been formed in all districts to monitor activities and ensure compliance with all animal welfare rules and government advisories," Mishra said.

The minister added that the district-level teams are functioning under the supervision of district in-charges and deputy directors. Their responsibilities include inspecting the transportation of animals, monitoring sale and purchase activities, checking animal management practices, and responding to complaints.

During the inspection drives, officials visited animal markets and public areas to spread awareness among traders, livestock owners, and transporters regarding legal provisions and restrictions in force during the festival period.

Authorities appealed to residents to cooperate with the teams and follow all government guidelines related to animal transportation, sacrifice, and disposal practices. Officials said strict action would be taken if any violation is reported.

The minister further stated that special care must be taken during the transportation of animals to ensure there is no cruelty or mistreatment. The sale of meat at unlicensed locations has also been banned.

Officials said the government has instructed local teams to maintain close coordination with police and civic authorities during the festival period to ensure effective monitoring and enforcement.



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IN FOCUS



A farmer covering growing mangoes with protective bags to shield them from heat, insects and harsh sunlight at an orchard in Nadia district

PTI

Emergency evacuation conducted on IndiGo flight at Bengaluru airport

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi

A major mishap was averted at Kempegowda International Airport Bengaluru after passengers onboard an IndiGo flight were evacuated following reports of smoke inside the aircraft during taxiing on Tuesday.

According to the airline, IndiGo flight 6E 6017 was scheduled to operate from Bengaluru to Chennai on 26 May 2026. The aircraft was taxiing toward the runway for departure when smoke was noticed inside the plane. Acting swiftly in the interest of passenger safety, the crew initiated an emergency evacuation procedure and informed all relevant airport and safety authorities. The airline confirmed



that all passengers and crew members were evacuated safely and no injuries were reported during the incident.

Travelers were escorted back to the terminal, where IndiGo staff provided assis-

tance and ensured their well-being. In an official statement, the airline said, “On 26 May 2026, while IndiGo flight 6E 6017 from Bengaluru to Chennai was taxiing out to runway for departure, smoke was

noticed in the aircraft. In the interest of safety, an immediate evacuation was carried out and all the relevant authorities were informed.”

The airline further stated that an alternate aircraft had been arranged to operate the flight and that refreshments were being served to passengers to ease the delay caused by the incident. Airport authorities and technical teams are expected to inspect the aircraft to determine the source of the smoke.

While the exact cause has not yet been disclosed, the timely response by the crew helped prevent any injuries or escalation of the situation. IndiGo reiterated that the safety and security of its passengers and crew remain its highest priority.

Bus overturns in Unnao, six dead

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ Unnao

Six people, including a police sub-inspector, were killed and 21 others seriously injured when a double-decker AC bus overturned on the Lucknow-Agra Expressway in Uttar Pradesh's Unnao district, police said.

The accident took place at 5.15 am near Nibha Kheda village when the bus, travelling from Delhi to Bihar, went out of control and overturned, they said. Police said around 50 passengers were believed to be travelling in the bus.

According to preliminary investigation, the driver allegedly lost control of the vehicle after dozing off at the wheel. The deceased have been



identified as police sub-inspector Ravi Charan Ram (around 50), Suresh Kumar Jaiswal (40) of Gorakhpur, Videshi Gupta (45), Vijay Kumar (24) of Basti and two unidentified persons, police said.

In a post on X, UP Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath termed the loss of lives in the accident as “extremely saddening and heart-rending”. He expressed condolences to the bereaved families and prayed for peace to the departed souls and speedy recovery of the injured.

Brother among accused in Jharkhand murder case, Delhi cops nab suspect

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

Delhi Police arrested a Jharkhand murder suspect who was in hiding in the national Capital, nearly 10 days after a man from Sahibganj district went missing and was later discovered dead in a forested area.

Investigators linked the killing to a drunken argument involving the victim's own

brother and friends.

According to the Crime Branch, the suspect, identified as Sukhdev Murmu alias Tala, was caught near Hanuman Mandir in Yamuna Bazar on May 24 following a tip-off that he had fled to Delhi after the murder of Champai Marandi in Jharkhand's Borio region.

Police said the case was initially registered as a kidnapping at Borio police station in Sahibganj district after

Champai Marandi went missing under suspicious circumstances on May 21.

Investigators discovered that the deceased was last seen drinking with Sukhdev, the victim's brother, Babuji Marandi, and another associate, Mangal Tudu. During their meeting on May 12, an argument allegedly broke out among the group, after which the suspect strangled Champai Marandi to death.

Use only as much electricity as required: CM Yogi

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

■ Lucknow

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on Tuesday appealed to people to use electricity according to their needs amid the ongoing energy crisis, saying the state government was working to ensure uninterrupted power supply despite rising demand and supply constraints.

Addressing a programme organised to mark three years of the Lucknow



Municipal Corporation board, the chief minister said global energy supply chains had been affected while the electricity demand had increased sharply due to

rising temperatures. He said Uttar Pradesh's peak power demand, which stood at 15,000-16,000 megawatts (MW) before 2017, had now risen to 32,000-33,000 MW.

At the same time, electricity generation in the state increased from around 6,000 MW to 13,000 MW, while renewable energy generation reached nearly 10,000 MW, he said. Adityanath said the state's total requirement was now between 33,000 and 35,000 MW and urged

citizens not to be misled by rumours regarding the power situation. “Consume only as much electricity as required,” he said, adding that many people had started using electric heaters for cooking due to the LPG supply crisis. The chief minister also said “the double-engine government” would continue working to address all challenges related to power supply and infrastructure. At the event held at Indira Gandhi Pratishthan,

Adityanath laid the foundation stones for 342 projects worth ₹413 crore related to the Lucknow Municipal Corporation.

According to an official statement, the CM also released a booklet titled ‘Swachh, Sundar, Samarth Lucknow’. The CM thanked people for electing BJP mayors in all 17 municipal corporations of the state, saying that this had enabled urban local bodies to implement development effectively.

Shah launches demography panel

Key features include The Assam Accord (1985), which set March 24, 1971, as the cut-off for identifying and deporting illegal immigrants. The National Register of Citizens (NRC) exercise in Assam (updated in 2019), which excluded nearly 1.9 million people, sparked nationwide debate.

The Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA) 2019 aimed to fast-track citizenship for persecuted non-Muslim minorities from neighbouring countries. The Government has consistently framed unchecked infiltration as a threat to sovereignty, national security, law and order, social harmony, and the cultural identity of indigenous and tribal communities, particularly in the Northeast, where demographic changes could erode local majorities and strain resources.

PM Modi, in his 2025 Red Fort speech, explicitly called infiltration a “well thought-out conspiracy” to alter India's demography and announced this high-powered “demographic mission” as a targeted response.

This multidisciplinary team is designed for rigorous, data-backed recommendations rather than political rhetoric. The committee's focus is explicitly on illegal immigration-driven “unnatural” shifts, distinguished from organic demographic trends like fertility rates or internal migration.

It will map changes at granular levels (religious and social communities) across states, with emphasis on border regions and tribal areas. Potential outputs include policy recommendations on border management, deportation mechanisms, and legal reforms strategies to protect indigenous identities and address social tensions.

HC refuses to halt Gymkhana eviction

“As on date, there is nothing on record to substantiate that action under the Public Premises (Eviction of Unauthorised Occupants) Act has been taken and in case the need so arises, the plaintiffs can avail remedies in accordance with law. The locus standi of the parties to file the plaint would be determined at an appropriate stage. Taking into account that summons in the main suits have been accepted by the defendants and in view of the statement made by the learned Solicitor General of India, no further interim directions are called for. At the cost of repetition, the statement is to the effect that eviction, if undertaken would be in accordance with law and after issuance of prior notice. It is reiterated that the apprehension of the plaintiffs that the governing body of the Club may hand over the possession is contrary to the stand taken by the governing body of the Club,” reads the order.

The HC was hearing pleas filed by longtime club member Vijay Khurana and the Delhi Gymkhana Staff Welfare Association challenging the Government's decision to terminate of the club's perpetual lease and proposed re-entry into the premises. Senior advocate Abhishek Singhvi, appeared for Gymkhana members while Senior advocate Kapil Sibal, appeared for the club's last elected body.

Govt wins Race Club battle

The Delhi Race Club was served an eviction notice by the Land & Development Office (L&DO) of the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs on March 12, days after the club completed 100 years. The notice directed the club to vacate the property it has occupied since 1926 within 15 days.

The Union Government has claimed that the 1926 lease deed with the club for the 84.48-acre plot at Lok Kalyan Marg was not perpetual in nature and it expired on December 31, 1994. Since

no further extension was granted, the club's continued occupation of the land was unauthorised and liable to be examined under the Public Premises (Eviction of Unauthorised Occupants) Act, the Government argued.

The move is being seen as part of a wider Government push to reclaim nearly 100 acres of prime land located close to the Prime Minister's residence at Lok Kalyan Marg and adjacent to the Air Force Station area in central Delhi.

For decades, the venue - known for its distinctive horseshoe-shaped track — has been a prominent destination for horse racing enthusiasts. Over the years, races held at the club have attracted dignitaries and celebrities. Originally known as the Delhi Gymkhana Race Club, the institution was established to promote horse racing and the breeding of Indian horses, and governed by elected members and Government nominees. Much of the land and surroundings were developed by British architects in the 1920s. It was formally incorporated in 1940-41 as the Delhi Race Club (1940) Limited, the name under which it continues to operate today.

CNG prices hiked by ₹2 per kg

The CNG price hike in the NCR came just as State-owned Oil Marketing Companies started passing on the impact of higher international oil prices to consumers. Petrol price has been increased by ₹7.35 per litre and diesel by ₹7.53 in four instalments. Rates of petrol and diesel, as well as CNG, vary from state to state depending on the incidence of VAT.

According to IGL, CNG in Noida and Ghaziabad will now cost ₹91.70 per kg, while in Gurugram, it will be priced at ₹88.12 per kg. PNG continues to be priced at ₹49.59 per standard cubic metre in Delhi. In Mumbai, PNG costs ₹51.50 per standard cubic metre.

Principal appointment row rekindles...

The broader question that the Elias appointment is now forcing into focus is the extent of autonomy that minority institutions enjoy in matters of governance and appointments. DU's position is that UGC regulations apply uniformly regardless of minority status. The college's position, backed by the 2008 High Court ruling, is that its minority status exempts it from specific ordinance provisions that govern selection committee composition. In practical terms, the situation may mirror the Thampus episode, where the appointee took charge, salary was initially managed through the college's private funds, and formal university recognition came significantly later. What is unambiguous is that Elias is expected at the college on June 1. What follows after that will depend on how far both sides are willing to push the dispute.

CBI probe in Twisha case intensifies

The CBI formally took over the investigation on Monday night and re-registered the FIR earlier lodged by Madhya Pradesh Police against Twisha's husband, lawyer Samarth Singh, and retired district judge Giribala Singh. The agency has booked both accused under charges related to dowry death and alleged destruction of evidence.

Twisha Sharma was found dead at her matrimonial home in Bhopal on May 12. While her husband's family claimed she committed suicide, her family has consistently alleged murder and accused the in-laws of attempting to influence the investigation.

The agency's intervention came amid mounting controversy over alleged procedural lapses

in the initial investigation and concerns raised by Twisha's family regarding possible tampering with evidence. According to sources, the CBI is examining allegations that police were informed several hours after Twisha's death, allowing crucial time during which evidence may have been disturbed.

Separate applications seeking preservation of Call Detail Records (CDR) and CCTV footage have also been filed before a Bhopal district court. Twisha's family has sought protection of mobile records, while Giribala Singh's side has moved an application for preservation of CCTV footage from the residence. The court is scheduled to hear both applications.

Regarding the gymnastics belt reportedly used in the hanging, Bhopal Police officials said the belt had been seized and later sent to the forensic laboratory in Sagar for examination. Following a request from AIIMS Delhi, the police have also written to the forensic laboratory and cyber cell regarding the evidence.

During questioning by the Special Investigation Team (SIT) before the case was handed over to the CBI, Samarth Singh allegedly claimed that Twisha had been under stress following a miscarriage. Investigators are also probing allegations of an additional dowry demand of Rs 20 lakh, which reportedly formed the basis for the dowry death case registered by the CBI.

The agency is expected to continue questioning the accused and examining forensic, digital, and medical evidence over the coming days as the high-profile case remains under intense public and legal scrutiny.

Change of guard likely in Karnataka

Shivakumar's demand that he be elevated to the chief minister's post in accordance with a “promise” which his supporters claim was made to him during State assembly elections in 2023. However, well-placed sources in the party said that Siddaramiah were conveyed the feelings of the High Command— Sonia Gandhi, Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi — that it's time to pave way for DK Shivakumar to lead the Government and in lieu of this, the senior Karnataka leader would be given a Rajya Sabha berth and simultaneously, his son would be accommodated in the State Government.

Siddaramiah has, however, shown his reluctance in stepping down as CM, rather conveying that he would desire to hear the same, nothing less than the Gandhis. Sources said that he categorically mentioned that he will neither take it from AICC General Secretary (Organisation) KC Venugopal nor AICC In-charge of Karnataka Randeep Singh Surjewala to step down as CM.

“Hence, the matter is unresolved as both Siddaramiah is known for his rigidity as he understands the backing of the majority of caste equations in the State, while DK has his own manoeuvring expertise in the State's political set-up,” explained a top party leader.

Congress termed as “mere speculation” the talk about any leadership change and asserted that the day-long discussions between the central and state top brass were solely focused on the upcoming elections to the Rajya Sabha and the state's Legislative Council.

Though Kharge had convened a meeting to decide party candidates for the two elections, the point of interest remained the protracted leadership tussle between Siddaramaiah and D K Shivakumar.

Congress's central leadership held deliberations for several hours with Siddaramaiah and Shivakumar, who is also the state party chief, at the Indira Bhawan party headquarters.

“Today, the entire discussion was only concentrated on the upcoming Rajya Sabha elections and (Legislative) Council elections of Karnataka. Whatever speculation you people are doing, that is only speculation, no reality at all. Today we dis-

cussed the Rajya Sabha seats and the Council seats of Karnataka,” Venugopal told the media after the meeting. He was flanked by Siddaramaiah and Shivakumar.

Karantaka, along with the other seats like Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan, goes for biennial elections next month. Of the four Rajya Sabha seats getting vacant in Karnataka, the Congress can win three seats and the BJP one. Kharge's Rajya Sabha seat is getting vacant in June, and he is likely to be re-elected from Karnataka.

Sources said the party may also field Shivakumar's brother D K Suresh as one of the Rajya Sabha candidates, as well as a woman or an OBC nominee. Suresh has been a former Rajya Sabha member from the state.

India-US sign rare earths pact

Critical minerals include lithium, cobalt, nickel, graphite and rare earth elements used in batteries, military hardware, renewable energy systems, electronics and advanced manufacturing. Rare earth metals are especially important because of their magnetic and conductive properties, making them essential for permanent magnets used in electric vehicles, wind turbines, smartphones and medical devices.

The US has increasingly sought to reduce reliance on Chinese supply chains amid rising geopolitical tensions and concerns over potential disruptions. The India-US agreement is being viewed as part of a broader strategic effort to create alternative supply networks among trusted partners.

According to statements released by India's Ministry of External Affairs and the US embassy, the framework aims to strengthen cooperation in exploration, extraction, refining and recycling of critical minerals. The US embassy said the partnership would help protect supply chains from “coercive market practices” and reduce vulnerabilities linked to “single-source monopolies”, in an apparent reference to China.

Although the two Governments have not publicly disclosed detailed commercial terms or investment figures, officials described the agreement as a long-term strategic partnership that could reshape global mineral supply chains.

India has been positioning itself as an emerging player in the rare earth sector. In 2023, the Indian Government identified 30 minerals as “critical”, including lithium, cobalt, graphite, nickel, titanium, tungsten and rare earth elements. Government estimates indicate India possesses around 13.15 million tonnes of monazite, a mineral rich in rare earth oxides.

To strengthen domestic production capabilities, India's 2026-27 budget introduced plans for “rare earth corridors” in Odisha, Kerala, Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu. These corridors are expected to support mining, refining, research and manufacturing of high-performance rare earth magnets used in clean energy technologies and electric vehicles.

Despite its mineral reserves, India currently produces only a limited range of critical minerals because of gaps in infrastructure, processing technology and large-scale exploration. The new agreement with the US is expected to help India attract investment and technological expertise to accelerate development of its rare earth industry.

The deal was signed alongside a broader Quad initiative involving India, the US, Japan and Australia to strengthen critical mineral supply chains across the Indo-Pacific region. Under the Quad framework, Governments and private companies are expected to mobilise up to \$20bn through loans, guarantees, subsidies and long-term purchase agreements to support mining, processing and recycling projects.

The Quad countries also agreed to cooperate on regulatory standards, licensing systems and recycling technologies to make supply chains

more resilient and less dependent on a handful of suppliers.

The United States has signed similar critical minerals agreements with several countries in recent months, including Argentina, Morocco, Peru, the Philippines, the United Arab Emirates, the United Kingdom and Uzbekistan. Washington has also backed major mining projects in Pakistan and South Africa as part of its global supply diversification strategy.

The India-US rare earth framework signals a deeper strategic partnership between the two countries that extends beyond defence and diplomacy into economic security and advanced technology cooperation. Analysts say the agreement could play an important role in reshaping the future global supply chain for clean energy technologies, semiconductors and artificial intelligence infrastructure while challenging China's overwhelming dominance in the rare earth sector.

West Bengal begins deportation drive

At Hakimpur in North 24 Parganas' Basirhat subdivision, over 100 alleged Bangladeshi immigrants gathered near the BSF checkpoint over the last two days, carrying trolleys, utensils and bundles—reminders of lives packed in haste and uncertainty. BSF personnel indicated that many arriving at Hakimpur were voluntarily approaching authorities seeking repatriation.

The new State Government's decision to launch district-level holding centres for suspected illegal immigrants appears to have triggered a “reverse exodus” through the international border, with scores of alleged Bangladeshi infiltrators gathering at the Hakimpur checkpoint in North 24 Parganas seeking to return home. The renewed rush comes days after Adhikari announced that West Bengal would aggressively implement a “detect, delete and deport” policy against infiltrators.

The State Government has set up holding centres in all districts to house apprehended foreigners and released foreign prisoners until deportation formalities are completed. Malda became the first district where such a facility became operational, housing nine suspected Bangladeshi nationals.

Panel summons CBSE chairperson

The CBSE recently faced criticism from students and parents over technical glitches, payment failures and access-related issues during the verification and re-evaluation process for class 12 results. It has also made the study of three languages, including at least two native Indian languages, compulsory for class 9 students beginning July 1.

Tamil Nadu has opposed the three-language formula, saying it places an unfair burden on non-Hindi-speaking states and undermines regional linguistic identity. The state has followed a two-language policy—Tamil and English.

According to the notice, the committee will hold another meeting on June 1. The agenda for the June 1 meeting includes discussion on the “use of pen-and-paper testing versus CBT” and “views pertaining to NEET and NTA”, the notice said.

The committee earlier met on May 21 to review the implementation of reforms in the National Testing Agency (NTA), the NEET-UG 2026 paper leak case and the implementation of the Radhakrishnan Committee's recommendations. The National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (NEET)-Undergraduate (UG) for admissions in medical courses was held on May 3. It was cancelled by the NTA on May 12 amid allegations of paper “leak”. The matter is being probed by the Central Bureau of Investigation and a retest is scheduled for June 21.

PM Modi completes 12 years in office; BJP hails tenure

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi completed 12 years in office on Tuesday with the ruling BJP and its top leaders hailing his tenure as India's return to self-confidence and cultural renaissance.

On May 26, 2014, Modi took charge as India's Prime Minister with a landslide victory. He got re-elected with a bigger mandate in 2019 and again became the prime minister for the 3rd time in 2024.

BJP president Nitin Nabin hailed Modi's leadership, saying the era that began on May 26, 2014, represents not merely a change of Government, but a historic moment marking the nation's regained self-confidence and cultural renaissance. In a post on X in Hindi, Nabin said the Modi Government, guided by the mantra of 'Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas, Sabka Vishwas, aur Sabka Prayas' and the principle of 'Antyodaya', has



ensured that policies moved beyond paperwork to become instruments of transformation for every citizen.

He described the prime minister's tenure as "12 glorious years of 'Sankalp Se Siddhi' (attainment through resolve).

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh said May 26, 2014, marked the beginning of a new chapter in India's civilisational and developmental journey. "The day Shri @narendramodi took oath as India's Prime Minister, India witnessed a decisive

shift in governance, vision, leadership, and national resolve," he said in a post on 'X'.

Singh said the vision of 'Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas, Sabka Vishwas' has not remained merely a slogan, but has been reflected in governance and policy at every level. He said today, India stands stronger, prouder and more self-confident than ever before.

"A 'Pradhan-Sevak', in the truest sense, Modi Ji has dedicated every moment of his life to the service of Maa

Bharati and her people. His tireless commitment, unwavering resolve and selfless devotion towards the nation continue to inspire millions. I pray to the Almighty for his good health, long life and continued service to the nation," he said.

Minister of Road Transport & Highways Nitin Gadkari said a defining moment that reshaped India's destiny-May 26, 2014 will always be remembered as the dawn of a new era under PM Modi.

He said in the years since, governance in India has undergone a fundamental transformation-marked by clarity of vision, decisive leadership, and an unwavering commitment to national progress.

From accelerating economic growth and expanding world-class infrastructure to advancing Aatmanirbhar Bharat and leading a digital revolution, the pace and scale of change have been remarkable, he said.

Assam facing demographic change for long time: Himanta

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Guwahati

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma on Tuesday said the State has been witnessing demographic change for a long time, and welcomed the Centre's announcement of a committee to study the phenomenon across the country.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Tuesday announced that the Centre has constituted a high-level committee under retired Supreme Court judge Justice Prakash Prabhakar Naolekar to assess demographic changes across India due to "illegal immigration and other unnatural causes".

Reacting to this, Sarma, in a post on X, said, "Illegal infiltration and unusual demographic change are not merely the concern of any single State but a serious issue linked to India's national security, cultural identity, and social balance."

The formation of the high-level committee to address this challenge is a "visionary and decisive step", he added.



"Under the proactive leadership of the honorable @AmitShah ji, this committee will study the unusual demographic changes occurring across the country and present concrete solutions. This will further strengthen national security and enable serious addressing of the concerns of border areas," Sarma said.

He said that Assam has been facing the challenge of demographic change for a long time.

"This initiative will prove extremely important for protecting our cultural heritage, tribal society, and the rights of indigenous people. We are confident that this committee will play a significant role in securing India's future," the CM said.

States Focus



MIZORAM GOVT TO INTRODUCE NEW LAND LAW: MINISTER

The Mizoram Government will introduce a comprehensive new land law aimed at overhauling the State's land administration system to meet the changing needs and administrative requirements, a minister said on Tuesday.

Speaking to reporters at a press conference here, State Land Revenue and Settlement Minister B Lalchhanzova said that "The Mizoram (Land Revenue) Bill, 2026" is currently being drafted to replace the existing Mizoram (Land Revenue) Act, 2013, which no longer adequately addresses evolving administrative and legal challenges.

"Since the existing law requires extensive revisions in view of changing times and administrative needs, a new legislation – The Mizoram Land Revenue Act, 2026 – is currently being prepared and is expected to be completed within this year," the minister said. (PTI)



POCSO: UNION MINISTER'S SON GETS 2 DAYS POLICE CUSTODY

A local court on Tuesday granted police two days' custody of Union Minister Bandi Sanjay Kumar's son, Bageerath, in a POCSO case registered against him. Police had sought three days' custody, but the court allowed two days', beginning May 27.

Bageerath was arrested on the night of May 16 in connection with the POCSO case and was subsequently remanded to judicial custody by a magistrate. He is currently lodged at Cherlapally Central Prison. Earlier, the Telangana High Court had refused to grant him interim protection from arrest. (PTI)

Nicobar project a bid to loot tribal resource, alleges Congress

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Terming the Modi Government "anti-tribal", the Congress on Tuesday alleged that the Great Nicobar project was aimed at "looting tribal resources" and the Centre was using the cover of national security to dispossess tribal communities of their land.

Adivasi Congress chairperson Vikrant Bhuria alleged that tribal people are being stripped of their water, forests and land everywhere, whether in Sijimali or Hasdeo.

Addressing a press conference, he claimed that the BJP Government at the Centre wants to loot tribal resources

in the name of the proposed Great Nicobar development project.

Bhuria alleged that the Government was using the cover of national security to dispossess tribal communities of their land and natural resources.

He alleged that the BJP Government intended to "bulldoze tribal forests" and facilitate the exploitation of mineral wealth by corporate groups.

Raising concerns over deforestation in Chhattisgarh's Hasdeo forests, Odisha's Sijimali region, the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) and the issue of delisting of tribal communities, Bhuria alleged



Adivasi Congress chairperson Vikrant Bhuria

that the BJP was systematically trying to weaken tribal identity, constitutional protection and land rights. Speaking about the Great Nicobar project, Bhuria claimed that the island currently has a

population of around 8,000 people, but the Government plans to settle nearly five lakh outsiders there under the proposed development initiative.

He alleged that nearly one

crore trees would be cut for the project and claimed that plans for large-scale townships and casinos were part of the proposal.

Bhuria expressed concern over the impact of the project on the Shompen tribe, describing it as one of the world's most vulnerable indigenous communities with a population of only around 200 people remaining.

He noted that Great Nicobar has been recognised as a UNESCO Biosphere Reserve and accused the Government of ignoring ecological sensitivities. The Congress leader also highlighted the island's seismic

vulnerability, noting that the region falls in an extremely sensitive earthquake zone.

Settling lakhs of people there, he said, would expose them to grave risks.

Bhuria further argued that the Andaman and Nicobar Islands act as a climatic shield for mainland India and play a key role in the monsoon system.

Massive deforestation in the region, he warned, could adversely affect rainfall patterns and contribute to drought conditions in the mainland.

On the issue of the UCC and tribal delisting, Bhuria described them as "a major attack on tribal rights"

Op Sheruwali: Troops target terrorist hideouts in J&K

MOHIT KANDHARI ■ Jammu

As the anti-terrorist operation Sheruwali entered its fourth day, joint teams of the Indian Army, Jammu and Kashmir Police's Special Operations Group, and paramilitary forces on Tuesday launched a fresh assault to smoke out foreign terrorists hiding in natural cave-like structures in the dense Dorimal-Gambhir Moghla forest belt of Rajouri.

Since the first contact on May 23, security forces have been relentlessly combing the thickly vegetated terrain in pursuit of the fleeing terrorists.

The Indian Army has also deployed helicopters to carry out aerial reconnaissance, besides relying on drone images and sniffer dogs to track down the footprints of terrorists on the run.

Joint teams of the Army, Jammu and Kashmir Police, and paramilitary forces have also expanded the scope of extensive searches in the



adjoining areas to prevent their escape.

According to ground reports, the security forces on Tuesday targeted suspected hideouts of the terrorists to neutralise them. Till late evening, there was no official confirmation about the outcome of the fire assault. The Indian Army had mobilised additional troops in the area to strengthen the cordon in the outer area further and prevent the terrorists from breaching the outer cordon.

According to local media

reports, heavy gunfire and explosions were reported from the Dorimal-Gambhir Moghla forest belt of Rajouri district, amid an ongoing operation in the area. Thick smoke was seen billowing out after the suspected hideouts were targeted inside the forest.

Security forces are also tracking blood stains believed to have been left behind by the fleeing terrorists after a hideout was destroyed during an assault carried out on Monday.

Meanwhile, the Director

General of Police, Nalin Prabhat, on Tuesday reviewed security arrangements for Eid-ul-Azha and Shri Amarnath Ji Yatra.

The meeting was attended by senior officers of the J-K Police, CRPF, ITBP, traffic police, railways and various security agencies, a police spokesman said.

"The DGP chaired a meeting at Police Control Room Kashmir to review security arrangements for the upcoming Eid-ul-Azha and Shri Amarnath Ji Yatra-2026 (SANJY-2026) at PCR Kashmir," the spokesman said.

Emphasising the importance of peaceful Eid celebrations, Prabhat directed the officers to ensure comprehensive crowd management arrangements at mosques and key congregation venues across the Valley.

The DGP stressed the need for strengthening security measures, safeguarding public movement and

deploying personnel at sensitive locations to prevent overcrowding.

He instructed field officers to enhance surveillance, carry out random inspections at vulnerable areas and intensify patrolling to effectively address any potential security concerns during the festive occasion.

During the meeting, the participating officers presented detailed briefings on the proposed security and logistical arrangements as well as preparedness measures for the smooth conduct of SANJY-2026.

Officers from the paramilitary and other security forces also shared their assessments and underscored the need for seamless coordination and synergy among all agencies involved.

The officers briefed the DGP regarding the administrative and logistical arrangements made for the incoming Central Armed Police Forces (CAPF) companies.

Pradhan holds meet to overhaul CBSE payment gateway

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan on Tuesday held detailed discussions with senior officials of four public sector banks on overhauling the Central Board of Secondary Education's payment gateway system.

The meeting was attended by representatives of State Bank of India, Bank of Baroda, Canara Bank and Indian Bank, an official statement said.

The development comes amid concerns over the recent payment and technical issues faced by students during the CBSE post-result and re-evaluation processes.

The minister stressed the need for a robust, reliable and student-friendly digital payment ecosystem, particularly for post-examination services such as re-evaluation, obtaining photocopies of answer sheets and other fee-based processes.

Three decades of precision: IAF's Surya Kiran aerobatic team turns 30

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Indian Air Force's elite Surya Kiran Aerobatic Team (SKAT) – an ensemble of iconic red-and-white Hawk Mk-132 jets, known for performing jaw-dropping manoeuvres in the skies, completed 30 years on Tuesday.

From its debut in 1996, it has been part of over 800 breathtaking displays across India and abroad, including marquee events in the country – Aero India and Air Force Day.

"Celebrating 30 years of precision, passion and pride, The Surya Kiran Aerobatic Team of the Indian Air Force commemorates its 30th Anniversary on 26 May, 2026, at Air Force Station Bidar, Karnataka," the IAF posted on X.

"From its debut in 1996 to over 800 breathtaking displays across India and abroad, SKAT continues to inspire with unmatched professionalism, precision flying and teamwork. Living by their motto 'Sadaiva Sarvottam' meaning 'Always the Best', the team symbolises the spirit



and excellence of the Indian Air Force," it said.

The IAF also shared a video clip marking the anniversary, in which the force described SKAT as "the ambassadors of the Indian Air Force".

On May 11, the team performed in the skies of Somnath in Gujarat, to mark the Somnath Amrut Mahotsav, which commemorated 75 years since the inauguration of the rebuilt temple by the then President Rajendra Prasad.

During his visit to Somnath, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, accompa-

nied by Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel and his deputy Harsh Sanghavi, watched the airshow performed by the aerobatic team over the temple.

Using indigenous smoke pods, the jets of the team released saffron, white and green smoke to create the image of the tricolour in the sky. Last year, on April 23, the elite aerobatic team had painted the Patna skies red as its Hawk Mk-132 jets performed jaw-dropping manoeuvres over the banks of the Ganga River to mark 'Shaurya Diwas'.

The day celebrates the valour displayed by freedom fighter from Bihar, Veer Kunwar Singh, during the First War of Independence in 1857.

This was the first time the Surya Kiran Aerobatic Team performed in the Capital of Bihar. Prior to the Patna show, the SKAT also performed at the Namkum Army Ground in Ranchi on April 19-20 in 2025.

The Surya Kiran team has represented the Indian Air Force in countries such as China, Sri Lanka, Myanmar, Thailand, Singapore and the United Arab Emirates, officials said.

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Communist Party of India (CPI) on Tuesday launched a scathing attack on the Narendra Modi-led Central Government over the recent spike in fuel prices, describing the move as "anti-people" and "corporate-driven." Condemning the relentless inflation, the party's National Secretariat called for nationwide



protests and democratic resistance against the Government's economic policies. In a press statement issued by CPI Office

CPI attacks Union Govt over fuel price hike

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

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protests and democratic resistance against the Government's economic policies. In a press statement issued by CPI Office

Secretary Roykutty, the party highlighted that petrol and diesel prices have been hiked four times in just ten days, translating to an increase of nearly ₹8 per litre. With petrol prices crossing ₹102 per litre in Delhi and ₹111 in Mumbai, the CPI warned that these hikes would trigger a catastrophic cascading effect across the economy, driving up transportation costs, food prices, agricultural expenses, and public transport fares.

SBI STATE BANK OF INDIA E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE				
BRANCH OFFICE: HOME LOAN CENTRE, A1/24, JANAKPURI, NEW DELHI-110058				
NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION SALE ON 29.06.2026 FOR MOVABLE PROPERTY				
E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Movable Assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described movable property hypothecated /charged to the Secured Creditor, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorized Officer State Bank of India, the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "As is Where is", "As is What is" and "Whatever there is" on 29.06.2026, for recovery of bank due to the secured creditor as under:-				
Interested bidder may deposit Pre-Bid EMD with BAANKNET before the close of e-Auction. Credit of Pre-Bid EMD shall be given to the bidder only after receipt of payment in BAANKNET's Bank Account and up-dation of such information in the e-auction website. This may take some time as per banking process and hence bidders, in their own interest, are advised to submit the pre-Bid EMD amount well in advance to avoid any last minute problem.				
Date / Time of E-Auction on 29.06.2026 for 8 Hours from 10:00 AM to 06:00 PM with unlimited extn. of 10 minute each.				
S. No.	Name of the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s)	Outstanding Dues for Recovery of which Property /ies is/are being Sold	Vehicle Description	Name of the Authorised Officer
1.	MS. RITU AWASTHI W/O SH. MANOJ KUMAR BAJOAI Car Loan A/c No. 43824859321 B-86, Dasrathpuri, Palam, New Delhi-110045	Rs.44,06,886.00 as on 12.09.2025 plus future Interest and other Charges etc. thereon	Make & Model: FORTUNER LEGENDER (AT) Vehicle No.: DL10CZ2895 Engine No.: 1GDA853542 Chassis No.: MBJAA3GS900627542-0125 Mfg. Date: 01/ 2025 Fuel: Diesel	Mr. Kapil Muni Yadav (Chief Manager) HLC, A1/24, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058, Tel-011-79681631 Mr. Amit Mobile: 9717077712
			₹ 34,20,000.00 ₹ 3,42,000.00 ₹ 10,000.00 *GST as applicable	
Last Date of EMD Deposit on or before 29.06.2026 upto 9:00 A.M. Account/ Wallet in which EMD to be remitted : Bidder's own wallet Registered with BAANKNET on its e-auction site: https://baanknet.com/eauction-psb/eproc-listing by means of NEFT/RTGS. EMD of Reserve Price to be transferred by bidders by means of challan generated on his/her/their bidder account maintained with BAANKNET on its e-auction site: https://baanknet.com/eauction-psb/eproc-listing by means of NEFT from his /her/their bank. For any assistance, please call BAANKNET HELPDESHK: +91 8291220220, support.BAANKNET@psballiance.com and/or Authorized Officer.				
TERMS AND CONDITIONS OF THE E-AUCTION ARE AS UNDER:				
(1) E-Auction is being held on "As is where is", "as is what is basis" and "whatever there is basis" and will be conducted "On Line". The auction will be conducted through the Bank's approved service provider BAANKNET at their web portal: https://baanknet.com/eauction-psb/eproc-listing				
(2) Bank shall reserve the right to cancel/postpone the auction.				
(3) The Vehicle are available for inspection during banking hours on 26.06.2026 from 11:00 AM to 17:00 Hrs. at Shriram Mall, Faridabad. Contact Person - Mr. Hemant Kumar Mobile: 9034545090, M/s. Suraj Legal Solutions Pvt. Ltd. (Resolution Agent).				
(4) Successful bidder to pay GST as applicable on the successful bid amount, viz sale value.				
(5) To the best of knowledge and information of the Authorized Officer there is no encumbrance on the property/ies. However the intending bidder should make their own independent inquiries regarding the encumbrances, title of the property/ies put on auction and claims/ligths/dues/affecting the property prior to submitting their bid. The e-Auction Advertisement does not constitute and will not be deemed to constitute any commitment or any representation of the Bank. The property is being sold with all the existing and future encumbrances whether known or unknown to the bank. The Authorized Officer shall not be responsible in any way for any third party claims/rights/ dues.				
(6) The Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) of the successful bidder shall be retained towards part sale consideration and the EMD of the unsuccessful bidders shall be refunded. The Earnest Money Deposit shall not bear any Interest. The successful bidder shall have to deposit 25% of the sale price, immediately on acceptance of bid price by the Authorized Officer and the balance of the sale price on or before 15 th day of the sale. Default in deposit of amount by the successful bidder would entail forfeiture of the whole money already deposited and property shall be put to the e-auction and the defaulting bidder shall have no claim/right in respect of property / amount.				
(7) For detailed terms and conditions of the sale please refer to the link at the Bank's Service Provider's web portal: https://baanknet.com/eauction-psb/eproc-listing & e-auction website: https://BAANKNET.com				
Place: New Delhi Date: 26.05.2026 Authorized Officer, State Bank of India, Home Loan Centre, Janakpuri, New Delhi				



States Focus



FORMER RJD LEADER RITU JAISWAL JOINS BJP IN BIHAR

Former RJD leader Ritu Jaiswal joined the ruling BJP in Bihar on Tuesday. She joined the BJP in the presence of the party's State president Sanjay Saraogi and Revenue and Land Reforms Minister Dilip Kumar Jaiswal in Patna. Jaiswal had contested the 2024 Lok Sabha polls on the RJD ticket from Sheohar constituency. She fought last year's State elections as an Independent. "I have decided to join the BJP because I am inspired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi's goal of accommodating people from all streams, irrespective of their ideology. Usually, people see things through a particular lens, but I feel proud that PM Modi has no such lens," she said. She hailed Centre's initiatives such as Ayushman Bharat, Kisan Samridhhi Yojana and PM Awaas Yojna as non-discriminatory.

(PTI)



TN CM VIJAY TO MAKE MAIDEN OFFICIAL VISIT TO DELHI

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay is scheduled to make his maiden official visit to Delhi on May 27 and meet with Prime Minister Narendra Modi and union ministers, an official said here on Tuesday. Senior officials from Tamil Nadu are already camping in the national Capital. During his meetings, the CM is expected to seek additional funds for the State and also request the Centre to approve major projects for Tamil Nadu. After winning the April 23 Assembly election, Vijay, who heads the fledgling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam, assumed office as Chief Minister on May 10.

(PTI)

Assam UCC is backdoor Hindu law imposition on Muslims: Owaisi

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Hyderabad

AIMIM president Asaduddin Owaisi has criticised the UCC Bill introduced in the Assam Assembly, calling it a "backdoor imposition" of Hindu law on Muslims.

He claimed that Hindu principles are being imposed on succession, inheritance and divorce.

The Hyderabad MP in a post on 'X' said: "Only Hindu culture is being protected, while Muslims have to comply with these so-called uniform rules".

The Assam Government on Monday tabled a Bill on the Uniform Civil Code — 'The Uniform Civil Code, Assam, 2026 Bill', seeking to ban



polygamy and make registration of live-in relationships compulsory. The Bill, however, said that it will not be applicable to any of the Scheduled Tribes residing in Assam.

"The Bill aims to consolidate and simplify laws governing marriage, divorce, succession, and live-in relationships," Assam Chief Minister

MHA rejects Karnataka hate speech bill, says laws exist

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Bengaluru

The Union Home Ministry has felt that Karnataka's bill to curb "hate speech" may not be necessary at this stage, and the existing legal framework is adequate to address the issue.

The Ministry conveyed its "Centre-State Division's" stance on the Karnataka Hate Speech and Hate Crimes (Prevention) Bill, 2025, to the Karnataka Government.

The Karnataka Government sent the Bill to the Ministry of Home Affairs in February for President Draupadi Murmu's assent, after Governor Thaaawarchand Gehlot refused to clear it.

The Bill was passed by both houses of the State legislature during the winter session in Belagavi that concluded on December 19 last year, despite strong opposi-



tion from the BJP and JD(S). "The matter has been examined in the CS Division. In this regard, it is stated that the issues sought to be addressed are already substantially covered under the existing provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 and other prevailing laws. Enactment of a separate state legislation may result in duplication and lack of uniformity," the

Ministry of Home Affairs (CS Division) said in its office memorandum dated May 12.

"In view of the above, it is felt that the proposed legislation may not be necessary at this stage, and the existing legal framework is adequate to address the concerns," it added.

Following the centre's letter, the Karnataka Department of Parliamentary

Affairs and Legislation has written to the state Home Department on May 20 to furnish the comments or clarification on the said Bill, to enable it to communicate an early reply to the Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India.

The Bill proposes a jail term of one year, extendable up to seven years, with a fine of ₹50,000 for a hate crime. For repeated offences, the maximum imprisonment will be seven years, with a fine of ₹1 lakh.

The BJP had termed the Bill as "draconian", "direct attack on free speech" and "dangerous tool for political vendetta".

Governor Thaaawarchand Gehlot in January sent back the Bill without giving his assent, stating that it would have "a severe chilling effect on constitutionally-protected democratic discourse."

CPI (Maoist) Central Committee member surrenders

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Hyderabad

The outlawed CPI (Maoist) suffered another setback on Tuesday with Central Committee member Pasunuri Narahari alias Vishwanath surrendering before Telangana DGP CV Anand.

Narahari (64) is also the secretary of the CPI (Maoist)'s Bihar-Jharkhand Special Area Committee (BJSAC).

His wife, Medara Danamma alias Latha, a State Committee member, also surrendered before the police.

"Today's surrender of two top-ranking leaders, Narahari and Danamma, marks a significant setback to the CPI (Maoist). With this, the organisation's last surviving Eastern Regional Bureau (ERB) appears to be on the verge of collapse," Anand told reporters.

The DGP said the Maoist couple had been suffering from dengue and malaria.



Telangana DGP CV Anand handing over Demand Drafts to surrendered Narahari couple

The Telangana police had been providing them medical treatment at a hospital here for the past 10 days.

Narahari was born in Somidi village in Kazipet mandal of Hanumakonda district in Telangana.

He was drawn to the ideology of the Radical Students Union (RSU) while pursuing his graduation in Warangal and went underground in 1982 after joining the People's War Group.

He worked in various capacities in

the CPI (Maoist), including as a member of the Bihar-Jharkhand Special Area Committee in 2006.

He was inducted into the Central Committee in 2017.

Narahari acquired skills in making firearms, mortars and rocket-propelled grenades, besides setting up booby traps and planting claymore mines and landmines. He also trained cadres in weapons production, repair and maintenance, Anand said.

Danamma, a native of Andhra Pradesh, married Narahari in 1988 and worked with him in Jharkhand.

Danamma was arrested in Nagpur in 2004 and imprisoned for seven years. After securing bail, she again went underground and became a member of the Bihar-Jharkhand Special Area Committee in 2018.

Anand said 822 cadres had surrendered before the Telangana Police since 2024.

DMK, AIADMK slam CM Vijay's crop loan waiver plan

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Chennai

The Opposition parties in Tamil Nadu on Tuesday criticised the Vijay-led Government's crop loan waiver plan, claiming that it doesn't entirely fulfil the TVK party's poll promises, especially the complete waiver of cooperative sector farm loans given to those having up to 5 acres of land.

DMK leader Udhayanidhi Stalin said that during the elections, the TVK promised to completely waive the crop loans of farmers having up to 5 acres of land. But now they have announced to waive off the crop loans of up to ₹50,000. "This is an injustice to farmers. A breach of trust," he alleged.

AIADMK Chief Edappadi K Palaniswami lashed out at the TVK Government, terming



AIADMK Chief Edappadi K Palaniswami

the crop loan waiver announcement as "scientific deception" to distract the people from "horse-trading" politics allegedly being indulged.

He accused the newly formed Government under C Joseph Vijay of "idling away time" to divert the people of Tamil Nadu from "watching the most disgusting politics of

horse-trading." Reacting to the chief minister's announcement on Monday, regarding waiver of cooperative bank crop loans up to ₹50,000 for marginal farmers across the state, the AIADMK general secretary said the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam had promised total waiver of crop loans for all farmers having up to 5

acres of land. Shifting the criteria from land size to a monetary cap of ₹50,000 was a "major betrayal of trust", the former chief minister claimed.

Comparing the sum provided during the previous AIADMK regime under him, Palaniswami said the then AIADMK Government had completely waived ₹12,110 crore in farm loans, which provided relief to over 16.43 lakh farmers without any complex restrictions.

"The dummy horse Government, which is functioning as described in the Tamil proverb 'my husband has also gone to the concert,' (doing something to show off without real interest in it), has staged a scientific fraud in the name of waiving agricultural crop loans. This was announced to divert the people of Tamil Nadu from the most disgusting politics of

horse-trading, which is being done frivolously without attending to the work that a Government should be doing," Palaniswami said in the statement on Tuesday.

The TVK promised to completely waive the cooperative bank crop loans taken by farmers having up to 5 acres of land, but now they are using money as the criterion instead of land.

"If you see that in 2021 we waived off loans worth ₹12,110 crore and now they are saying that they will waive off loans worth only ₹2,044 crore in 2026, the farmers will understand that it's a big deception. As a farmer, I say history shows that no Government that cheated farmers ever lasted. A farmer is like a god who feeds. Don't cheat them," Palaniswami said in a statement.

Reject Karnataka's DPR for Mekedatu project, Vijay tells PM Modi



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Chennai

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Tuesday expressed surprise over the Ministry of *Jal Shakti* and the CWC entertaining Karnataka's proposal for the Mekedatu project, without considering Tamil Nadu's plea.

He also requested Prime Minister Narendra Modi to instruct officials concerned to reject the DPR prepared by Karnataka, as it contravened the final award of the Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal and also the Supreme Court judgment.

Also, PM Modi should advise the Karnataka Government not to take up any new project without getting the concurrence of co-basin States and not to violate the apex court judgment, he said.

In a letter addressed to the Prime Minister, Vijay said the announcement for the 'Bhoomi Puja' of the Mekedatu reservoir across the Cauvery river and utterances of Karnataka Deputy Chief Minister DK Shivakumar have caused a lot of concern among the lakhs of farmers of Tamil Nadu, who depend on the Cauvery river for their livelihood.

Bihar Govt asks employees to visit tourist spots every 3 months

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Patna

The Bihar Government has directed all State Government employees to undertake mandatory visits to tourist destinations across the State every three months with their families and submit reports on how to promote them, officials said on Tuesday.

In a letter, dated May 20, issued to departmental heads, divisional commissioners, DMs and SPs, Additional Chief Secretary



Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary

(General Administration) B Rajender said Government employees must travel with

their families for two days and two nights to tourist, eco-tourism or rural tourism

destinations in districts other than their home districts.

The travel is to be scheduled over Fridays and Saturdays, during which employees are expected to visit and stay overnight at least three tourist spots, according to the directive.

"Bihar is rich in cultural diversity, environmental heritage and historically significant tourist destinations. There are several sites that can emerge as major national and international tourism hubs. Encouraging

officials to visit such places and submit suggestions will aid tourism development and improve related infrastructure," the letter stated.

Officials have been specifically instructed not to conduct review meetings or official inspections during these trips.

After the visit, employees will have to submit a report containing photographs, details of the tourist destinations visited and their experiences to the district magistrate or respective departments, the letter said.

Onion farmers protest low procurement prices in Nashik

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Nashik

Several onion farmers, led by Opposition Maha Vikas Aghadi (MVA) leaders, on Tuesday staged a protest against the Government's procurement prices, blocking the busy Mumbai-Agra National Highway in Nashik district.

Police intervened and detained protesters after the 'Kanda Utpadak Shetkari Kranti Mahamorchha' dis-

rupted traffic in Chandwad town, where some agitators reportedly attempted to deflate the tyres of vehicles stranded on the highway.

Opposition leader, including NCP(SP) MLA Rohit Pawar, Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Ambadas Danve, and Congress state president Harshwardhan Sapkal, led the rally on a bullock cart before being detained by the police.

During the agitation, Pawar said, "The



Government has declared a ₹1,580 per quintal price for onions. Farmers are unhappy with this. They should get a

price of ₹24 per kg for onions. The Government is afraid of our agitation. The CM, deputy CM and other ministers will

BSF boosted people's morale during Operation Sindoor, says Amit Shah

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Bikaner

Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Tuesday praised the BSF for its role during Operation Sindoor, saying the force not only guarded the border firmly but also boosted the morale of the people living in frontier districts.

Addressing BSF personnel at the Sanchu border outpost in Rajasthan's Bikaner district, Shah paid tribute to more than 2,000 BSF personnel who have laid down their lives since the force

expanded, and facilities at all border posts would be strengthened by 2030.

Referring to the 1965 India-Pakistan war, Shah said the Sanchu outpost holds historical significance as security personnel had successfully defended it despite heavy attacks by Pakistani forces.

He also highlighted steps being taken to improve border infrastructure in Rajasthan, including road construction, new fencing designs and water pipeline connectivity to 180 border posts.

Shah said the Centre had



was raised.

He said BSF jawans have served in extreme conditions ranging from deserts and dense forests to snow-covered regions with extreme climate conditions, displaying courage, discipline and the spirit of supreme sacrifice.

"The sacrifice of these personnel is a debt on 140 crore Indians, and the nation is proud of them," Shah said.

The home minister also inaugurated women's barracks at the outpost and said women personnel had proved their capabilities by performing beyond expectations in border security duties.

He said infrastructure for women personnel was being

expanded the BSF's jurisdiction to 50 kilometres from the International Border, keeping in mind the emerging security challenges such as infiltration, smuggling and drone-based narcotics trafficking.

Shah said border security could no longer rely solely on traditional methods and called for close coordination among state police forces and State administrations to strengthen the security grid.

He also stressed the need to remain vigilant against demographic changes caused by cross-border infiltration and said agencies should closely monitor activities in villages located near the border.

SIX DIE OF SUSPECTED ASPHYXIATION INSIDE SEPTIC TANK IN ODISHA

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Bhubaneswar/Bhawanipatna

At least six people died of suspected asphyxiation inside an under-construction septic tank in Odisha's Kalahandi district on Tuesday, police said.

One person also fell ill in the incident that took place at Gauda Kar lakhunta village in Madanpur-Rampur police station area, an officer said.

All of them were taken to the Madanpur Rampur Community Health Centre (CHC), where doctors declared six people dead, he said.

The deceased are three masons, a labourer, the builder of the septic tank and his son, police said.

The incident happened when they opened a portion of the septic tank for construction-related work, and the builder accidentally fell inside, the officer said.

To rescue him, the others entered the tank, he said.

Assam adopts resolution for speedy women’s quota rollout

TONY DAS ■ Guwahati

The Assam Assembly on Tuesday adopted a resolution calling for the immediate implementation of one-third reservation for women in Parliament and State legislatures, after completing the delimitation process.

The resolution, which was moved by Women and Child Welfare Minister Ajanta Neog on Monday, was passed by a voice vote.

Placing the resolution for adoption, Neog said that reservation of seats for women in the highest policy-making bodies was the need of the hour. “I have been an MLA since 2001, and I cannot say the number of women colleagues has increased. Therefore, it is the need of the hour to grant this reservation,” she said.

“We are in the 21st century, and women cannot be held back anymore,” Neog, the



State’s longest-serving women legislator and only woman finance minister, added.

Discussion on the resolution witnessed the participation of MLAs from both treasury and Opposition benches, including Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma.

He said Assam has a legacy of honouring women’s power, from Goddess Kamakhya to Ahom princess Joymoti to freedom fighter Kanaklata, and they have played a pivotal

role in the State’s social discourse. He also cited the contribution of the 40 lakh women associated with self-help groups to the economy. Sarma also accused the Congress of being “anti-women” after the party staged a walkout from the Assembly during the discussion, and said it could have passed the reservation bill when it was in power, but did not do so.

The Opposition parties, while supporting reservation

for women, were against linking the delimitation exercise with it. Congress’s Jakir Hussain Sikdar said that it was during the party’s regime that 50 per cent women’s reservation was given in panchayats, and the country’s first woman president, prime minister, chief minister and such high positions were appointed by the grand old party.

“We are not against the reservation. In fact, we support it. But it should not be linked with delimitation,” Sikdar added. Rajior Dal’s Akhil Gogoi said that his party wants 50 per cent reservation of seats for women.

“Why wait for delimitation? Rajior Dal wants the reservation to be implemented immediately,” he said.

Trinamool Congress MLA Sherman Ali Ahmed, while supporting quota for women, also emphasised the need for literacy among women.

61.5% turnout in Punjab civic polls amid political clashes

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Chandigarh

Clashes involving supporters of Congress, AAP, BJP and SAD and allegations of booth capturing were reported at several places in Punjab during the civic elections that saw 61.5 per cent polling on Tuesday.

The final percentage of voter turnout may change after data is compiled by returning officers.

The local body elections are being seen as crucial for all major political parties of the State as these are taking place ahead of the Assembly polls next year.

Congress candidate from Ward number 4 in Raikot, Jagdev Singh Jagga, was injured in an attack with sharp-edged weapons by a group of people. He was admitted to a private hospital in Ludhiana, officials said.

Punjab Congress chief Amrinder Singh Raja Warring and Congress MLA Partap Singh Bajwa condemned the



incident and slammed the AAP Government over the law and order situation in the State.

“The brutal attack on Congress candidate Jagdev Singh Jagga in Raikot exposes the complete collapse of law and order under the Bhagwant Mann Government. Gangsters and political goons are roaming freely while the Government is busy with ads and reels. If election candidates are unsafe, imagine the condition of common people in Punjab,” Warring said on X.

In Barnala, the husband of the BJP candidate from Ward

number 15, Deepinder Kaur, was assaulted by a group of people following heated exchanges after he made allegations of bogus voting. His turban was removed, and he suffered injuries, after which he was taken to a hospital.

A clash erupted between the supporters of the Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD) and the ruling Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) in Gidderabha in Muktsar district during polling in Ward numbers 18 and 19, officials said.

The SAD later lodged a complaint with the Punjab State Election Commission

against AAP MLA Hardeep Singh Dimpy Dhillon and others, accusing them of indulging in booth capturing, assault and intimidation during municipal elections and demanded an FIR be registered against them.

Tension prevailed in Samana in Patiala supporters of two rival political parties clashed and later pelted stones at cops during polling in Ward number 19.

The police resorted to cane charging to disperse the crowd, and polling was temporarily stalled, the officials said.

In Amritsar’s Majitha, supporters of SAD and AAP clashed, prompting police to intervene in the matter, they said.

SAD leader Bikram Singh Majithia attacked the Mann Government over the incident and alleged that during the council elections in Majitha, AAP workers, with the support of the Punjab Police, indulged in booth capturing, violence and intimidation.

Kerala launches Project Zero to crack down on corruption

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Thiruvananthapuram

Kerala Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala on Tuesday announced “Project Zero”, a comprehensive anti-corruption initiative aimed at eradicating corruption at all levels of administration in the State with public participation and strengthened vigilance measures.

Addressing reporters at the headquarters of the Vigilance and Anti-Corruption Bureau (VACB) here, the minister said the Government’s objective was to transform Kerala into a completely corruption-free State.

“Together, let’s build a corruption-free Kerala. We have zero tolerance towards corruption. We want to eradicate corruption at all levels. That is the motto of the



Kerala Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala

Government,” he said. Chennithala said the initiative would ensure that people receive services from Government offices without having to pay bribes.

“At present, in many offices, even certificates are issued only after paying bribes. That will be strictly curbed,” he said. The minister said systems would be put in place for the public to report incidents of corruption and

assured that the identity of informants would be kept confidential.

He said vigilance authorities would maintain strict surveillance over corrupt officials and leaders and warned that nobody involved in corruption would be spared.

Noting that cyber crimes and digital corruption were on the rise, Chennithala said strong measures would be taken to identify such centres and prevent technologically driven corrupt practices.

He said the objective of the initiative was not merely to act after corruption occurs, but to prevent it at the source itself, with the VACB functioning as a strong deterrent.

The minister also announced that the 1969 Vigilance Manual would be revised in accordance with present-day requirements.

Munambam land row: Kerala CM ensures ownership rights

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi
/Thiruvananthapuram

Kerala Chief Minister VD Satheesan on Tuesday assured protection and full ownership rights for Munambam residents, while alleging that the previous Left Government’s politically-appointed Waqf Board had complicated the land dispute. The issue could have otherwise been settled within 10 minutes, he said while addressing a press conference in New Delhi after meeting Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman.

Satheesan said the Government was examining legal steps to address the Waqf Board’s registration of the disputed land in the ‘UMEED’ portal.

He alleged that the disputed land was registered on the Centre’s UMEED



Prime Minister Narendra Modi during a meeting with Kerala Chief Minister VD Satheesan in New Delhi

portal against legal provisions and claimed the registration should have been carried out by the “mutawalli”, the caretaker or administrator of a waqf. Satheesan alleged that while ministers in the previous Left Government had assured Munambam residents they would not be evicted, the Waqf Board appointed during the same

regime adopted the stand that the land was waqf property. “So, they have cheated the people in Munambam,” he alleged.

The CM also claimed that the Congress-led UDF had effectively intervened when the BJP attempted to use the issue to create divisions between the two religious communities in the past. He said IUML State president

Sadiq Ali Shihab Thangal and senior leader PK Kunhalikutty had met the Varapuzha Archbishop and assured him that nobody would be evicted from the area.

“However, the Left Government adopted a position that aided the Sangh Parivar agenda,” Satheesan alleged. He said the issue could have been resolved “within ten minutes”, but the Waqf Board complicated it.

“But that is okay. We still have the mechanism to handle it. There are legal aspects involved, and there will be precise intervention. There will be no circumstance in which the poor people there will be thrown out,” he said.

His remarks came amid a political row in Kerala after the Kerala State Waqf Board registered the disputed land in Munambam, where most

residents belong to the Christian community, on the UMEED portal.

Meanwhile, Kerala State Waqf Board Chairman KS Hamza clarified that the registration on the portal was only part of a technical and legal procedure and would not determine the final ownership of the property. Hamza said the registration was a mandatory legal process that had to be completed before May 17 and maintained that any final decision regarding ownership would be subject to Government and court rulings. The Munambam issue pertains to a long-running dispute over around 404 acres of land in Ernakulam district over ownership and classification of the property, which was reportedly managed by Farook College and later claimed by the Waqf Board as waqf land.

4th AIADMK MLA quits, party strength drops to 43 in Tamil Nadu

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Chennai

A fourth MLA from the AIADMK’s rebel camp on Tuesday tendered his resignation from the Tamil Nadu Assembly, bringing down the strength of the Opposition party in the 234-member House to 43 from 47.

Ambasamudram MLA Esakki Subaya met Speaker JCD Prabhakar and submitted his resignation letter, shortly after AIADMK chief Edappadi K Palaniswami-led faction called on the latter with a plea not to accept the resignation of three AIADMK legislators who had stepped down on May 25.

Prabhakar later said the resignation of Subaya was accepted. The Palaniswami camp cited alleged legal and procedural lapses behind the three MLAs’ move on Monday and wanted the Speaker not to accept their resignation.

The party claimed the three MLAs joined the ruling TVK even before their resignation was notified.

Subaya is the fourth MLA from the rebel CV Shanmugam-SP Velumani

camp to have quit as MLA and said he did so in the interest of his constituency people.

He parried questions on whether he would join the TVK but said, “It is not a sin to meet Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay.”

“I will meet him if I get the chance,” Subaya told reporters. Soon after his resignation, he was seen with senior TVK leader and State minister N Anand.

Amid the developments in the AIADMK camp, Congress MP S Jothimani expressed concern over “horse-trading” in Tamil Nadu, and said her party should not support such moves by the ruling TVK since the national party itself has been at the receiving end of such manoeuvres.

TVK leader and Revenue Minister KA Sengottaiyan denied the horse-trading allegations. On his part, Speaker Prabhakar insisted he was performing his duties within the legal framework and the powers vested in him. He said he accepts the resignation letters if they are in the prescribed format. “Other than that, I have nothing to say.”



Earlier, senior AIADMK leaders, ‘whip’ Agri SS Krishnamurthy and Rajiya Sabha MP IS Inbadurai, met Speaker Prabhakar and submitted a representation urging him not to accept the resignations of Maragatham Kumaravel, P Sathyabama and S Jayakumar that have since been notified in a Government gazette.

Krishnamurthy said that since their earlier plea seeking the disqualification of the 25 MLAs for defying party diktat to vote against the Government in its May 13 floor test was pending before the Speaker, he cannot accept the resignation of the concerned legislators.

“We had sought action

against 25 AIADMK MLAs under the anti-defection law for defying Palaniswami’s diktat on confidence vote. The Speaker had said it was under his consideration. Fearing action under the anti-defection law, the three tendered their resignation. When the earlier plea is pending, the Speaker accepting their resignations contravenes the rules. We filed a plea (on Tuesday) on behalf of the AIADMK, saying he should not accept their resignation,” he told reporters.

Within five minutes of tendering their resignation, a “laminated TVK membership card was given” to the three persons in the Secretariat itself, he claimed.

“People are asking if this is the Secretariat or TVK headquarters. If this Government encourages such resignations, there will be heightened horse-trading; the Government should come forward to stop this,” he said.

Chief Minister Vijay had promised clean governance. “To establish his rule through the back door, this Government is doing horse-trading at the speed of a horse,” the senior leader alleged.

Inbadurai, also the AIADMK Advocates’ Wing Secretary, said that their side had urged action against the rebel MLAs under the anti-defection law, and that plea is pending. “The legal issue is he (Speaker) can’t accept their resignation,” under such circumstances.

“They met a TVK minister before their resignation was notified...and they enacted a drama of formally joining (late in the evening). Still, the notification of their resignation (in a Government gazette) had not come. So we have sought that their resignation should not be accepted,” he said.

Red Fort blast: Accused used fake ID for explosives, says NIA

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The National Investigation Agency’s (NIA) probe has found that the key accused in the Delhi Red Fort car blast case used a fake identity to procure off-the-shelf chemicals for manufacturing explosives, official sources said on Tuesday.

The prime accused, Dr Umer Un Nabi, who was driving the explosives-laden car and died in the blast, researched offline and online resources related to various chemicals and had set up a makeshift lab in his flat at Al Falah University in Faridabad for carrying out experiments with the objective of manufacturing a prototype explosive material, the sources said. During the course of the investigation, the NIA sleuths got hold of a delivery challan dated September 25, 2024, from a small Mumbai trader that cracked open the supply chain for procur-



ing materials needed for making explosives.

The challan was issued by the trader against a customised mixed metal oxide (MMO)-coated titanium anode, a specialised electrode used in an electrolysis process that the accused needed for their chemistry experiments, the sources said, quoting a chargesheet filed by the NIA recently.

According to the revelations made by the accused during their interrogation by the NIA, the electrolysis process was carried out at Umer’s flat for making chlorates and perchlorates from a common salt solution—a technique that he learnt in his research.

Gujarat woman shot dead in US store; robbery suspected

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Ahmedabad

A woman from Gujarat living in the United States was shot dead in an alleged robbery-related incident, according to preliminary reports from local authorities.

The victim, identified as Meghna Patel, originally belonged to Jatral village in Vijapur taluka of Mehsana district. She had reportedly settled in the United States with her family several years ago.

Reports indicate that the incident occurred inside a store where an unidentified man allegedly opened fire on her, causing fatal injuries. CCTV footage from the scene has surfaced, showing a suspect entering the premises dressed in a tracksuit, jacket, gloves, face covering and cap.

Investigators said the suspect briefly interacted with Meghna Patel before firing at her.

Arunachal Governor urges law students to be driven by justice

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Itanagar

Arunachal Pradesh Governor KT Parnaik has urged law students to view law as a public trust dedicated to justice for common citizens and imbibe passion in their chosen profession.

Addressing students and faculty members during a visit to Jarbom Gamlin Government Law College, Jote, on Tuesday, the governor highlighted development such as digital courts, e-filing, virtual hearings, and a focus on constitutional rights and urged students to combine legal knowledge with empathy, ethics, and



Arunachal Pradesh Governor KT Parnaik

social sensitivity, an official report from Lok Bhavan said.

The legal sector has become essential and highly relevant in today’s time, he said. Parnaik emphasised that the college should focus on strengthening legal research, community legal outreach, technology-driven

legal education, and ethical leadership to contribute towards the vision of Viksit Bharat. He highlighted the importance of studies on constitutional governance, cyber laws, indigenous rights, environmental protection, border issues, and tribal rights, while encouraging active Legal Aid Cells and AI-assisted legal research.

Stressing discipline, integrity, and constitutional values, Parnaik expressed confidence that the institution would emerge as a beacon of justice, knowledge, and human dignity, inspiring future generations through quality legal education and public service.

Urban heat island effect driving up power demand: Study

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Urban Heat Island (UHI) effect, which raises city temperatures between two and 10 degrees Celsius above surrounding areas, is one of the key reasons behind the rise in power demand in the country, according to a new analysis.

It states that while industrial power demand has remained relatively stable in several regions, residential demand has surged sharply because cities are becoming significantly hotter, especially during evenings and nights.

This forces households to rely more heavily on cooling appliances such as air-conditioners (ACs), coolers, and fans, according to the analysis, released by Climate Trends, a Delhi-based climate research organisation, on Tuesday.

“Rising temperatures alone do not



explain why cities and towns are becoming increasingly unlivable during summers. Rapid urbanisation is significantly amplifying heat stress, turning Indian cities into giant heat traps and driving a sharp rise in electricity demand,” said the analysis.

The power demand in India has been skyrocketing in recent days. It touched 257.3 GW on May 18, 260.4 GW on May 19, 265 GW on May 20, and ultimately reached a record 270.8 GW on May 21. The main factor driving UHI is rapid urbanisation, which leads to more concrete, roads, bricks and

metal in the area. These objects absorb heat during the day and radiate it at night when the Sun is absent.

The situation is exacerbated by the use of ACs, which emit hot air outside and contribute significantly to UHI.

“Demand from cooling — both commercial and residential — which starts from noon and does not come down till the early morning hours, has put grid planning in a knot,” said the analysis.

To mitigate UHI, there is a need to promote light-colored roofing materials with high reflectivity, which can significantly reduce heat absorption, potentially lowering roof temperatures by up to 25 degrees Celsius compared to darker materials.

Creating a network of natural and semi-natural elements, such as wetlands, parks, green roofs and water bodies, can also help regulate city temperatures, said the analysis.

Editor's
TAKE

Pope Leo's AI warning is a wake-up call

Pope Leo XIV has issued his starkest warning yet: artificial intelligence, left unchecked in the hands of a powerful few, risks fragmenting humanity itself

There is something arresting about the world's most influential spiritual leader reaching back four millennia to a myth about bricks and hubris to make sense of the age of algorithms. Yet Pope Leo XIV's instinct is sound. In his encyclical Magnifica Humanitas, released on May 25, he warned humanity of a pivotal choice – “either to construct a new Tower of Babel or to build the city in which God and humanity dwell together.” Strip away the theology, and what remains is a political and moral argument of urgent force. The Pope's central warning is that control of artificial intelligence must not remain in the hands “of a few”. This is not a niche religious concern; it is a diagnosis of a crisis already unfolding. A small constellation of American technology corporations – armed with vast capital, proprietary data, and lobbying influence – is effectively writing the rules of the most transformative technology in human history. Pope Leo criticised the immense power concentrated within a handful of private technology companies, and rightly so.

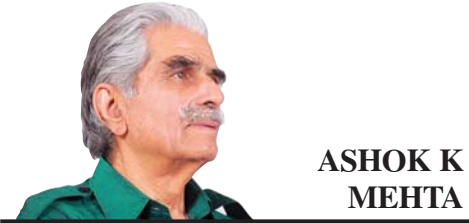
When the architects of a technology are also its regulators, something has gone badly wrong. The Babel metaphor is apt precisely because it captures the paradox of AI power. In the biblical narrative, Babel represents human hubris – humanity's attempt to reach the heavens through its own power, resulting ultimately in confusion and fragmentation. Today's AI ecosystem mirrors this dynamic: a dominant technological culture, monolithic in values and driven by profit, building upwards at immense speed while treating the human cost as an afterthought. Pope Leo warned that a singular, totalising technological culture risks becoming a new form of oppression.

For the United States, the encyclical arrives at an awkward moment. Last week, President Donald Trump delayed an executive order that would have created a voluntary process for testing AI models – retreating even from the mildest gesture towards oversight. Washington remains consumed by geopolitical competition: deploy AI faster than China, weaponise it sooner, regulate it later – if at all. Pope Leo's emphasis on human dignity and his opposition to autonomous weapons place him in direct contrast with techno-optimists who argue that the United States must militarise AI advances before its rivals do. The Pope does not oppose technological progress. Rather, he argues that calling for prudence – even for a slower pace in adopting AI – is not resistance to progress but an act of responsible care for humanity. That is a distinction that Washington, Brussels, and Beijing alike seem increasingly reluctant to acknowledge. Pope Leo has called for robust legal frameworks, independent oversight, informed users, and political systems that do not abdicate responsibility. These are not radical demands. They are the essential architecture of democratic accountability applied to a domain where accountability has been dangerously absent.

The Tower of Babel collapsed not because its builders lacked intelligence, but because they lacked wisdom. That is Pope Leo's warning. Whether world governments will heed it remains uncertain. History, as he reminds us, has seen this before – and it did not end well.

India's strategic autonomy needs a reset

New Delhi's carefully cultivated policy of balancing competing powers is facing unprecedented stress. The larger question is whether India's current approach is adequate for a world where power politics is being rewritten in real time



ASHOK K MEHTA

Speaking on the anniversary of the nuclear tests conducted in defiance of US warnings, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said: “India will not bow down to anyone”, heralding the successful execution of its strategic autonomy, though its evolution has seen more downs than ups, especially during the turbulent Trumpian era. Punitive tariffs and multiple sanctions, along with waivers on Russian military platforms, Russian oil, and Chabahar Port, have taken their toll. During the recent BRICS Foreign Ministers' meeting in New Delhi, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar criticised unilateral non-UN sanctions on India, calling them “unjustified”, even as Delhi awaited waivers on Chabahar and Russian oil. Later at the conference, he noted the unnecessary resort to unilateral coercive measures and sanctions, which are inconsistent with international law and the UN Charter. These measures “disproportionately affect developing countries”. This is perhaps the first time such comments have been made – akin to closing the stable door after the horse has bolted.

Strategic autonomy has been bruised notwithstanding the slew of deals with the EU and France. The purchase of 36 Rafale fighters in 2016, subsequent contracts for 18 naval versions, and the rejection of US, Russian, European, and Swedish offers were seen as a combination of high technology and, more importantly, trust. Trump's coercive tariffs and warnings over de-dollarisation in BRICS have made India compliant. But the narrative worsens. A US submarine sinking an Iranian naval ship, IRIS Dena, in the Indian Ocean after it returned from the Indian Fleet Review 2026 dented India's image as a net security provider.

“Strategic” is perhaps the most overused adjective in the diplomatic lexicon. It is attached to “restraint”, “patience”, “sovereignty”, and “national interest”. The word “partnership” is variable, dynamic, and transactional. But “strategic autonomy” — hedging or balancing relationships through sovereign choices — has endured. It originates from non-alignment adopted after independence, when New Delhi punched far above its weight. With adversarial relations with the US intensifying, India was gradually pulled towards the Soviet Union. Confronted with simultaneous threats from Pakistan, China, and the US in 1971, India was compelled to sign the first formal Treaty of Peace and Friendship with the USSR. Then Prime Minister Indira Gandhi insisted that the phrase “India is a non-aligned country” be inserted into the treaty, although it functioned de facto as an alliance.



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The writer, a retired Major General, served as Commander, IPKF (South), Sri Lanka, and was a founder member of the Defence Planning Staff, now the Integrated Defence Staff

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India has evolved from non-alignment to multi-alignment, multi-engagement, and multipolarity, culminating in strategic autonomy, whose utility appears to be diminishing in a disrupted global order. Since no formal national security policy or strategy documents have been produced, strategic autonomy remains an immaculate conception, despite six drafts reportedly gathering dust. With India's oldest ally, Russia, the relationship is described as “Special, Privileged and Strategic”. The partnership with the US has evolved from an “Estranged Democracy” into a “Comprehensive, Global and Strategic” partnership. Relations with China have fluctuated between war and border skirmishes, signifying deep mistrust. The EU is a more recent entrant into the strategic club, though largely in trade and commerce. Relations with Vietnam were elevated to an “Enhanced Comprehensive Strategic Partnership” during the recent visit of President To Lam.

Lately, there has been intense debate regarding strategic autonomy and India's graded strategic relations with other nations, many of which have undergone qualitative upgrades. Strategic autonomy is a dynamic policy that requires periodic recalibration in line with contemporary geopolitics and geoeconomics. The recent summit between Xi Jinping and Donald Trump in Beijing confirmed a shift in the US strategic approach towards China — from rivalry and competition towards “stable and respectful relations”. Diplomatic vocabulary acquired a new phrase from Xi: “constructive strategic stability”, replacing the Biden-era term “strategic competition”. Trump went further in a Fox News interview, describing the meeting as resembling a “G2”, recalling earlier remarks made by President Obama that had caused consternation. Trump

displayed unusual restraint and respect towards Xi, praising his leadership extensively. The subsequent Xi-Putin summit was described as a meeting between “dear friends” in an “everlasting strategic partnership”. In both cases, Xi conceded little to either Trump or Putin. These developments call for a reassessment of India's strategic autonomy.

At the recent Chennai conference, the majority opinion supported the establishment's approach, calling it “pragmatic”. The opposing view argued that the government had deferred excessively to Trump, beginning with Modi's February 2025 visit. Regarding the two kinetic assaults on Iran, critics argued that India had effectively taken sides even before the conflict began. It appeared aligned with the US and Israel, particularly after Modi addressed the Knesset 48 hours before the Iranian Supreme Leader was assassinated in an Israeli precision strike. Apparently, both US and Indian intelligence agencies believed the conflict would end swiftly. Delhi remained silent, despite Modi's earlier repeated assertion that “this is not an era of war” and that only a political solution could resolve conflicts. India's attempt to balance strategic relations with the US, Russia, China, Israel, the EU, and Vietnam has resulted in too many competing priorities, with its relationship with Israel increasingly becoming a liability among Global South nations.

Some of India's recent diplomatic difficulties might have been avoided with more skilful handling of Trump's claim that the US facilitated the ceasefire during Operation Sindoor, which was not entirely untrue. Acknowledging this would not necessarily have undermined strategic autonomy. India's insistence that there was no third-party mediation appears difficult to sustain, given that in nearly every crisis since 1971 the US has played a role. Pakistan, meanwhile, managed its diplomacy skilfully, transforming its image from a state sponsor of terrorism into that of a responsible mediator in conflict resolution.

Pakistan can now claim to have helped facilitate the impending ceasefire between the US and Iran, in which Israel is conspicuously absent. Its international profile has consequently risen, and rather than being re-hyphenated with India, it now occupies a different diplomatic category.

At another seminar, Ambassador Jawed Ashraf remarked emphatically: “Silence is not strategic autonomy”, hinting at India's silence regarding what many consider illegitimate actions by the US and Israel against Iran and others. To become a Viksit Bharat, India must play a more proactive role and truly avoid bowing to anyone, as Modi frequently states. Its credibility among the Global South and within its neighbourhood is at stake. Strategic autonomy is indeed in need of a reset.

PIC TALK



A boy rides on a buffalo as others cool off in the River Tawi on a hot summer day in Jammu.

PHOTO: PTI

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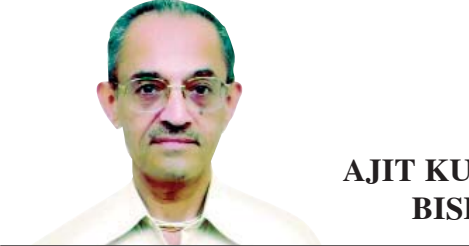
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Ahankar: The greatest barrier between man and God



AJIT KUMAR BISHNOI

2ND OPINION

We should all be peaceful, 'sukhi' (happy), and satisfied. Unfortunately, we fail to achieve this dream state. Aren't we small, truly helpless, and largely ignorant? We are, but we do not accept this reality due to 'ahankar' (false ego). What is this 'ahankar'? It is a faculty given to us to realise that we exist and have a separate identity. In brief, ahankar means that I am; I exist. Unfortunately, we falsely believe that we are great because of whatever opulences we possess, such as wealth, power, etc. But these are temporary possessions earned through good karmaphalas (results of past pious deeds). They do not give peace, sukha, or satisfaction - what we constantly seek and miss.

It is time to seek an entity who can grant all these and is willing to accept us as well. As a matter of fact, God is willing to help all of us. His only condition is that we give up ahankar and sincerely take His shelter. God then takes charge and begins to micromanage the life of the surrendered soul. This includes reformations, especially of 'svabhava' (nature), which is a person's worst enemy. Aren't we helplessly lustful and greedy? As improvements occur, God begins to empower the willing soul in a manner that suits the individual. For example, my Lord has empowered me to write spiritual texts.

With time, one becomes capable of accomplishing great tasks, just as Arjuna did in the Mahabharata war. Prior to that, Lord Krishna had assured Arjuna about the outcome of the war; Arjuna merely had to become a 'nimitta' (instrument)



ment) of God, rise, and gain fame. (11.33) It was a foregone conclusion because God was the 'karta' (doer) in that case. We also have Hanumanji's example of how one should act as a 'nimitta'. Upon his return from Lanka, having successfully accomplished his mission, Lord Ramachandra asked him, “How did you accomplish the stupendous task of burning Lanka, which was protected by Ravana?” Hanumanji replied, “O Raghunathji! It is all due to You; there is no greatness on my part.” (Shri Ramcharitmanas, Sundarkanda 32) Hanumanji understood that it became possible only because of empowerment by his Lord. Unfortunately, we are not that wise; we try to take credit despite the warning given by Lord Krishna: “Whatever you do; whatever you eat; whatever offering you make; whatever you give in charity; whatever austerities you perform, do that as an offering to Me.” (9.27)

We become puffed up with success, forgetting that everything was possible only through God's empowerment, as Hanumanji realised. This satisfies ahankar and distances us from God. Yet not everyone makes this mistake; some remain humble. Such souls progressively become peaceful, sukhi, and satisfied under God's protection. Gradually, they attain the dream state of 'jeevan mukta' (liberated while living in a material body). Many even qualify for liberation, which God is pleased to grant.

The Pioneer
SINCE 1865

The writer is a spiritual teacher and a popular columnist

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Voice of social change

Writer Sivasankari being honoured with the Padma Shri has added dignity and stature to the award itself. Beginning her professional career in the 1970s as a Public Relations Officer at Citibank, Sivasankari transformed her pen into a powerful instrument of social awareness and reform. Over more than five decades, she has enriched Tamil literature through novels, short stories, essays, travelogues, and biographies. Her remarkable literary contribution includes 36 novels, 150 short stories, 15 travelogues, seven essay collections, and three biographies, including one on former Prime Minister Indira Gandhi. Her works have also been translated into several Indian and foreign languages, reflecting her universal appeal.

Tamil literature once enjoyed a discerning and committed readership. While writers such as Sujatha and Balakumaran dominated among male authors, Sivasankari and Indumathi emerged as powerful female voices shaping social consciousness through literature. What distinguished Sivasankari was not merely the volume of her work, but the depth of compassion and social concern reflected in it. Her celebrated novels, including *47 Natkal*, courageously addressed alcoholism, women's struggles, family relationships, and changing social values, leaving a lasting impact on generations of readers.

AP THIRUVADI | CHENNAI

Pride of Indian athletics

It is truly inspiring and a matter of immense pride for every Indian to witness Gurindervir Singh clocking 10.09 seconds in the 100-metre race and becoming the fastest Indian athlete. His achievement reflects the power of dedication, discipline, and self-belief.

What makes his success even more remarkable is the inspiring journey behind it. Despite being repeatedly told that Indians were not naturally suited for the 100-metre sprint, Gurindervir refused to accept such limitations and proved that determination can break stereotypes. His statement, “Indian genes are also strong,” perfectly captures the confidence and spirit of today's youth. Equal credit must go to his parents and coaches, whose sacrifices, encouragement, and unwavering support played a crucial role in helping him achieve this milestone. Stories like these remind us that behind every successful sportsperson stands a family that dreams, struggles, and perseveres together. Gurindervir's achievement will undoubtedly motivate countless youngsters, particularly in Punjab, to pursue athletics with greater passion and confidence. His success is not merely a personal triumph but a moment of inspiration for the entire nation. India now eagerly awaits further glory from him at the forthcoming Commonwealth Games and Asian Games.

SANJAY CHOPRA | MOHALI

Restoring trust In NEET

The Supreme Court's strong reprimand of the National Testing Agency over the NEET paper leak controversy is both timely and necessary. Following repeated failures in maintaining examination integrity and the subsequent cancellation of the highly competitive NEET-UG examination, the Court's intervention has become essential to ensure accountability and structural reform.

The Court expressed concern that the NTA failed to learn from previous controversies despite repeated warnings. Following the NEET-2024 irregularities, an expert committee headed by former ISRO chief K. Radhakrishnan submitted 101 recommendations to strengthen examination security and transparency, many of which were allegedly not implemented properly.

NEET-2024 witnessed allegations of paper leaks and an unprecedented number of top rankers, raising serious doubts about the credibility of the examination system. In 2025, the Central Bureau of Investigation reportedly arrested individuals attempting to manipulate NEET scores in exchange for huge sums of money. The latest paper leak controversy has further damaged public trust.

Students and parents are demanding a transparent system. The Union Government must restore trust and protect merit.

P VICTOR SELVARAJ | TIRUNELVELI

SYMBOLIC DIPLOMACY CANNOT REPLACE CONCRETE POLICY COMMITMENTS

Apropos “Repairing Bridges, Reaffirming Alliances” (26 May 2026), the high-profile diplomacy surrounding the visit of Marco Rubio appears more like a calculated exercise in damage control than a spontaneous expression of bilateral warmth. While a White House dinner invitation and visits to cultural landmarks create positive optics, they cannot instantly erase the trust deficit created by punitive tariffs and differing positions on regional security issues.

Washington clearly recognises the strategic importance of India as a major counterweight in the Indo-Pacific region. However, durable alliances are built on consistency and mutual respect rather than temporary diplomatic gestures. Symbolism alone cannot substitute for long-term strategic clarity and economic cooperation.

A pragmatic future requires

both nations to move beyond optics and confront economic and geopolitical realities honestly. For India, diversifying energy partnerships must remain guided by economic interest and national priorities, not merely by attempts to satisfy American strategic concerns.

If the United States genuinely wishes to strengthen ties with India, it must offer concrete commitments in trade, investment, defence technology transfer, and strategic cooperation instead of relying solely on goodwill diplomacy. Goodwill is ultimately a perishable commodity. Unless Washington treats New Delhi as an equal strategic partner rather than a transactional buffer in global rivalries, these repaired bridges may once again become vulnerable to future political storms

K CHIDANAND KUMAR | BANGALURU

Please send your letter to the info@dailypioneer.com. In not more than 250 words. We appreciate your feedback.

How India is building energy sovereignty, brick by brick

Energy sovereignty on large scale cannot be achieved overnight. It is built steadily through factories, infrastructure, and changing habits — brick by brick, factory by factory, citizen by citizen



BHUPATIRAJU SRINIVASA VARMA

the largest two-wheeler base on the planet and a passenger vehicle market still in its early growth stage, how the country powers its mobility will shape household budgets, the rupee, and its strategic standing for decades.

The structural answer has, over the past decade, become clear and globally visible — the gradual transition of mobility from petrol and diesel to electric. The International Energy Agency notes that the world's electric vehicle stock displaced more than 1.3 million barrels of oil a day in 2024, and projects that figure to cross five million by 2030. India, under the leadership of Narendra Modi, has been positioning itself for this transition over the past decade.

At the centre of that effort sits PM E-DRIVE — the Prime Minister Electric Drive Revolution in Innovative Vehicle Enhancement scheme. Launched in October 2024 with an outlay of ₹10,900 crore and recently extended to March 2028, it supports 24.79 lakh electric two-wheelers, 3.16 lakh electric three-wheelers, 14,028 electric buses across nine cities, electric trucks and ambulances, and a nationwide charging backbone worth ₹2,000 crore. At a national conference in Bengaluru earlier this week, an additional 4,874 EV chargers across several states were approved.

The early returns are visible. India sold over 25.5 lakh electric vehicles in the last financial year — a 25 per cent year-on-year jump, taking the electric share to 8.64 per cent of all automobile sales. Penetration in the electric three-wheeler passenger segment has crossed 33 per cent.

The 16.72 lakh vehicles already supported by demand incentives are saving the country around ₹0.14 crore worth of fuel every day. Each vehicle, cumulatively, represents a barrel of crude no longer imported into the country.

PM E-DRIVE alone cannot deliver this transition. Consumer subsidy is merely the visible end of a much longer supply chain — batteries, magnets, components, and complete vehicles.

A connected set of schemes addresses that larger ecosystem. The Production-Linked Incentive for Automobiles and Auto Components (₹25,938 crore) anchors advanced automotive manufacturing. The PLI for Advanced Chemistry Cells (₹18,100 crore) is taking domestic battery production to gigawatt scale — historically the largest cost component in an imported EV.

The Scheme for Rare Earth Magnets (₹7,280 crore) addresses a supply chain in which global capacity is concentrated in very few hands, and upon which an Aatmanirbhar Bharat in mobility cannot afford to remain dependent. The Scheme to Promote Manufacturing of Electric Passenger Cars in India, opened to global applicants in June 2025, brings world-leading EV manufacturers to Indian

soil with a minimum committed investment of ₹4,150 crore each. Behind these schemes lies employment for young Indian engineers, technicians, and ITI graduates.

Public transport carries the same logic at scale. Buses account for nearly 60 per cent of all passenger kilometres in India. Two schemes support their electrification: PM E-DRIVE's ₹4,391 crore allocation for 14,028 buses, and the PM e-Bus Sewa Payment Security Mechanism, with an outlay of ₹3,435.33 crore, supporting over 38,000 additional electric buses by guaranteeing operator payments when a State Transport Undertaking delays payment.

That single guarantee removes a financial obstacle that no subsidy alone could address. Bengaluru is set to receive 4,500 buses in the current phase, Hyderabad 2,000, Delhi 2,800, Ahmedabad 1,000, and Surat 600.

Energy is the bedrock of modern economic life. For a country that imports nearly nine out of every ten barrels of the oil it consumes, securing it is not one policy question among others. It is the policy question of the century. India faces it more sharply than most: as the world's third-largest crude importer, with



The Pioneer
SINCE 1865

WHAT HAS BEEN SET IN MOTION UNDER THE PRIME MINISTER'S LEADERSHIP OVER THE PAST DECADE GIVES INDIA, TODAY, MORE OPTIONS THAN EVER BEFORE AT A TIME OF INTERNATIONAL ENERGY UNCERTAINTY. THE VISION OF VIKSIT BHARAT BY 2047 RESTS, IN PART, ON PRECISELY THIS WORK, WHICH WILL CONTINUE

The writer is the Minister of State for Heavy Industries and Steel

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 The Pioneer

None of this work began because of the present international situation, but recent developments have made its value abundantly clear. Global oil markets have experienced significant volatility since late February, with disruptions around the Strait of Hormuz affecting major shipping routes. India imports 88 per cent of its crude oil and spent 174.9 billion dollars — 22 per cent of total imports — on crude and petroleum products in 2025-26. Several major Asian and European economies witnessed retail fuel prices rise by twenty to thirty per cent during this period. Prices at Indian petrol pumps, however, moved only marginally — the result of diversified sourcing, prudent fiscal management, and the resilience of our oil marketing companies.

It is in this context that the Prime Minister's recent appeal — to consume less petrol, carpool, use the metro, and shift to electric vehicles when changing one's vehicle - has found a country increasingly prepared. The carpool the Prime Minister referred to, scaled to the level of the city, is the electric bus already arriving in Bengaluru and Hyderabad. The shift to electric mobility is now a practical choice available to the average citizen, often at a lower running cost than petrol or diesel vehicles.

The same effort is visible on the diplomatic front in the Prime Minister's ongoing five-nation tour covering the United Arab Emirates, the Netherlands, Sweden, Norway, and Italy from May 15 to 20. The agreements signed in Abu Dhabi this week — including a Memorandum of Understanding on Strategic Petroleum Reserves and a long-term arrangement for the supply of Liquefied Petroleum Gas — strengthen India's energy supply lines for the years ahead. Discussions underway in the Nordic capitals are advancing cooperation in clean technology, battery chemistry, and green industrial growth.

What is important across all these initiatives is how they fit together. The manufacturing schemes create the production base. PM E-DRIVE places alternative vehicles within reach of ordinary citizens.

The Payment Security Mechanism puts electric buses onto Indian roads. The Prime Minister's appeal encourages citizens to make choices that this architecture now enables. Diplomatic outreach secures the inputs and partnerships necessary for the future. Each forms part of one national project. Energy sovereignty on this scale cannot be achieved overnight. It is built steadily through factories, infrastructure, and changing habits — brick by brick, factory by factory, citizen by citizen.

What has been set in motion under the Prime Minister's leadership over the past decade gives India, today, more options than ever before at a time of international energy uncertainty.

The vision of Viksit Bharat by 2047 rests, in part, on precisely this work, which will continue.

It's time to get industrial trans fats out of our kitchens



INDU BHUSHAN

enforcement remains uneven across the country, and in too many states it is still not being meaningfully implemented. Trans fats — the chemically altered oils that clog arteries and kill silently — are still finding their way into our food. They may be present in samosas at roadside stalls, in the cream layers of biscuits, in the ladoos and jalebis sold at neighbourhood sweet shops, and in the puffs and patties at bakeries in our towns and cities. The law has been written, but it is not yet being lived. The gap is neither technical nor cultural — it is about enforcing the law where the problem actually begins.

This is the work that lies ahead.

Trans fats are not, as is sometimes assumed, part of our diverse culinary heritage. Vanaspati — the partially hydrogenated vegetable oil that became the workhorse of cheap commercial cooking in twentieth-century India - was a foreign invention introduced in the 1930s as an industrial substitute for ghee. It was sold to us as a modern, hygienic, and convenient product, but in reality it is equivalent to slow poison. Every gram of industrial trans fat consumed in India today is a gram of something our traditional kitchens never knew. What our great-grandmothers' kitchens did know was mustard oil pressed from seeds grown across the Gangetic plain; groundnut oil from the kolhus of Gujarat and Maharashtra; coconut oil from Kerala; sesame oil (til ka tel) pressed in the fields of Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh; and ghee, made the slow way, from the milk of cows fed on real fodder. These are the fats India consumed for centuries. None of them contain the industrial trans fats estimated to have caused up to half a million premature deaths globally every year.

The death toll in India is staggering: an estimated 70,000 deaths annually due to trans fat consumption. Cardiovascular disease is now the leading killer in our country, striking Indians, on average, a full decade earlier than it strikes people in Western nations. India also bears one of the world's heaviest diabetes burdens - and a growing body of evidence now links industrial trans fat consumption not only to heart attacks but also to insulin resistance and type 2 diabetes. Every heart attack prevented, every case of diabetes averted, is a wage-earner saved, a family kept whole, and a hospital bed freed for someone else.

So, what must states now do? The answer is simpler than it first appears because the problem is concentrated. Industrially produced trans fats are made by a finite and known number of producers - the manufacturers of vanaspati, margarine, bakery and confectionery shortenings, and partially hydrogenated and inadequately reformulated fats that downstream bakers and halwais purchase. Solve the producer problem, and the downstream problem largely solves itself. First, identify the producers. Every state food safety department, working with FSSAI, can identify all manufacturers of vanaspati, bakery shortening, and hydrogenated fat operating within the state. This is not a search for needles in haystacks. These are, for the most part, licensed and registered industrial units. They can be listed, visited, sampled, and tested against the 2 per cent limit. Those not registered can readily be identified and brought into the system by tracing supply chains back from shops to suppliers and then to producers.

Second, inform the producers - and the regulators themselves. Implementation has been uneven partly because frontline officials responsible for enforcement have not always been adequately equipped to do so. State food safety officers need clear guidance on identifying and sampling regulated products, standardised laboratory protocols to measure TFA content, and the authority to act upon their findings. Many producers - especially smaller regional manufacturers - continue operating with outdated technology, formulations, and supply chains. State governments, working alongside the edible oil industry and technical institutes, can guide the transition towards compliant fat blends and, above all, towards the use of traditional Indian oils that are healthier and have formed the foundation of our cuisine for generations.

A producer who reformulates healthier alternatives using mustard, groundnut, sesame, and rice-bran oils or their blends is not merely complying with the law. He or she is creating a better product from crops cultivated by Indian farmers.

Third, take action against those unwilling to comply. Information and assistance are the carrot; the stick must also be real. Producers who, after being identified and offered a clear path forward, continue to market non-compliant trans-fat-laden products are introducing toxins into our food supply and should face licence suspension, product seizure and recall, and prosecution under the Food Safety and Standards Act. A handful of stringent and publicised actions will move the industry faster than a thousand inspections of small bakeries ever could. India set the standard for the world four years ago; it is now time to make India truly trans fat free. We know that we can, and when we do, we will not be importing some foreign idea of health. We will be returning to our own roots and moving towards an Ayushman Bharat.



The writer is President of I-LEAP at Pahlé India Foundation and a former Indian bureaucrat. He was also the first CEO of Ayushman Bharat

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India acquires capacity to operate a commercial-scale fast breeder nuclear reactor



ANIL BHAT

chain reaction. This monumental achievement pushes India into the second stage of its pioneering three-stage nuclear energy programme and positions the country as a global leader in advanced breeder reactor technology.

Completed and commissioned in March 2024, the reactor successfully achieved first criticality just thirteen months later — the initiation of a sustained, self-sustaining nuclear chain reaction.

Designed by the Indira Gandhi Centre for Atomic Research and built by BHAVINI, a Government of India enterprise established to construct and operate the country's advanced nuclear power reactors, the PFBR is central to Stage Two of India's Three-Stage Nuclear Power Programme. It is designed to use mixed oxide (MOX) fuel - plutonium and uranium — and produces more fissile material than it consumes, paving the way for the utilisation of India's vast thorium reserves.

India holds only about 1-2 per cent of global uranium reserves but possesses one of the world's largest thorium reserves, estimated at 25-

30 per cent of the global total. Thorium cannot be used directly as a nuclear fuel; it must first be irradiated in a reactor to convert it into the fissile isotope Uranium-233. To harness these reserves, the Department of Atomic Energy established an innovative closed-loop Three-Stage Nuclear Power Programme aimed at achieving long-term energy independence:

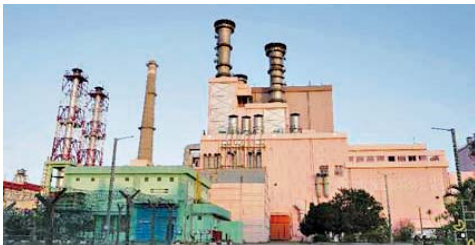
Stage 1: Pressurised Heavy Water Reactors Natural uranium is used as fuel to generate power. The spent fuel produces plutonium, which acts as the primary input for the next stage.

Stage 2: Fast Breeder Reactors The plutonium from Stage 1 is used to fuel reactors that generate more fissile material than they consume. These reactors are also used to irradiate thorium and convert it into Uranium-233.

Stage 3: Thorium-Based Reactors These reactors will use the Uranium-233 bred in Stage 2 to power the nation using the country's abundant coastal thorium reserves.

The PFBR at Kalpakkam, Tamil Nadu, marks a major milestone towards transitioning into the second and ultimately the third stages of this roadmap. India's Department of Atomic Energy designed a unique phased roadmap to bypass its limited domestic uranium reserves and unlock its massive coastal monazite sand deposits, found extensively in Kerala, Tamil Nadu, and Odisha.

Unlike conventional reactors that consume more fuel than they produce, the 500 MWe PFBR is a "breeder" reactor. Using a uranium-plutonium mixed oxide (MOX) fuel core, it is designed to transmute surrounding non-fissile uranium



into more plutonium than it burns.

This entirely indigenous innovation has been achieved after overcoming decades of complex engineering challenges and geopolitical technology denial regimes. The plant was completely designed by the Indira Gandhi Centre for Atomic Research and built by BHAVINI, validating India's culture of scientific self-reliance. India's ambition to sustain its power grid for up to 60,000 years relies on its vast world-leading thorium reserves, estimated to exceed 500,000 tonnes. Thorium-based nuclear reactors use a closed fuel-cycle process that transforms this abundant element into fissile Uranium-233, creating a practically limitless energy source capable of achieving genuine national energy independence.

Power generated at the Kalpakkam nuclear complex is delivered across India through the National Grid. The delivery process operates as follows:

(a) Generation and Step-Up: The Madras Atomic Power Station (MAPS) and the PFBR generate electricity at medium voltages, around 15-33 kV. Generator Step-Up (GSU) transformers immedi-

ately boost this to extra-high voltages, such as 400 kV or 220 kV, to minimise energy loss over long distances.

(b) Grid Interconnection: The stepped-up power is fed into the Southern Regional Grid. It is integrated through switchyards at Kalpakkam into high-voltage direct current (HVDC) and high-voltage alternating current (HVAC) transmission lines.

(c) National Transmission: Using inter-state "power highways", electricity is transmitted across the country. The Power Grid Corporation of India monitors and balances this supply dynamically. If regional power pools experience deficits, grid operators can reroute Kalpakkam's electricity to different states through the inter-connected National Grid.

(d) Distribution to Consumers: When the electricity reaches its destination state, it passes through regional substations where the voltage is progressively stepped down through successive transformers, ultimately reducing it to low-voltage lines (415V/230V) to safely power homes and businesses across the nation.

By design and according to the laws of nuclear physics, the PFBR at Kalpakkam produces high-grade Plutonium-239, the primary fissile material used in nuclear weapons. A fast breeder reactor (FBR) uses a core of mixed uranium-plutonium fuel surrounded by a "blanket" of depleted Uranium-238. Fast neutrons generated in the core bombard this blanket, transmuting the uranium into Plutonium-239. While reactors inherently produce different grades of plutonium, the FBR's operating cycle can be manipulated to yield highly pure,

weapons-grade Plutonium-239 by removing the fuel and blanket rods before they become "over-exposed", which would otherwise create less desirable plutonium isotopes. India's three-stage nuclear programme is designed ultimately to harness the country's vast thorium reserves.

Because India maintains a civil-military separation in its nuclear programme — and is not a signatory to the Treaty on the Non-Proliferation of Nuclear Weapons 1 the PFBR operates outside the safeguards of the International Atomic Energy Agency. While the PFBR's stated primary objective is to produce clean baseload electricity and establish a closed fuel cycle for thorium utilisation, the facility also provides an industrial-scale capability that yields the precise materials required for nuclear weapons. While this is a historic milestone for long-term energy security, it will have no immediate effect on mitigating the current global energy crisis, as the reactor will require months of safety testing, grid integration, and commissioning before reaching full commercial power capacity.

The immediate impact is primarily symbolic and strategic: it makes India only the second country in the world, after Russia, to operate a commercial-scale fast breeder reactor, thereby demonstrating the country's technological capability to manage complex closed-loop nuclear fuel cycles.

The writer is a VSM (Retd), a strategic affairs analyst and former spokesperson, Defence Ministry and Indian Army

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NEET row: Coaching centre founder's custody extended

A Delhi court on Tuesday extended by one day the CBI custody of a coaching centre founder, Shivraj Raghunath Motegoankar, in the NEET paper leak case. Special CBI judge Ajay Gupta extended the custody after the agency submitted that further custodial interrogation was required for confrontation with other co-accused, recovery of material evidence and establishing the accused's role. Motegoankar, the founder of Renukai Career Centre, was arrested on the evening of May 17 in Latur, and the court sent him to nine days' CBI custody the next day. In its remand application, the CBI had said, "He is involved in the leakage and circulation of NEET UG exam questions-2026 and that, in conspiracy with other accused persons, he had received the chemistry questions and answers of the exam before the examination, ie on April 23, 2026."



NCP (SP) leader Vikas Lawande gets bail

Five days after he was arrested, a local court on Tuesday granted bail to NCP (SP) spokesperson Vikas Lawande in a case registered against him over alleged controversial remarks about a few leaders of the Warkari sect. Judicial Magistrate First Class Alisha Bagal directed Lavande's release on a personal bond of ₹30,000, subject to conditions that he shall not commit a similar offence in future and provide his permanent residential address to the court. Lawande was arrested by the Wagholi police on May 21. During the hearing, his lawyer advocate Milind Pawar argued that the arrest was in violation of the due process of law as well as the guidelines laid down by the Supreme Court. Police also provided misleading information to the court earlier to get his interim pre-arrest bail cancelled, the lawyer stated.



HC directs OpIndia to remove defamatory articles on journalist Swati Chaturvedi

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

An appeal preferred by the website OpIndia assailing the May 13 injunction order passed by the District Judge Meenu Kaushik of Patiala House Court, whereby OpIndia was directed to remove/takedown two defamatory articles about journalist Swati Chaturvedi, was listed before the Delhi High Court on Tuesday.

Senior Advocate J Sai Deepak, appearing for OpIndia, contended that the trial court's order deserved to be set aside and pressed for a stay on the



injunction. This prayer for a stay was opposed by Advocate Akshat Gupta, representing journalist Swati Chaturvedi.

Justice Manoj K Ohri, while issuing notice on the appeal, declined to stay the trial court order and fixed the matter for hearing on August 20, observing that staying the order would amount to virtually allowing the appeal, which cannot be done without hearing both sides.

No death for child rape convict: Delhi Court

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A Delhi court refused to award the death penalty to a man convicted of raping a four-year-old girl, saying the incident did not fall under the "rarest of rare" category.

Additional Sessions Judge Amit Sahrawat observed while hearing arguments on the quantum of punishment to convict Sunny Kumar, and instead sentenced the 22-year-old to imprisonment for the remainder of his natural life. "This court does not think that the present case falls in the category of rarest of rare cases. Considering the young age and clean past of the convict, the capital sentence is not justifiable in the present case," the court order read.

On April 30, the court convicted Kumar for kidnapping and raping a girl, saying that the child suffered brutal and life-threatening injuries that could only have been caused by penetrative sexual assault. The court said that the "diabolical" conduct of Kumar showed he posed a



serious threat to society and deserved no leniency. "Although the convict is not being considered for a capital sentence, there is still no doubt in holding that his misdeeds are diabolical in nature and he does not deserve any kind of leniency, and he is required to be kept out of society for as long as possible," the order read. The court said that the sufferings of the victim cannot even be imagined. Undergoing several surgeries and then remaining bedridden due to surgical constraints is too painful, it said. "If a convict can commit rape of such a small child, then he is a serious threat to society at large, and therefore he should be kept behind bars throughout his life," the court said.



SC tells Rajasthan, MP, UP to curb illegal sand mining

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday directed the Governments of Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh to take immediate and effective steps, including initiating the recruitment process to fill vacant posts of forest guards, to curb rampant illegal sand mining in the National Chambal Gharial Sanctuary.

The top court directed these states to ensure the establishment and operationalisation of surveillance and monitoring infrastructure in affected regions, and also called for coordinated enforcement action against

vehicles and machinery involved in these activities and the owners and contractors linked to them.

A bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta took note of a recent media report relating to instances of unregistered and unnumbered vehicles being used for the transportation of illegally mined sand in Morena district of Madhya Pradesh.

It asked Additional Solicitor General SV Raju, who was appearing for Madhya Pradesh, to file a response on the issue and posted the matter for May 29.

"If this is correct, then your officers have filed a false affidavit in the court," the bench told Raju. The law officer said



if the facts were correct, then it was "shocking" and serious action must be taken.

"They have taken pictures of unregistered and unnumbered vehicles moving around," the bench observed.

The top court is hearing a suo motu case titled 'In Re: Illegal sand mining in the National Chambal Sanctuary and threat to endangered aquatic wildlife'.

The National Chambal

Sanctuary, also called the National Chambal Gharial Wildlife Sanctuary, is a 5,400-sq km tri-state protected area.

Besides the endangered gharial (long-snouted crocodile), it is home to the red-crowned roof turtle and the endangered Ganges river Dolphin. Located on the Chambal River near the tripoint of Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh, the sanctuary was first declared a protected area in Madhya Pradesh in 1978 and now constitutes a long and narrow eco-reserve co-administered by the three states. On Tuesday, the apex court passed further directions to ensure effective enforcement, institutional accountability

and immediate operationalisation of surveillance and preventive measures to deal with the issue of illegal sand mining. "The states of Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh are directed to undertake immediate and effective steps for augmentation of the field level enforcement officials in the respective forest departments, including recruitment to vacant posts of forest guards and other front line enforcement personnel..." it said.

It said the recruitment process for such posts should be expedited, and these states shall ensure that the process for filling up vacant posts is initiated forthwith and completed within a year.

Moneylife moves Delhi court against takedown order

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Journalist Sucheta Dalal's news portal Moneylife on Tuesday moved a Delhi court against a trial court order directing takedown and de-indexing of reports and videos relating to Manoj Kesarichand Sandesara, his family and the Sterling Biotech bank fraud.

District Judge Sunil Choudhary of Tis Hazari Courts heard the matter and recorded an undertaking on behalf of Sandesara that he would not seek any further takedown. The case will now



be heard on July 14.

The appeal was filed challenging a May 16 order passed by a senior civil judge in Sandesara's suit against Google LLC and others. The order restrained Moneylife

from publishing, republishing or circulating further content relating to Sandesara and his family name in connection with Sterling Biotech Limited and bank fraud. It also directed de-indexing,

de-listing and de-referencing of specified URLs and "such other links not known to the Plaintiff" relating to the subject matter.

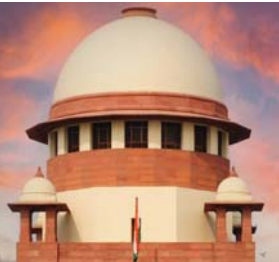
Moneylife has argued in its appeal that the civil judge's order is sweeping and directly affects journalistic reporting and infringes its fundamental rights under Articles 14 (right to equality), 19 (freedom of speech) and 21 (right to liberty) of the Constitution. According to its plea, the order "effectively chokes" reporting, publication or criticism concerning Sandesara, his family and the Sterling Biotech case.

SC upholds 1983 murder case convictions

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday upheld several convictions in a case of the murder of five people in Bihar in 1983, saying the brutality of the incident "shocks the judicial conscience."

A bench of Justices Sanjay Karol and N Kotiswar Singh said the trial court as well as the Patna High Court rightly observed that the case leaves



no room for "misplaced sympathy or leniency." The top court delivered its verdict on the appeals filed by the con-

victs challenging an August 2017 judgment of the Patna High Court. The high court had upheld the conviction and life sentence awarded by the trial court to these convicts.

The apex court noted that the incident took place in March 1983 in a village in Muzaffarpur district, where a mob of at least 58 persons set the house of Chandra Shekhar Choudhary on fire, followed by the brutal killing of five persons and wound-

ing of several others. It was the day of Holi when the mob armed with deadly weapons surrounded Choudhary's house.

"The high court has meticulously summarised the role of each accused person and identified those who ignited the straw, those who set the house on fire, those who chased the fleeing victims and those who inflicted fatal blows upon the deceased persons," the bench said.

SC seeks development plan near Vrindavan temple

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Kolkata

The Supreme Court on Tuesday directed the Uttar Pradesh Government to prepare a comprehensive development plan including widening of roads and other facilities for senior citizens, women, children and ailing devotees of Thakur Shree Bankey Bihari Ji Maharaj temple in Vrindavan.

A bench comprising Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi took note of the plea that the deity at the temple is a "living child" and passed a significant interim order to balance centuries-old traditions with modern administrative needs.

The bench directed the inclusion of four specific Goswami representatives into the high-powered committee (HPC) for effective management of the affairs of the temple.

It also directed the State Government and the HPC to prepare a comprehensive development plan for the area surrounding the temple.

The bench said the plan should address widening of roads, regulation of commercial activity, facilities for devotees and local residents, hotels, dharamshalas, drinking water, restrooms, emergency exits, public transport and electric vehicle access for senior citizens, women, children and ailing devo-



tees. "We have, therefore, requested the State Government as well as the committee to prepare a report and submit it before us for consideration," the CJ said in the order.

Senior advocate Shyam Divan and lawyer Tanvi Dubey, appearing for 'sevayats' (priests), said that the court-appointed HPC was

interfering with "essential religious practices".

He specifically challenged the September 2025 order of the HPC that altered 'darshan' timings. "The deity is a living child. There are specific periods for waking the deity, performing rituals and an afternoon rest period.

These timings are deeply embedded in rituals fol-

lowed since time immemorial and should not be disturbed for administrative convenience," Divan said. The petitioners also flagged the suspension of the 'Dehri Pooja', a ritual performed at the temple threshold when doors are closed and the imposition of an "exorbitant" fee of Rs 1.51 lakh for the 'Phool Bangla Seva', which was previously conducted by paying only nominal electricity and maintenance costs.

Addressing a "communication gap" between the Goswami community and the current administration, the bench ordered the induction of four members nominated by the priests into the committee.

CALCUTTA HC VACATES INTERIM PROTECTION TO TMC'S JAHANGIR KHAN

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Kolkata

The Calcutta High Court on Tuesday vacated an interim protection granted to TMC leader Jahangir Khan. According to police, seven FIRs have been registered against Khan at Falta police station in West Bengal's South 24 Parganas district.



A vacation bench of Justice Partha Sarathi Sen observed that it would be unjust to extend protection solely on the basis of a change in the political scenario in the state and allegations of political vendetta made by the petitioner.

Justice Sen refused Khan's prayer for extension of interim protection from coercive action by police, which was granted by the court on May 18. The court directed that the matter would be heard again before the regular bench after the summer vacation.

Sambhal temple-mosque row: Court puts off hearing to July 21

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Sambhal (UP)

A court in Chandausi on Tuesday postponed to July 21 the hearing in the Shahi Jama Masjid-Harihar temple dispute in the wake of the stay on proceedings by the Supreme Court.

The matter was listed for hearing before Civil Judge (Senior Division) Aditya Singh. Shahi Jama Masjid advocate Shakeel Ahmed Warsi told reporters that the hearing



in this case was to be held today but due to the stay on proceedings ordered

by the Supreme Court, the hearing was postponed and will be held on July 21

Mimicry case: Ranveer Singh visits Chamundeshwari Temple

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mysuru (Karnataka)

Bollywood actor Ranveer Singh on Tuesday visited the Chamundeshwari temple here and offered prayers after the Karnataka High Court directed him to visit the shrine in the 'Kantara' mimicry case against him, officials said. The visit to the shrine atop Chamundi Hills comes in the wake of the Karnataka High Court directive.

Speaking to reporters, one of the temple priests said, "He came at around 7.45 am. No one knew he had come-he was wearing a

mask, so no one could identify him. Only when he came inside the temple and removed the mask did we realise he was the actor."

"He came along with two others. After performing archane (floral offering ritual), we gave him prasada (sacred offerings) and sent him off. He prayed for ten minutes and did not mention the purpose of his visit," he said.

The High Court last month quashed proceedings against the actor in the case related to his mimicry of the deity depicted in the film 'Kantara'. The court's decision followed the



actor's submission of an unconditional apology.

The court had also accepted the revised affidavit submitted by his advocate and asked him to visit the Chamundi deity to make amends for his conduct.

The controversy relates to remarks allegedly made by the actor at the Filmfare Awards in Goa while speaking about the film 'Kantara'. He is accused of imitating a Daiva and calling it a "devil."

Based on a complaint by a lawyer who alleged that his religious sentiments were hurt, the 'Dhurandhar' actor was booked.

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Saatvik Green Energy bags ₹171 cr solar modules order

Saatvik Green Energy on Tuesday said it has secured a ₹171.45-crore order for supply of solar modules for a utility-scale solar project.

The modules being supplied are TOPCon Bifacial Glass-Glass Solar PV Modules, a latest-generation solar technology, that generates power from both sides of the panel, not just the front, significantly increasing energy output compared to conventional modules, a company statement said.

According to the statement, Saatvik Green Energy said it has received and accepted an order aggregating to ₹171.45 crore for a domestic independent power producer.

Saatvik Green Energy CEO Prashant Mathur said in the statement, “Being selected to supply modules for a domestic independent power producer of this magnitude at one of India’s most important solar sites is a meaningful endorsement of what we have built.”

Saatvik Green Energy is one of India’s leading solar photovoltaic module manufacturers, with a strong presence across utility-scale, commercial & industrial, EPC, and distributed solar segments. (PTI)

₹1,428 crore approved for 4-lane Thiruvavarur bypass

Ministry of Road Transport and Highways has approved ₹1,427.61 crore for the construction of a 4-lane Thiruvavarur bypass on the Nagapattinam-Thanjavur section of NH-83 in Tamil Nadu.

According to an official statement on Tuesday, the project spans 14.9 km and also includes the construction of two additional Road Over Bridges (ROBs) on NH-129A and NH-134A.

“In Tamil Nadu, we have approved ₹1,427.61 crore for the construction of a 4-lane Thiruvavarur Bypass on the Nagapattinam-Thanjavur section of NH-83, spanning 14.9 km, along with 2 additional ROBs on NH-129A & NH-134A. This strategic project will strengthen connectivity between key industrial hubs like Tiruchirappalli and Coimbatore with the port towns of Karaikal and Nagapattinam, boosting regional economic activity,” Union Minister Nitin Gadkari posted on X.

The bypass, starting from Adiyakkamangalam-Thandalai, will pass through key locations including Athipuliyyur, Andipalayam, Kidaramkondan, Pallivaramangalam, Perumpugalur, Elavangarkudi, and Anaivadapathy Colony, among others.

Once completed, it will significantly decongest Thiruvavarur town, reduce travel time by approximately 15 minutes, and enhance road safety by diverting traffic away from densely populated and commercial areas. The alignment will also improve connectivity to SH-23, SH-65, and the revered Thyagaraja Swamy Temple, contributing to both infrastructure development and ease of travel in the region. (PTI)

Fuel price hikes could push inflation to 5 pc; RBI to be on wait-and-watch mode for now: Economists

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Fuel price hikes and higher import duties on gold and silver could push retail inflation to 5 per cent by June, but the RBI will wait and watch till the impact of fuel price hike settles in before tightening interest rates in the second half of the fiscal year, economists said.

Over a period of 11 days, starting May 15, petrol prices have been increased by ₹7.38/ltr and diesel prices by ₹7.48/ltr with some inter-city variation. These price hikes will directly cascade into impacting prices in sectors where petrol and diesel are

used as inputs such as transport and storage and to some extent electricity.

Besides, the Government on May 13 had hiked import duty on gold and silver to 15 per cent to curb non-essential imports.

“After an overall increase averaging about ₹7.5/ltr in petroleum products, CPI inflation would go up by about 75 basis points. In May 2026, CPI inflation may thus be in the range of 4-4.5 per cent and June CPI may be in the range of 4.5-5 per cent,” EY India Chief Policy Advisor D K Srivastava told PTI. The CPI inflation data for May is scheduled to be released on June 12.

The Pioneer

NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | MAY 27, 2026

India, Canada push to seal trade pact in year end

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

India and Canada are looking at concluding negotiations for a free trade agreement by the end of this year, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal has said.

Goyal is in Canada for a three-day official visit, starting May 25. He is leading a delegation of industry leaders from over 100 companies.

“Our prime ministers have tasked us not only with completing the free trade agreement with a comprehensive outlook before the end of this year or earlier — but also tripling our trade from a current \$17 billion level to \$50

billion by 2030,” Goyal said, while jointly addressing the media in Ottawa with Canada’s Trade Minister Maninder Sidhu on Monday.

Goyal also called on Canada’s Prime Minister Mark Carney. Both sides expressed optimism about the early conclusion of the trade pact negotiations.

In a social media post, Carney said, “We’re negotiating a free trade deal with India. This will be a game changer for Canadian workers and businesses — unlocking a massive new market. We’re working fast — I met Minister @PiyushGoyal to review our progress so far and explore the opportunities ahead for both our countries

in energy, agri-food, tech, and education.”

The two countries are negotiating a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA). Two rounds of negotiations have been completed.

Handlers seek pay hike for replenishing cash at ATMs

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

Back-to-back hikes in fuel prices and workers’ wages have led to an increase of up to 20 per cent in the operating costs for cash logistics players, triggering the demand for a higher payment for managing cash at bank ATMs.

Cash logistics industry body CCA (Currency Cycle Association) has written to the Indian Banks Association (IBA) seeking a “pricing realignment”.

CCA, in a statement, said it

has highlighted the “rising operational cost in the cash logistics sector and has flagged a sharp rise in oper-

ating costs that will require timely pricing realignment with banks”.

In the letter addressed to

banks, a copy of which was reviewed by PTI, CCA said that fuel prices “have increased and continue elevating”, which impacts the cash van movement expenses, while simultaneously, there have been upward revision in minimum wages across several key states.

CCA said in its statement that Haryana has increased minimum wages for unskilled workers by approximately 35 per cent to ₹15,220 per month, while Uttar Pradesh has hiked it by around 20 per cent to ₹13,690.

Gold futures slides to ₹1.57 lakh/10g as fresh strikes on Iran spurs dollar demand

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

Gold prices retreated by ₹1,107 to ₹1.57 lakh per 10 grams in futures trade on Tuesday as renewed US military strikes against Iran triggered volatility, strengthened the US dollar and prompted traders to book profits.

On the Multi-Commodity Exchange, the yellow metal for June delivery rose by ₹1,107, or 0.7 per cent, to ₹1,57,974 per 10 grams in a business turnover of 4,725 lots.

Similarly, the August contract for gold also traded lower, declining by ₹1,061, or 0.65 per cent, to ₹1,61,320 per 10 grams in 4,810 lots on the MCX.

Analysts said the gold prices remained volatile as investors reacted to escalating tensions in West Asia and fluctuating crude oil prices.

“Gold prices experienced some volatility in the domestic futures market on Tuesday,” Gaurav Garg, Research

Analyst at Lemonn Markets Desk, said.

Optimism around possible US-Iran peace negotiations had initially supported sentiment before renewed uncertainty sparked fresh selling, he added.

In the international markets, Comex gold futures for August delivery went

up marginally to \$4,562.15 per ounce in New York. Gold prices turned volatile after the US military conducted fresh strikes on Iranian targets, which revived fears of a prolonged conflict in West Asia, Manav Modi, Commodities Analyst, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Ltd, said.

The renewed escalation pushed crude oil prices higher after a week of declines, reigniting concerns over energy-driven inflation and keeping markets cautious, he added.

“A rebound in oil prices also supported the US dollar, which remained relatively firm as investors continued to view the greenback as a safer asset amid geopolitical uncertainty,” Modi said.

US President Donald Trump acknowledged the ongoing diplomatic engagement with Tehran, but cautioned that military action could resume if talks collapse.

Fertiliser subsidy to cross ₹3 lakh cr in FY27: Govt

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

India’s fertiliser subsidy bill could cross ₹3 lakh crore in the current fiscal if the disruptions resulting from the West Asia crisis prolong, a senior Government official has said.

The budgetary allocation for fertiliser subsidies in 2026-27 stands at ₹1.71 lakh crore, but the subsidy bill is set to rise due to a sharp increase in prices of urea, Di-Ammonium Phosphate (DAP) and other soil-nutrients in the global market.

At a conference organised by the Indian Council for Research on International Economic Relations (ICRIER) on Monday, Krishna Kant Pathak, joint secretary in the Department of Fertilisers, asserted that the government currently has sufficient stocks of fertilisers, almost 20

million tonnes. He informed that the fertilisers are being sourced from different countries through long-term agreements.

“But, it has a cost. The cost, which before this war situation was almost ₹2 lakh crore in subsidies. It will grow substantially, and it will be a burden for us,” Pathak said at the event, the video of which was released on the ICRIER website.

Enforcing anti-dumping duties can save India ₹28,540 cr annually, says report

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The non-implementation of the recommended anti-dumping duties has resulted in an annual economic loss of ₹11,938 crore to the domestic industry, whereas the imposition of these levies could generate an additional ₹28,540 crore annually in forex by reducing imports, a report said on Tuesday.

The Directorate General of Trade Remedies (DGTR), under the commerce ministry, conducts investigations into alleged dumping as a quasi-judicial authority, whereas the finance ministry takes the final call to impose these duties.

“The non-implementation of anti-dumping duties on 56 DGTR-recommended products has resulted in an annual economic loss of ₹11,938 crore

to the domestic industry.

“Whereas, imposition of DGTR-recommended anti-dumping duty could additionally generate about ₹28,540 crore (\$3 billion) in annual foreign exchange savings by enabling domestic manufacturers to meet domestic demand instead of imports,” according to the C-DEP Research and Centre for WTO Studies report —

Impact of Anti-Dumping Duties in India.

A study of 33 products shows that economic loss from dumped imports in the current period is about ₹1.54 lakh crore, and is projected to rise to ₹2.70 lakh crore by 2030, with jobs loss increasing from around 24,000 at present to 38,000-42,000 by 2030, it said.

The report has examined

the effects of anti-dumping duties on downstream costs, inflation, MSMEs, domestic capacity, and investments.

Anti-dumping duties are WTO-compliant trade-remedy instruments that are levied globally by governments to safeguard their domestic manufacturers from predatory pricing by foreign exporters, who dump the imported products at prices that are lower than the prices in their home country.

Dumping occurs when a product is exported at a price lower than its normal value. For instance, if a chemical is sold domestically in China for \$100 per metric tonne but exported to India at \$70 per metric tonne, the dumping margin (difference between the normal value and export price) is \$30 per metric tonne, or 30 per cent.

TVS Motor tops global shareholder-value ranking

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

TVS Motor Company has topped a global shareholder-value ranking in the “Durable Consumer Goods” category, underlining the scale of its recent business momentum.

The company said the recognition from WirtschaftsWoche and Boston Consulting Group was based on a five-year review of more than 2,000 listed firms across 35 industries, with TVS emerging ahead of major peers from India and overseas.

TVS said it delivered an average annual total shareholder return of about 51 per cent between 2021 and 2025, supported by strong revenue growth, a richer market valuation, better profitability and a sturdier balance sheet. That combination helped the company fit the study’s profile of

resilient businesses: profitable, growth-led and financially disciplined.

TVS Motor reported its highest-ever annual sales at 5.89 million units, a 24 per cent jump from the previous year. Revenue climbed 30 per cent to ₹47,270 crore, operating profit before tax rose 40 per cent to ₹4,975 crore, and operating EBITDA margin improved to 12.9 per cent.

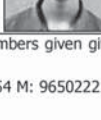
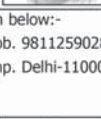
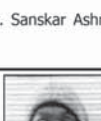
International demand also remained a bright spot, with the company saying overseas business grew 33 per cent across more than 90 markets. In a statement, Chief Mentor Professor Sir Ralf Speth credited Chairman Sudarshan Venu’s strategic direction, the company’s focus on technology and customers, and a culture rooted in manufacturing excellence and social responsibility.

per cent (from 6.9 per cent) after the June 5 MPC meeting.

India Ratings & Research Director Megha Arora said based on the four fuel price hikes so far, June CPI inflation is likely to be higher by around 38 bps, with an upside risk from further passthrough. June CPI is likely to surpass 4 per cent but remain within RBI’s upper tolerance band of 6 per cent.

The RBI has the mandate to keep inflation at 4 per cent with a tolerance band of 2 per cent on either side.

Crisil Principal Economist Dipti Deshpande said the rating agency expects average inflation at 5.1 per cent in current fiscal year.

DEPARTMENT OF WOMEN AND CHILD DEVELOPMENT GOVT. OF NCT OF DELHI ISBT BUILDING, KASHMERE GATE, DELHI 110006		
S.N o.	Description MISSING CHILDREN	Photograph
1	Name: Krishna , Father's Name: Ghosha, Mother's Name: Sona. Gender: Male, Age: 10 years, Complexion: Dusky, Hair: Short and black, Eyes: Black. This child was found missing at Sarai Rohilla Railway Station on June 14, 2026. At that time, the child was wearing a white T-shirt and blue half-pants. According to the child, his family resides in Kathiar, Haryana. Pursuant to the orders of the Child Welfare Committee-III (Central), the child was placed in the DMRC CUB for care and protection on August 19, 2025. This case has been registered at Sarai Rohilla Railway Station (G.R.P) under DD Entry No. 0080 A, dated June 14, 2025.	
2	Name: Sandeep Father's Name: Neeraj Mother's Name: Rupa Devi Gender: Male Age: 11 years Complexion: Dark Hair: Short and Black Eyes: Black. This child was found missing at Old Delhi Railway Station on June 9, 2025. At the time, the child was wearing a yellow T-shirt and blue half-pants. According to the child, his family resides in Fatehpur, Lalauli, Uttar Pradesh. In compliance with the orders of the Child Welfare Committee-III (Central), the child was placed in the DMRC CHB for care and protection on August 19, 2025. This case has been registered at New Delhi Railway Station (G.R.P) under DD Entry No. 0040 A, dated June 9, 2025.	
3	Name: Krishna , Father's Name: Himanshu, Mother's Name: Late Som, Gender: Male, Child's Age: 10 years, Complexion: Fair, Hair: Black, Eyes: Black. This child was found missing at Old Delhi Railway Station on July 24, 2024. At the time, the child was wearing a blue T-shirt and blue trousers. According to the child, his family resides in Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh. In compliance with the order issued by the Child Welfare Committee-III (Central) on January 15, 2025, the child has been placed in the DMRC CHB for his safety This case has been recorded at Old Delhi Railway Station (GRP) under DD Entry No. 0042 A; Date: July 24, 2024.	
4	Name: Rudra , Father's Name: Late Bunty, Mother's Name: Seema. Gender: Male, Age: 11 years. Complexion: Fair, Hair: Black, Eyes: Black. This child was found missing at the Old Delhi Railway Station on March 1, 2023. At that time, the child was wearing a white T-shirt and black trousers. According to the child, his family resides in Loni, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh. Pursuant to the orders of the Child Welfare Committee-III (Central), the child was placed in the DMRC Children's Home on November 22, 2023, for care and protection. This case has been registered at the Old Delhi Railway Station (GRP) under DD Entry No. 0039 A, dated March 1, 2023.	
5	Name: Unknown @ Mando ; Father's Name: Unknown; Mother's Name: Unknown; Gender: Male; Age: 9 years: Complexion: Fair; Hair: Black; Eyes: Black. This child was found abandoned at the Old Delhi Railway Station on July 11, 2023. At the time, the child was wearing a white T-shirt and blue trousers. According to the child, he has no knowledge regarding his family: he suffers from a speech impediment and also appears to be suffering from a mild mental illness. In compliance with the orders of the Child Welfare Committee-III (Central), the child was placed in the DMRC Children's Home on December 7, 2023, for care and protection. This case has been registered at the Old Delhi Railway Station (GRP) under DD Entry No. 0040 A, dated July 11, 2023.	
6	Name: Sanju Jaiswal Father's Name: Late Bablu Mother's Name: Renu Gender: Male Age: 10 years Complexion: Fair Hair: Black Eyes: Black. This child was found missing at Kishanganj Railway Station on July 1, 2022. At the time, the child was wearing a chocolate-colored shirt and blue lower garments. According to the child, his family resides in Gorakhpur, Uttar Pradesh. Pursuant to the order dated April 19, 2023, issued by the Child Welfare Committee-III (Central), the child has been placed in the DMRC (TIB for his safety. A case regarding this matter has been registered at Kishanganj (Delhi) Railway Station (RPF). vide DD Entry No. 42. dated July 14, 2022.	
7	Name: Shivam , Father's Name: Late Sunil, Mother's Name: Late Rajmuni, Gender: Male, Child's Age: 9 years. Complexion: Dusky, Hair: Black, Eyes: Black, An FIR regarding this child was registered at the Mukherjee Nagar Police Station in 2019. At the time, the child was wearing a brown shirt and blue lower garments. According to the child, his family resides in Delhi. Pursuant to the order dated April 13, 2023, issued by the Child Welfare Committee-III (Central), the child has been placed in the DMRC CUB for his safety. A case regarding this matter has been registered at the Mukherjee Nagar Police Station; FIR No.: 340/19, Date: July 2019.	
8	Name: Shivaay , Father's Name: Late Ashok , Mother's Name: sunita , Gender: Male, Child's Age: 16 years. Complexion: Fair, Hair: Black, Eyes: Black. This child was found missing at kashmeri gate on September 29, 2022. At the time, the child was wearing a blue T-shirt and blue trousers. According to the child, his family resides in assam. In compliance with the order issued by the Child Welfare Committee-III (Central) on September 30, 2022, the child has been placed in the DMRC CHB for his safety. This case has been recorded at kashmeri gate Police station under DD Entry No. 0041 A; Date: September 29, 2022.	
NOTE: Parents/Guardians/Relatives in case of children at S.No. 1 to 8 may contact at address/phone numbers given given below		
1. DMRC Children Home for Boys: Bhargava Lane, Pillar no, 65 Near Tis Hazari Metro Station Delhi 110054 M: 9650222184		
2. District Child Protection Unit-1, Sewa kutir, Kingsway Camp, Delhi-110054		
9	Name: Indu (given by the agency) Sex: Female DOB/age: about 2 years. The child was found abandoned at New Delhi Railway Station on 13.03.2025. Complexion: light black, GD No. 0046A dated: 13/03/2026 is lodged in PS New Delhi Railway Station ; The child wearing blue T-shirt and while pzmza. The child was produced before Child Welfare Committee, Central on 16/03/2026 and by the order of CWC the child has been kept in Sewa Bharati Matri Chhaya for care and protection. The child is not giving any detail of her parentage at all.	
Note: Parents/Guardians/Relatives in case of child at S. no. 9 may contact at address/phone numbers given below:- I.Sewa Bharati Matri Chhaya; 10455, Bagchi Allauddin, Gali No.3, Motia Khan, Pahar Ganj, New Delhi-55, Mob. 9811259028. 9212538402, 011-44747839 2. District Child Protection Unit-1 (Central), Sewa Kutir Complex, Kingsway Camp. Delhi-110009. Tel: 011-27655004		
Name - Diksha . Age:-12+ yrs, Complexion: - Whitish.Child was found abandoned at Burari through PCR Call DD entry was made at PS Burari Police Station with DD no: -51A Dated 04/03/21. She was produced before Child Welfare Committee by PS Burari The child has been kept in DMRC-Udaan Girls Children Home, Aradhak Marg adjacent to Red Cross Hospital Dilshad Garden. New Delhi- 110095		
Note: - Parents/Guardians/Relatives, in case of child, at S. no. 10 may contact at address/phone numbers given below		
1. DMRC- Udaan Girls Children Home, Aradhak Marg adjacent to Red Cross Hospital Dilshad Garden, New Delhi- 110095		
2. DCPO District ProtectionUnit-1, Sewa Kutir Complex, Kingsway Camp, New Delhi- 110009:- 011-27655034		
11	Name- Hedar Ali (came with name) male child, aged about 2 years, wheatish complexion, due to family dispute child palced with DCCW /Palna via order of CWC-V, Dilshad Garden on 8/8/25. Parents are alive and extended family is there. Child was produced before the committee-V. Dilshad Garden on 8/8/25. At the time of arrival he was wearing half sleeve red and brown colored west and blue colored half pant. Special need child. Case was lodged at P.S. Welcome and FIR no is 151 A dated 24/04/25	
12	Name -Malti (name given by agency) female child, wheatish complexion, around 2 years old. child was found abanoned/Missing at Anand Vihar bus terminal then placed to DCCW/PALNA via order of CWC-V. Dilshad Garden on 17/11/25. Child was produced before the committee-V, Dilshad Garden on 16/11/25. DD entry was lodged at P.S. Patpat ganj Industrial area DD no: 008 A dated 16/11/25. At the time of arrival, she was weared dark yellow colored t-shirt gray colored warmer upper and lower, blue white, violet woolen cap and gray shoes She is a Normal child.	
13	Name- Monika (Told by minor) female child around 3 years old. found abandoned/missing at Anand Vihar Railway station and then transferred to DCCW/PALNA via order of CWC-V-Dilshad Garden on 29/12/25 along with her sibling Anshika . Child was produced before the committee on 29/12/25. DD entry was lodged at Anand Vihar Railway station on 26/12/25 GD no: 0042 A. At the time of arrival, she was wearing white frock with gray flower print, gray inner warmer, greenish yellow gray yellow jacket, blue colored shoes, black thread in a neck wand waist. Normal child. Both Monika and Anshika are siblings.	
14	Name - Anshika (Told by minor) female child around 5years old. found abandoned/missing at Anand Vihar Railway station and then transferred to DCCW/PALNA via order of CWC-V-Dilshad Garden on 29/12/25 along with her sibling Monika. Child was produced before the committee on 29/12/25. DD entry was lodged at Anand Vihar Railway station on 26/12/25 GD no: 0042 A. At the time of arrival, she was weared red & whitewarm t-shirt blue denim top and jeans, red clored half sweater. Brown, orange sandal. Normal child. Both Monika and Anshika are siblings.	
Note: Parents/Guardians/Relatives in case of children at S. no. 11 to 14 may contact at address/phone numbers given below:- 1. Incharge: Delhi Council for Child Welfare (PALNA) , Qudsia Bagh,Yamuna Marg. Civil Lines, Delhi-54 Contact No. 011-23968907/ 7303486155 2. District Child Protection Unit-11 (District North East) Department of Women and Child Development. Sanskar Ashram complex, Dilshad Garden.		
15	A boy child named Krishna , about Seven years old and whitish in complexion was found on 12/12/2025 by Women and Child Helpline staff Bharti, at the New Delhi Railway Station in Delhi. After initial examination, the child was presented before the Child Welfare Committee-III at Sewa Kutir Complex, Kingsway Camp. Delhi on 12/12/2025. As per the Committee's order, he was placed in the Sathi Open Shelter Home, Paharganj, Delhi, for care and protection. At the time of admission, he was wearing a white Hoodie and blue pants.A general diary entry; GD No. 0009A, dated 12/12/2025, regarding the child's recovery was recorded at the Police Station. Police Station GRP New Delhi Railway Station. District Central Delhi.	
Note: for more information the Parents/Guardians/Relatives of the above child,, at Sr. no. 15. may contact the address/phone numbers for further information: 9540618618		
1. SATI 11 Open Shelter Home Deshbandhu Gupta Marg Paharganj, New Delhi.		
2. District Child Protection Unit [DCPU] Sewa Kulir, Delhi 110009, and delhicentraldcpu@gmail.com		
16	Name: Christina (name given by parents), Age: Approximately 9 years (as on 08.07.2022), Complexion: Fair. It is hereby informed that on 08.07.2022, the above- mentioned child was found abandoned on the roadside in the Timarpur area of Delhi. In this regard, a General Diary entry vide GD No. 0095A dated 08.07.2022 was recorded at Police Station Timarpur, Delhi. The child was subsequently produced before the Child Welfare Committee-III, Kingsway Camp, Delhi. As per the orders of the Hon'ble Committee, the child Christina was placed under care and protection at Kikari Rainbow Home, Kashmire Gate, Delhi. At the time of admission, the child was wearing a white T- shirt and blue pants. It has now been confirmed that the child's mother has been missing for approximately 11 years, and the father is unable to take care of the child. Therefore, the father has submitted a request before the Hon'ble Child Welfare Committee (CWC) Court for placing the child for adoption. Any person having any information or claim regarding the child is requested to contact the Child Welfare Committee-III, Kingsway Camp, Delhi within 15 days from date of publication of this notice. Claims received after the stipulated period shall not be considered.	
Note:- Parents/Guardiams/Relatives of abovementioned child, at Sr. no. 16. may contact at address/phone number given as:		
1. Village cottage home 1 & III Kasturba niketan Complex, Lajpat nagar- II, New Delhi- 110024. Con. No. 011-29810675		
2. District Child Protection Officer , DCPU- III (South), Kasturba Niketan complex, Lajpat Nagar- II. New Delhi- 110024, 011-20887340		
17	Name: Shahnaz@Tahir , Age: 9 years, Father's name : Ishtiyakh. Mother's name - Unknown, Complexion: White; Gender: Male. The child was found abandoned in Andrews Ganj bus stop. He was produced before Child Welfare Committee-II, Lajpat Nagar on 10/04/2024 by police and with the order of the Child Welfare Committee, he has been kept in Village Cottage Home - I & III, Kasturba Niketan Complex, Lajpat Nagar - II, New Delhi for Care and Protection with DD No. 0039A, PS Defence Colony, New Delhi.	
Note: Parents/Guardians/Relatives of above-mentioned child, at Sr. no. 17 .may contact at address/phone number given as:		
1. Village cottage home 1 & III Kasturba niketan Complex, Lajpat nagar - II. New Delhi- 110024. Con. No. 011-29810675		
2. District Child Protection Officer , DCPU- III (South), Kasturba Niketan Complex. Lajpat Nagar-II. New Delhi- 110024. 011-20887340		
18	Name : Jyoti , Age: 8 years, Complexion: Fair. Gender: Female, Father's Name: Vicky and Mother's Name: Nanny. Child was found Abandoned in Sangam Vihar, Delhi. On 15.08.2022. Child was produced before the Child Welfare Committee, Kalkaji and by their order placed in the Village Cottage Home -III for care and protection.	
Note: Parents/Guardians/Relatives of above mentioned child, at Sr. no. 18, may contact at address/phone number given below:-		
1. Village Cottage Home -III, Kasturba Niketan Complex, Lajpat Nagar - II , New Delhi-110024. Contact no.: 011-20887340 . Email.VCIII2kalkaji@gmail.com		
2. District Child Protection Unit-VIII (South-East) , Kasturba Niketan Complex, Lajpat Nagar-11. New Delhi-110024, Ph. No.-011-20887340. Email: depu8southeast@gmail.com		
SD/-Director Department of Women & Child Development		
Please give information to CHILDLINE 1098 about Children who need care and protection.		
Sd/- Deputy Director Child Protection Unit Deptt. of WCD, GNCTD NEW DELHI		
DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0075/26-27		



Iran denounces US airstrikes amid peace talks

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Dubai

Iran on Tuesday denounced US strikes a day earlier as a sign of “bad faith and unreliability” as negotiations continue toward a possible deal to end the war.

The US military has characterised on Monday's strikes in southern Iran as defensive, saying targets included missile launch sites and boats placing mines, and said the US acted with “restraint” in light of the weeklong ceasefire. Iran's foreign ministry called the strikes a ceasefire violation and warned that Washington would bear responsibility for “all consequences”, without details.

The Islamic Republic of Iran will leave no act of aggression unanswered,” it added in a statement.

Iran's Revolutionary Guard on Tuesday said it had shot down and deterred drones and a fighter jet that entered its airspace, according to Iran's official *Mizan news agency*, which did not specify when the incident occurred.

It wasn't immediately clear what the developments



Donald Trump salutes during the playing of taps at the 158th National Memorial Day in Arlington

would mean for negotiations. The strikes came after Iranian parliament speaker Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf went to Qatar as part of the talks, which US President Donald Trump said Monday were “proceeding nicely”.

The strikes were the latest flare-up in the fragile ceasefire that began April 7 and has largely held. Negotiations centre in part on the Strait of Hormuz, the crucial waterway off southern Iran through which a fifth of the world's crude oil and natural gas passed before the war

began with US-Israeli strikes in February. Tehran retaliated by effectively closing the strait, stranding hundreds of ships and shocking the global economy.

The strait has become a powerful lever for Tehran in talks, joining the long-running issue of Iran's nuclear programme and highly enriched uranium. Iran in turn wants the US to lift its military blockade of Iranian ports that began on April 17.

The strait also is cause for growing concern as supplies

NOT IN FAVOUR OF PAKISTAN JOINING ABRAHAM ACCORDS: DEFENCE MINISTER

Islamabad: Pakistan's Defence Minister Khawaja Asif has said that he was not in favour of Islamabad joining the Abraham Accords to normalise relations with Israel. His comments came after US President Donald Trump asked countries involved in the peace talks with Iran to sign on to the Abraham Accords, which deal with establishing diplomatic and security ties between Israel and Arab nations. “Personally, I don't think we should join any such accord which clashes with our fundamental ideologies,” Asif said during an interview on a talk show with Samaa TV on Monday night. Among the negotiators, the UAE and Bahrain are already members of the Accords, and Trump expects Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Pakistan, Turkey, Egypt and Jordan to sign up. Pakistan's

defence minister also talked about his country's long-standing position to not accept Israel until the Palestinian state on the pre-1967 borders with East Jerusalem as its capital is established. “We have a very clear stance that it is not acceptable to us,” he said. The minister also highlighted the question of credibility. “How will you sit with those people whose word cannot be trusted for even a single day?” he asked. He also mentioned Pakistan's passport, which says it is not valid for travel to Israel. Asif is among the politicians who vehemently oppose any idea of normalisation of ties with the Jewish state. Last month, he called Israel a “curse for humanity”, while accusing it of carrying out genocide in the region.

of fertilizer are also badly affected for vulnerable global farmers. “What we are witnessing today is not only a geopolitical crisis, it is a sys-

temic shock to the global agrifood system,” the director-general of the UN's Food and Agriculture Organization, Qu Dongyu, said Tuesday.

17 Indian-origin men held in Canada for extortion

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Ottawa

Canadian police have arrested 17 persons, believed to be of Indian origin, for their alleged involvement in extortion and organised crime targeting South Asian business owners and community members in the region.

The Extortion Task Force of the Peel Police “dismantled a coordinated campaign of intimidation, threats, and escalating violence used to extort local businesses”, according to a press release issued by the Peel Regional Police on its official website.

The majority of the arrested individuals have ties to an international criminal network known as 'For Brothers', which targeted South Asian business owners and community members across the region in Canada and the United States, it said. The organised criminal network was believed to have been active in Brampton, Mississauga, Caledon, and British Columbia, with links to California, it added.

“We recognize the fear and harm this has caused, particularly within the South Asian community, and remain committed to put a stop to these crimes and keep our communities safe,” Chief Nishan Duraippah, Peel Regional Police, was quoted as saying in the release. The 17 individuals were arrested in April 2026 after a joint investigation



was launched in December 2025 by the Canadian police, security agencies, and the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) of the United States.

The accused are connected to 24 incidents, including 16 violent incidents associated with 'For Brothers'. Six individuals charged by Peel Regional Police may face immigration action, including possible removal from the country, after their criminal cases are finished, police said. During the investigation, police also seized six firearms, illicit drugs, multiple cell phones, SIM cards and fraudulent identification cards.

Police said that the investigation in the case is still ongoing and further arrests are anticipated.

The accused were identified as Iqbal Singh Bhagria, Akashdeep Singh, Ravinder Singh, Jashanbir Singh, Dilawarpreet Singh, Mandeep Singh, Prabhdeep Sohal, Partapbir Ghuman, Ajaydeep Singh, Navroop Singh, Rajan Singh, Amritjot Singh, Jashanpreet Singh, Guneet Guneet, Sukhwinder Singh, Mohinder Singh and Gautam.

Request for Bid

Online bids are invited from the intending bidders for the following tender:

- **Tender Title:** Engineering, Procurement and Construction of Wash Centre at Mahi Miri, Kaziranga.
- Estimated cost: INR 10 crore.
- The last date of submission of tender document is 18/06/2026 which has to be submitted through the Assam Tenders portal only.

The detailed tender document may be downloaded from the Assam Tenders portal i.e The bid reference number is: <https://assamtenders.gov.in> SBMG/Mahi/Miri/26.03 from 27/05/2026.

**Sd/-
Chief Engineer, (PHE), Sanitation, Assam
DIPRC/PIO/63/27-MAY-26 Betkuchi, Guwahati-35**

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, KANCHAN LATA D/O BALDHARI RAM and W/O KAMLESH KUMAR permanently residing at VILL- AKHARCHANDA POST- MAHARAJGANJ, SAGRI, AZAMGARH, UTTAR PRADESH-276137 presently residing at E-199, FIRST FLOOR, J J COLONY RAGHUBIR NAGAR, NEW DELHI-110027, have changed the name of minor daughter KAMINI alias KAMINI KAUSHAL, aged 16yrs and she shall hereafter be known as KAAMINI KAUSHAL. It is certified that I have complied with other legal requirements in this connection.

CHANGE OF NAME

It is for general information that I, Lt. Col. Bhupinder Singh Sabharwal S/o Major Ram Singh R/o Flat No.-802, Tower-8, Vipul Greens, Sector- 48, Sohna Road, Gurgoan, declare that name of my wife has been wrongly written as Jagjeet Sabharwal in my Service documents and PPO No. M/003551/92. The actual name of my wife is Jagjeet Kaur which may be amended accordingly.

ReNew Solar Energy (Jharkhand Three) Private Limited					
CIN No. : U40300DL2016PTC301311					
Regd. Office : 138, Ansal Chambers II, Bikaji Cama Place, Delhi-110066					
Corporate Office : ReNew.hub, Commercial Block-1, Zone-6, Golf Course Road, DLF City Phase-V, Gurugram, 122009, Haryana, Phone – 0124-4896 670/ 80					
Statement of Financial Results for the quarter and year ended 31 March 2026					
(Amounts in INR millions, except share and per share data, unless otherwise stated)					
Particulars	Quarter ended 31 March 2026	Quarter ended 31 December 2025	Quarter ended 31 March 2025	Year ended 31 March 2026	Year ended 31 March 2025
	(Refer note 7)	(Unaudited)	(Refer note 7)	(Audited)	(Audited)
Total Income from Operations	439	412	451	1,746	1,793
Net (Loss)/ Profit for the year (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	87	66	161	368	479
Net (Loss)/ Profit for the year before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	87	66	161	368	479
Net (Loss)/ Profit for the year after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	67	40	106	261	276
Total Comprehensive Income for the year (Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax))	112	(64)	1	201	171
Paid up Equity Share Capital	170	170	170	170	170
Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)	1,733	1,706	1,472	1,733	1,472
Securities premium	997	997	997	997	997
Net worth	1,903	1,875	1,641	1,903	1,641
Paid up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt	9,267	10,077	10,087	9,267	10,087
Debt Equity Ratio	3.26	3.58	3.81	3.26	3.81
Earnings Per Share (of Rs. 10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)					
1. Basic :	3.96	2.38	6.22	15.34	16.24
2. Diluted :	1.93	1.16	3.03	7.96	8.65
Debtenture Redemption Reserve	2	-	-	2	-
Debt Service Coverage Ratio*	0.83	1.18	1.37	0.94	1.05
Interest Service Coverage Ratio*	1.61	1.79	2.15	1.82	1.93
Current ratio*	1.99	1.27	1.05	1.99	1.05
Long Term Debt to Working Capital*	4.45	10.42	12.22	4.45	12.22
Current Liability Ratio*	0.12	0.15	0.25	0.12	0.25
Total Debts to Total Assets Ratio*	0.65	0.63	0.59	0.65	0.59
Debtors Turnover Ratio*	4.78	2.44	4.24	9.08	8.98
Inventory Turnover Ratio*	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Operating margin (%)	60%	53%	59%	57%	53%
Net profit margin (%)	15%	10%	23%	15%	15%

*not annualised

Additional disclosures pursuant to Regulations 52(4), 54(3) and 63(2) of Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (as amended) :

Notes :

1. Ratios have been computed as follows :
 - Earning per share = Profit after Tax / Weighted average number of equity shares
 - Debt Equity Ratio* = Debt (Total Debt payable to lender) / Equity (Equity share capital, share premium, loan from Related party)
 - Interest Service Coverage Ratio* = Profit before interest, tax and depreciation / Total Interest Expense.
 - Current Ratio* = Current Assets/ Current Liabilities
 - Long Term Debt to Working Capital* = Non- Current borrowing including current maturities of Non-current borrowings/ (Current Assets - Current Liabilities excluding current maturities of Non-current borrowings)
 - Bad debts to Accounts Receivable ratio* = Bad debts / Average Trade receivables and Average unbilled Revenue
 - Current Liability Ratio* = Current Liabilities/ Total Liabilities
 - Total Debts to total Assets* = Total outstanding debts/ Total Assets
 - Debtors turnover= Revenue from operation/ Average trade receivables and Average unbilled Revenue
 - Inventory Turnover = Not applicable
 - Operating margin(%)= (Profit before tax + Finance costs - Other income)/ Revenue from operations
 - Debt Service Coverage Ratio* = (PAT (excluding non-cash adjustments, if any)+ Depreciation+ Interest (Interest, Guarantee Fees, other financing costs payable under Debtenture and Project Documents)) / (Interest + Principal Repayment only (schedule repayment) guarantee fee).
 - Net profit Margin= Net Profit after tax /Revenue from operations
2. The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly financial results filed with the Stock Exchange(s) under regulation 52 of the Listing Regulations. The full format of the quarterly financial results is available on the website of National Stock Exchange of India Limited and the listed entity URL(s) (<https://www.bseindia.com>).
3. For the other line items referred in Regulation 52(4) of the SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015, the pertinent disclosures have been made to the National Stock Exchange of India Limited and can be accessed on the URLs (<https://www.bseindia.com>).
4. The statement has been prepared in accordance with recognition and measurement principles laid down in accordance with the Indian Accounting Standard as prescribed under Section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013 (the 'Act') read with Rule 3 of the Companies (Indian Accounting Standards) Rules, 2015 and relevant rules issued thereunder and other recognized accounting practices and policies.
5. The company is in the business of development and operation of solar power. There is only one segment (business and/ or geographical) in accordance with the requirements of IND AS - 108 "Operating Segments".
-

Israeli strike kills 12 in east Lebanon village

KAREEM CHEHAYEB ■ Beirut

An Israeli airstrike on a village in eastern Lebanon killed 12 people, State media said on Tuesday, as an Israeli official said the military had called up more troops to Lebanon.

The strike hit the village of Mashghara in the Bekaa Valley late Monday, according to Lebanon's state-run National News Agency.

It came after Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said that he had authorised more intensive strikes targeting the Hezbollah militant group across Lebanon. The Israeli military did not comment on this particular strike, but said on Monday that it was



targeting Hezbollah infrastructure in eastern Lebanon.

An Israeli security official said the military had called up an additional battalion to Lebanon. The official spoke on condition of anonymity in line with regulations. Rescue workers say that a dozen bodies were pulled out of the rubble following an intense

wave of overnight strikes targeting swaths of southern and eastern Lebanon.

The intensified attacks come three days before Lebanese and Israeli military delegations are set to meet in Washington for direct talks. Hezbollah is attacking Israeli troops in southern Lebanon and northern Israeli

towns, and has vowed to continue fighting until Israel stops its daily airstrikes and withdraws its troops from the country.

In recent weeks, Hezbollah has boasted that it is using new fibre-optic drones that Israeli troops have struggled to intercept, hitting both Israeli troops and northern border villages.

Israel has updated its defensive guidelines in line with the recent developments in its northern areas, telling people not to gather in large numbers.

"What this requires of us now is to increase the blows, to increase the intensity.

We will smite them hip and thigh," Netanyahu said in a video posted on social

media Monday ahead of the strikes. The Lebanese Government hopes that the direct talks with Israel, opposed by Hezbollah, will lead to a ceasefire.

Over a million people in Lebanon have been displaced in the war, which was sparked by Hezbollah firing rockets into northern Israel on March 2 in solidarity with Iran.

3,185 people in Lebanon have been killed in Israeli strikes since the start of the war, according to the Lebanese Health Ministry. Over 9,600 others have been wounded. The intensified strikes have brought fear in Lebanon of a renewed full-scale war, leaving the capital exposed to possible strikes again. (AP)



Muslim pilgrims pray at top of the rocky hill known as the Mountain of Mercy, on the Plain of Arafat, during the annual Hajj pilgrimage near the holy city of Mecca, Saudi Arabia

Muslim pilgrims converge on Arafat for prayers as Haj reaches its peak

**BARAA ANWER/
MARIAM FAM**
■ Arafat

Muslim pilgrims from around the world congregated on Mount Arafat in Saudi Arabia on Tuesday, the second official day of the annual Islamic pilgrimage, considered the pinnacle of Haj. Despite the sweltering heat, the pilgrims gathered on the rocky hill and the surrounding plains for intense prayers that often mark a spiritual peak. Typically, they fervently murmur prayers and pour their hearts out in supplications, asking God for forgiveness, mercy, blessings and

good health. It is common for many pilgrims on that day to raise their hands in worship, with tears streaming down their faces, on the slopes of the rocky hill and in the surrounding area. Haj, one of the Five Pillars of Islam, is required once in a lifetime for every Muslim who can afford it and is physically able to perform it.

For pilgrims, Haj, performed over several days, can be a deeply moving spiritual experience and a chance to seek God's forgiveness and the erasure of past sins. This year, Muslims have been pouring into Saudi Arabia for the Haj

against the backdrop of a tenuous ceasefire in the Iran war and related uncertainty in the region. Haj, one of the Five Pillars of Islam, is required once in a lifetime for every Muslim who can afford it and is physically able to perform it. For pilgrims, Haj, performed over several days, can be a deeply moving spiritual experience and a chance to seek God's forgiveness and the erasure of past sins. (AP)

PUBLIC NOTICE

General Public is hereby informed that my clients Sh. Brij Mohan Sachdeva and his wife Smt. Suman Sachdeva R/O E-230, 11nd Floor, Lajpat Nagar-1, New Delhi have disowned/debarred, their son Panjaj Sachdeva, his wife Divya Sachdeva and their newly born son Hridyansh Sachdeva due to cruel and immoral behaviour of their daughter in law Divya Sachdeva, from all their movable and immovable properties and other assets and have ceased all their family relations with them by all means and if they commit any act or misdeed in future, any dealings with anyone, they shall be responsible for the same themselves.

Navin Sharma (Advocate) Office:-182-A, Hari Nagar Ashram, Mathura Road, New Delhi-110014, Mobile: 9312942168

PUBLIC NOTICE

Re: Entire Second floor without roof terrace Rights Hereinafter referred to as "said floor" Built-Up Property Bearing No. 3, Built-On land area measuring 180 Sq Mtrs. in Block-B5 (EAST), with its rooftop terrace rights upto sky, shown in the layout plan of Shalimar Bagh Residential Scheme, Shalimar Bagh, Delhi; Hereinafter referred to as "said property".

NOTICE is hereby given to general public that our client, Mr. Manoj Jain (hereinafter called the "owner") is the absolute owner of the said floor in the Gift Deed dated 07.12.2019 executed by Mr. Narinder Prasad Jain & Mr. Vinod Kumar Jain, registered as Document No. 18128. It has been informed further that initially Mr. Narinder Prasad Jain was the owner of the said property vide Perpetual Lease Deed dated 02.07.1981 and thereafter he has sold his undivided share to Mr. Vinod Kumar Jain vide a GPA, ATS & Will dated 22.01.2000. After that Conveyance Deed dated 24.03.2000 has been executed jointly in favour of Mr. Narinder Prasad Jain & Mr. Vinod Kumar Jain. Finally, both of them has gifted the said floor in favour of our client as mentioned above. The said owner has also informed that the said floor is not mortgage anywhere and there is no dispute or any litigation pending upon the said floor.

Any person including Banks/, Financial Institution/s, relative/s having any claim, right, title or any interest of any nature whatsoever into or upon the said floor is hereby called upon to make the same known, in writing, with documentary evidence, by Registered AD Post, to the undersigned at the address mentioned herein below within 07 days of publication of this notice and in the event of no response having been received to the notice, the title of the owner in respect of the said floor shall be deemed to be clear of any charge or encumbrance of any nature whatsoever and any subsequent claim shall not bind our client/owner, in any manner whatsoever.

Shivkant Arora, Advocate
For M/s Intelective Law Offices
A-74, LGF, Defence Colony,
New Delhi-110024

Pak's Punjab Govt defers road renaming to avoid extremists

M ZULQERNAIN ■ Lahore

Giving in to the pressure of some "extremist elements," Pakistan's Punjab Government has deferred its plan to restore original historical names of roads and several streets in Lahore aimed at reviving the city's pre-Partition heritage, an official said on Tuesday.

The Lahore Heritage Areas Revival (LAHR), in its recently held meeting, jointly presided over by PML-N President and three-time former prime minister Nawaz Sharif and his daughter, Punjab Chief Minister Maryam Nawaz, gave approval to the restoration of original historical names of roads and streets in Lahore and its neighbour-hood.

North Korea launches ballistic missile

**HYUNG-JIN KIM/
KIM TONG-HYUNG**
■ Seoul

North Korea launched a close-range ballistic missile and other weapons toward the sea on Tuesday, South Korea's military said, days after the leaders of Russia and China voiced their opposition to Western pressures on North Korea.

The missile fired from Jongju, a city near the North's west coast, flew about 80 kilometres (50 miles), South Korea's Joint Chiefs of Staff said. North Korea launched other kinds of projectiles, it said, but didn't elaborate.

South Korean media, citing the military, reported that the other weapons systems mobilised included multiple rocket launch systems. The reports said that the simultaneous launches of different kinds



of weapons were likely meant to test the ability to evade South Korean and US defences. South Korea's military said that it closely monitors activities in North Korea. It said that South Korea, with a solid alliance with the US, maintains a readiness to repel any provocations by North Korea.

It was North Korea's first weapons launch event since April 19, when

the country fired multiple short-range missiles in what state media described as a demonstration of cluster bomb warheads.

North Korean leader Kim Jong Un has focused on modernising his nuclear and missile arsenals since

his nuclear diplomacy with US President Donald Trump collapsed in 2019. In recent years, Kim has expanded ties with Russia by sending troops and conventional arms to support its war efforts against Ukraine. Kim has also pushed to cement cooperation with China, North Korea's economic pipeline. In their summit in Beijing last week, Russian President Vladimir Putin and Chinese President Xi Jinping expressed their opposition to "foreign policy isolation, economic sanctions, military pressure and other methods of creating threats to the security" of North Korea, according to a statement from the Kremlin. (AP)

IS 15700 : 2018

उत्तर प्रदेश आवास एवं विकास परिषद

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता-गाजियाबाद वृत्त, वसुन्धरा काम्प्लेक्स, सेक्टर-16ए, वसुन्धरा, गाजियाबाद.

दूरभाष सं० 0120-4133277, ई-मेल-circle7@upavp.com

पत्र सं०- 1723 /ENG-4B/61 दिनांक :- 25/05/2026

ई-निविदा सूचना
कार्यालय पत्र संख्या- 1722/ENG-4B/60 दिनांक 25.05.2026 के माध्यम से गाजियाबाद वृत्त के अन्तर्गत, सिद्धार्थ विहार योजना, गाजियाबाद एवं अजन्तापुरम योजना, गाजियाबाद में विविध कार्यों हेतु टू-बिड पद्धति पर ई-निविदा आमंत्रित की गयी है। निविदा सम्बंधित विस्तृत विवरण, नियम व शर्तें, परिषद की वेबसाइट [\(अजय कुमार मित्तल\)
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता](http://upavp.in/राज्य सूचना केन्द्र (NIC) की वेबसाइट http://etender.up.nic.in पर देखी जा सकती है।</p></div><div data-bbox=)

The Pioneer Classified

LOST & FOUND

I, Siddhaarth Suri S/o Sudhir Suri R/o A-1, Derawal Nagar, Model Town II, North West Delhi-110009 I have lost my Property Papers (Agreement of Sale) on 15-05-2026, If found any one please contact to my Address.

PD(1179)C

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Vijay Kumar S/O Ramkishor, R/o- E-24/38, Jai Bharti Camp, East Vinod Nagar Delhi-110091 have changed the name of my minor son Aadarsh aged 13 years and he shall hereafter be known as Aadarsh Kumar.

PD(1180)C

I, hitherto known as Mayank Khatri alias Mayank S/O Dharmender Khatri R/O House No. 390, Near MCD School, VPO Bankner, Narela, North West Delhi-110040, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Mayank Khatri.

PD(1181)C

I, MOHD ALI S/o Abdul Bari R/o C-68, Gali No.-14, Madanpur Khadar, New Delhi-110076 have changed my name from MOHD ALI to MD ALI. Henceforth, I would be known by the name of MD ALI for all future purposes

PD(1182)C

I, SHABISHTA W/o MD ALI R/o C-68, Gali No.-14, Madanpur Khadar, New Delhi-110076 have changed my name from SHABISHTA to SHABISTA. Henceforth, I would be known by the name of SHABISTA for all future purposes.

PD(1183)C

I, Roshni W/o No.16014357K Hav Dipendra Singh, R/o- Vill- Chak Paigambarpur, PO- Sidawan, Teh- Bhaahuva, Dist- Fatehpur, U.P- 212655, have changed my name from Roshni to Roshni Singh, vide affidavit dated 26/05/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

PD(1184)C

I, Shah Naj Begum W/o No.16023436A Nk Nishar Khan, R/o- Vill & PO- Chomho, Teh- Ater, Dist- Bhind, M.P- 477111, have changed my name from Shah Naj Begum to Shahana Begum, vide affidavit dated 26/05/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

PD(1185)C

I, Satveri Devi Mother of JC-473136A Sub Vinod Kumar, R/o- VPO- Jalokhari, Teh- Gabhana, Dist- Aligarh, U.P- 202155, have changed my name from Satveri Devi to Satviri, vide affidavit dated 26/05/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

PD(1186)C

I, Lok Maya Thapa Mother of No.15797375Y L/Hav Bhuvan Thapa, R/o- Vill- Pragati Vihar, Post- Selaqui, Teh- Vikas Nagar, Dist- Dehradun, Uttarakhand- 248011, have changed my name from Lok Maya Thapa to Look Maya, vide affidavit dated 26/05/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

PD(1187)C

I, Kiran Thakur Mother of No.16026336A Nk Ankit Singh Thakur R/o- Mangrola, PO- Chintaman Jawasia, Teh & Dist- Ujjain M.P- 456006 have changed my name from Kiran Thakur to Kiran Bai, vide affidavit dated 26/05/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

PD(1188)C

I, Sharthak Kumar Singh S/o JC-473508A Sub Manoj Kumar Singh, R/o- Vill- Hirapur, PO- Hathi Bazar, Teh/Dist- Varanasi, U.P- 221405, have changed my name from Sharthak Kumar Singh to Sarthak Kumar Singh, vide affidavit dated 26/05/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

PD(1189)C

I, No.18015224M Hav Vishal Kumar, R/o- Vill- Bhadaura, Post- Rasulpur Rohta, Teh- Sadar, Dist- Meerut, U.P- 250502, have changed my mother's name from Kamlesh Devi to Kamla Devi and in my service record my mother's D.O.B. is wrongly mentioned as 01/05/1962 instead of her correct D.O.B. 01/05/1975 vide affidavit dated 26/05/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

PD(1190)C

I, No.15424154L Hav Pawar A L, Unit- Army Hospital R&R, Delhi Cantt- 110010, have changed my daughter's name in my service record from Ayushi to Ayushi Apparao Pawar, vide affidavit dated 26/05/2026 before notary public Delhi.

PD(1191)C

I, No.15255532W Hav (CLK SD) Akshay Kumar, R/o- VPO- Nanagwas, Teh- Neemrana, Dist- Alwar, Rajasthan- 301704, have changed my daughter's name from Deepthi to Deepthi Yadav, vide affidavit dated 26/05/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

PD(1192)C

I, No.15424154L Hav Pawar A L, Unit- Army Hospital R&R, Delhi Cantt- 110010, have changed my son's name in my service record from Yash to Pawar Yash Apparao, vide affidavit dated 26/05/2026 before notary public Delhi.

PD(1193)C

I, Manu Yadav D/o Ram Kishun, R/o B-12-C/101, Ground Floor, M.B. Road, Vishwakarma Colony, Jaitpur, South Delhi, Delhi-110044, declare that "Manu" and "Manu Yadav" are one and the same person.

PD(1194)C

Public Notice

This is to inform the general public that Ram Nareish is the owner of Plot, Araji No. 1747 (Old) Araji No. 2676 (New), area measuring 93 Sq. Mtr., Situated at Village- Hussainganj, Pargana, Tehsil & District- Fatehpur through Gift Deed dated 18.05.2026 doc. no. 7560 executed by Chhotel in favour of Ram Nareish. The owner has mispled the (1) Original Sale Deed dated 09.05.2001 doc. no. 2342 executed by Bhullu Devi in favour of Ram Singh in respect of Plot, Araji No. 1747, area measuring 94 Sq. Mtr., Situated at Village- Hussainganj, Pargana, Tehsil & District- Fatehpur for which complaint is regd. vide Application No.- 20260000492437, registered at P.S. Police Computer Center, Technical Services HQ, Lucknow, on 26.05.2026. Anyone who finds the above-mentioned documents is requested to handover the same to the Manager of Axis Finance Ltd., Lucknow. Ram Nareish is in the process of mortgaging the said property with Axis Finance Limited. Any objections or concerns regarding this transaction should be raised within a period of 10 days from the date of this public notice. Any objections submitted after the completion of this 10-days period will not be considered binding with respect to the said property or the interests of our client. If anyone wishes to raise an objection, please do so within the stipulated 10-days period by contacting Law Veritas: North (Advocates & Legal Consultants) at Office No. 11, 1st Floor, Building No. A-44A, Sector-16, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301; Landline(s): +91012-04499711, e-mail: accounts@lvnorth.in

Public Notice

This is to inform the general public that Sandeep Logistics India Pvt. Ltd. are the Owner of the Property i.e., Part of bearing Khewat no. 406, Khata no. 437, Mtu. no. 27 and Kila no. 172 (2-3), 173 (0-10), 181 (6-3), measuring 9K-15M and Khewat no. 497, Khata no. 528, Mtu. no. 27, Kila no. 182(1) (0-18), 191/1/1 (2-5), measuring 3K-3M, Total measuring 12K-18M Situated at Waka Moja Baghola, Tehsil and District Palwal through Sale Deed dated 10.01.2025 doc. no. 11953 executed by Chandar Bhan and Sanjay Sethi in favour of Sandeep Logistics India Pvt. Ltd. through its Signatory Deepak Kumar. Sandeep Logistics India Pvt. Ltd. are in the process of mortgaging the said Property with Hero Fincorp Limited. Any objections or concerns regarding this transaction should be raised within a period of 7 days from the date of this public notice. Any objections submitted after the completion of this 7-day period will not be considered binding with respect to the said property or the interests of our client. If anyone wishes to raise an objection, please do so within the stipulated 7-day period by contacting Law Veritas: North (Advocates & Legal Consultants) at Office No. 11, 1st Floor, Building No. A-44A, Sector-16, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301; Landline(s): +91012-04499711, e-mail: accounts@lvnorth.in

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Open E- Tender Notice

For and on behalf of President of India, Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer (Chg.), Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites open e-tender on "SINGLE PACKET SYSTEM" for following work from experienced and capable tenders.

1. Name of Work	Repair of Automatic Twist Locks at Wagon Care Centre, Tughlakabad for Two years
2. Work Place	Delhi (TKD)
3. Period of Work	Twenty four (24) Months
4. Advertised Value	Rs. 32,37,780.00 /- (including provision of GST)
5. Earnest Money to be deposited	Rs. 64,800.00/-, through net banking or gateway only
6. Tender Document Cost	[Nil]
7. Date and Time availability of E-Tender Document	From 25.05.2026 to 16.06.2026 at 12:00 hrs
8. Date and time of E-tender Closing	16.06.2026 12:00 hrs
9. Date and time of E-tender opening	On 25.05.2026 after 17:32 hrs, if the date of opening happens to be holiday then E-Tender shall be opened on the next working day
10. Place for opening E-Tender	Mechanical Department, Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi-55

Note: The complete particulars of the tender may be found in website www.ireps.gov.in No. NR/DL/10MC/NW/2026 Date: 25.05.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 1774/26

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE					
SR NO.	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT
1	PWD B&R, KARNAL	CONST. OF PHC AT VILLAGE KHEWRA, RAI DISTT. SONIPAT (PDG. ELV SERVICES) + 6 WORKS	23.05.2026 29.05.2026	160.54 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, HISAR	DNIT FOR THE WORK OF WATERPROOF, CRACK SEALING AND ARRESTING THE LEAKAGE OF WATER AT RUB LC 89 AND LC 60 ON JINDAL CHOWK TO SURYA NAGAR ROAD IN HISAR DISTRICT. + 2 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 29.05.2026	180.14 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in
3	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	REPLACEMENT OF 4 NOS. JOHNSON MAKE LIFTS INSTALLED IN MINI SECRETARIAT AT JIND. + 3 WORKS	25.05.2026 01.06.2026	81.68 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in
4	PWD B&R, JIND	SPECIAL REPAIR OF GOVERNMENT INDUSTRIAL TRAINING INSTITUTE BUILDING AT JULANA IN JIND DISTT.	CLOSING DATE 01.06.2026	69.18 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in
5	PWD B&R, JIND	CONSTRUCTION OF 2 NOS. HOUSES FOR ADDITIONAL DISTRICT AND SESSIONS JUDGE AND 4 NOS. CIVIL JUDGE (SENIOR DIVISION) IN OFFICER COLONY AT JIND IN JIND DISTT.	CLOSING DATE 15.06.2026	518.89 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in
6	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	CONSTRUCTION OF DEIC ON THE FIRST FLOOR OF EXISTING CIVIL HOSPITAL AT ROHTAK IN DISTRICT ROHTAK (PROVIDING BED ELEVATOR ONLY) + 1 WORKS	22.05.2026 29.05.2026	33.72 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in
7	HORTICULTURE DEPARTMENT, BHUNA (FATEHABAD)	E-TENDER NOTICE FOR REPAIRING OF PROTECTED STRUCTURES AT CEG, BHUNA	27.05.2026 18.06.2026	35000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in
8	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, CHARKHI DADRI	REQUIREMENT OF MATERIAL TO BE USED IN THE FLOOD DEWATERING 2026-27	CLOSING DATE 01.06.2026	17.93 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in
9	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	DESCRIPTION OF STORE:- LIST COMPRISING OF ITEMS FROM SR. NO. 01 TO 30 ITEMS (SINGLE LOT OF 30 ITEMS) *.	26.05.2026 01.07.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in dsndharyana.gov.in
10	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	DESCRIPTION OF STORE: - LIST COMPRISING OF ITEMS FROM SR. NO. 01 TO 124 ITEMS (SINGLE LOT OF 124 ITEM)*.	26.05.2026 01.07.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in dsndharyana.gov.in
11	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	DESCRIPTION OF STORE: - LIST COMPRISING OF ITEMS FROM SR. NO. 01 TO 05 ITEMS (SINGLE LOT OF 05 ITEM)*.	26.05.2026 01.07.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in dsndharyana.gov.in
12	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	DESCRIPTION OF STORE: - LIST COMPRISING OF ITEMS FROM SR. NO. 01 TO 206 ITEMS I.E. LIQUID NITROGEN GAS CYLINDER (SINGLE LOT OF 206 ITEMS)*.	26.05.2026 01.07.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in dsndharyana.gov.in
13	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	DESCRIPTION OF STORE:- LIST COMPRISING OF ITEMS FROM SR. NO. 01 TO 01 I.E. FOOT OVER BRIDGE (SINGLE LOT OF 01 ITEM)*.	26.05.2026 01.07.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in dsndharyana.gov.in
14	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	DESCRIPTION OF STORE:- LIST COMPRISING OF ITEMS FROM SR. NO. 01 TO 51 ITEMS (SINGLE LOT OF 51 ITEMS) *.	26.05.2026 01.07.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in dsndharyana.gov.in
15	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	DESCRIPTION OF STORE: - LIST COMPRISING OF ITEMS FROM SR. NO. 01 TO 18 ITEMS (SINGLE LOT OF 18 ITEMS)*.	26.05.2026 01.07.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in dsndharyana.gov.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in

RO 45611-I-27-7

PROSPECT

Khadi, village industries sector crosses ₹1.87 lakh crore in sales



The Khadi and Village Industries sector recorded sales of ₹1,87,105 crore in the financial year 2025-26, surpassing the ₹1.87 lakh crore mark for the first time in its history, according to provisional data released by the Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC) on Tuesday.

KVIC Chairman Manoj Kumar released the figures at Gandhi Darshan, Rajghat, in New Delhi, describing the performance as record-breaking across production, sales, and employment generation. "Compared to 2013-14, we have recorded a growth of 501 per cent in sales, 380 per cent in production, and 56 per cent in employment generation over the last 12 years," Kumar said.

Production figures tell a parallel story. Output stood at ₹26,109 crore in 2013-14. It has risen nearly fivefold to ₹1,25,296 crore in 2025-26, a growth of 380 per cent. On employment, the sector now supports 2.04 crore people, up from 1.30 crore in 2013-14, a 56 per cent increase over 12 years. Within the broader sector, Khadi textiles have shown particularly sharp growth. Production rose from ₹811 crore in 2013-14 to ₹3,974 crore in 2025-26, an increase of approximately 390 per cent. Khadi textile sales grew from ₹1,081 crore to ₹7,869 crore, a jump of approximately 628 per cent.

The village industries segment accounts for the bulk of the sector's overall numbers. Production in this segment grew from ₹25,298 crore in 2013-14 to ₹1,21,322 crore in 2025-26, an increase of approximately 380 per cent. Sales in village industries rose from ₹30,073 crore to ₹1,79,236 crore, representing approximately 496 per cent growth. Employment in village industries alone rose from 1.19 crore to nearly 1.99 crore over the same period.

The Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme added 66,494 new units in 2025-26 alone, with a margin money subsidy of ₹2,457 crore disbursed against loans of ₹7,375 crore. These units generated employment for 7,31,434 people. Cumulatively, since the scheme began, 10,84,679 units have been set up, providing employment to approximately 97.95 lakh people. Women have been central to the sector's growth. Out of the 79,682 trainees who received training under various KVIC programmes in 2025-26, approximately 59 per cent, or 47,382, were women. Under the PMEGP, 28,180 women entrepreneurs established units during the year, creating employment for 3,09,980 women. Women also account for over 80 per cent of the approximately five lakh artisans working in the Khadi sector.

Artisan remuneration has also risen sharply. The rate paid per hank has increased from ₹4 in 2013-14 to ₹15 currently, a rise of approximately 275 per cent. Government procurement of Khadi and Village Industries products reached ₹92.08 crore, while exhibition and marketing sales contributed ₹30.83 crore. Sales of national flags rose from ₹0.87 crore in 2013-14 to ₹2.35 crore in 2025-26.

Under the Gramodyog Vikas Yojana, a total of 3,23,006 machines, toolkits, and equipment have been distributed to artisans since the scheme began, with 37,769 units distributed in 2025-26 alone.

(PNS)

Gadkari reviews quality of national highway projects

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Union Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari on Tuesday reviewed the quality and maintenance progress of National Highway projects covering 4,335 km in Punjab and 3,332 km in Delhi and Haryana, following inputs received through media and social media platforms.

According to an official statement, during the review, Gadkari emphasised the need to accelerate on-ground execution of highway projects and ensure the timely completion of works. He directed officials and contractors to strengthen coordination and maintain strict adherence to project timelines.

The minister stressed the importance of continuous monitoring of project quality and instructed agencies to adopt modern construction technologies and best engineering practices to enhance



asset durability and long-term performance of National Highways.

Gadkari underlined the need to improve riding quality and ensure seamless connectivity across key highway corridors in Punjab, Delhi and Haryana. He directed officials to prioritise high standards in construction and maintenance to provide a safer, smoother and more efficient travel experience

for commuters. He also called for greater accountability in maintenance operations and emphasised regular inspections to identify and address deficiencies in a timely manner.

The minister further directed officials to undertake advance monsoon preparedness measures across all highway stretches.

He also stressed the importance of effective drainage

management, slope protection measures and swift response mechanisms to minimise disruptions during the monsoon season and ensure commuter safety.

Gadkari instructed concerned agencies to remain vigilant and ensure uninterrupted traffic movement by addressing water-logging, erosion and other weather-related challenges proactively.

Coal India arm SECL vows to meet nation's energy needs

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Coal India arm South Eastern Coalfields Ltd's (SECL) CMD Harish Duhan on Tuesday reiterated the company's commitment to fulfilling the nation's energy requirements as power demand hit record highs amid an intense spell of heatwave.



Duhan said during the ongoing financial year 2026-27, SECL has made the highest contribution of 26.86 million tonnes towards Coal India's production milestone of 100 million tonnes achieved so far. He reiterated SECL's commitment towards fulfilling the nation's energy requirements under the guidance of the Coal Ministry, SECL said in a statement.

The company further said Union Minister of State for Coal and Mines Satish Chandra Dubey on Tuesday undertook a one-day visit to SECL's headquarters at Chhattisgarh's Bilaspur, during which he conducted a detailed review of the company's operations and achievements.

Chairing the review meeting at SECL headquarters, the minister reviewed coal production, dispatch, quality management, safety, coal gasification, mine closure, environmental initiatives, digitisation, CSR activities, and future action plans.

The minister stated that SECL is playing a significant role in strengthening the nation's energy security and appreciated the company's efforts in the areas of production, quality, safety and environmental responsibility.

He further stated that through CSR initiatives, priority should be given to ensuring that the benefits of development and welfare schemes reach the last person in the coalfield regions.

K9 warriors steal the show at Exercise PRAGATI 2026

TONY DAS ■ Guwahati

Amid tactical drills and multinational training at Exercise PRAGATI 2026, the Indian Army's four-legged warriors added a distinctive and powerful dimension to the exercise. Army dogs trained alongside troops from friendly foreign countries, showcasing their role in modern military operations and enhancing interoperability in a multinational environment.

From IED detection and tracking to intervention operations, the K9 teams demonstrated how trained military dogs remain an invaluable asset in high-risk operational scenarios. The display included Alan, a Belgian Malinois assault dog; Victor, a Rampur Hound tracker dog; and Deo, a Labrador explosive detection dog. Each showcased a specialised skill set, reflecting the versatility, discipline



and mission readiness of Indian Army K9 teams.

A key highlight was the participation of India's indigenous breed, the Rampur Hound, represented by Victor. Known for climatic adaptability, resilience and disease resistance, indigenous breeds are increasingly being integrated into operational roles, strengthening the Indian Army's move towards self-reliance under Atmanirbhar Bharat.

The K9 warriors also demonstrated their opera-

tional relevance across varied terrains, from deserts to glaciers, underlining their adaptability and effectiveness in diverse conditions. Whether detecting explosives, tracking hostile movement or supporting intervention teams, these dogs bring speed, instinct, courage and loyalty to the battlefield.

The exercise also featured robotic dogs, highlighting the evolving interface between trained animals and emerging technology in future military operations.

Book released at CISF headquarters

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

An inspirational book titled 'Hogi Jai... Hey Purushottam Naveen!', written by CISF AIG (Administration) Jai Prakash Azad, was released at CISF Headquarters by DG CISF Praveer Ranjan.

Inspired by Mahakavi Suryakant Tripathi 'Nirala's renowned poem 'Ram Ki Shakti Puja', the book highlights the importance of inner strength, positivity, patience, and continuous effort in overcoming the challenges, stress, and struggles of modern life.

Through the life, courage, and perseverance of Lord Ram, the book conveys that every individual carries within them the potential of a "Purushottam" — an ideal self capable of facing every obstacle.

Author Jai Prakash Azad clarified that the book is not a retelling of the Ramayana but an attempt to draw inspiration from Lord Ram's values, struggles, discipline, and *karmyog* (path of action)



to guide today's youth toward a more positive and meaningful life. The author has also shared personal experiences in the book, making it more relatable and impactful for readers.

Written in a simple, engaging, and motivational style, the book is expected to serve as a valuable guide for youth and Force personnel alike in building self-confidence, self-awareness, and emotional resilience.

DG CISF Praveer Ranjan said, "'Hogi Jai... Hey Purushottam Naveen!' is an inspiring guide for today's

youth and force personnel living in stressful and challenging times. The book encourages readers to overcome life's difficulties through inner strength, positive thinking, patience, and continuous action. Inspired by Mahakavi Nirala's 'Ram Ki Shakti Puja', this work motivates every individual to awaken the 'Purushottam' within."

Core Message of the Book: "Every person is a unique creation of God. Success is not the privilege of a select few, but the birthright of every individual."

DAILY SUDOKU

			7	8			9
	9		2		6		
	8						5
6				1	3		
	3		4		2		7
			9	7			4
	9					3	
		4		3	2		
5			8	7			

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★☆

HOW TO SOLVE IT

Sudoku is a logic puzzle where you fill a 9x9 grid so that numbers 1 to 9 appear once in every row, column, and 3x3 box, using elimination and logical deduction—no maths involved.



SOLUTION (26.5.26)								
5	8	1	3	9	6	2	4	7
2	7	9	1	5	4	6	8	3
6	3	4	2	7	8	9	5	1
8	9	7	4	2	5	1	3	6
4	1	2	6	8	3	7	9	5
3	6	5	9	1	7	8	2	4
7	2	3	8	4	1	5	6	9
9	5	6	7	3	2	4	1	8
1	4	8	5	6	9	3	7	2

DOUBLE CROSSWORD WEDNESDAY | MAY 27, 2026

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
10						11	
13		14					16
17							
			19				
20	21					22	23
24					25		
27						28	
30							31

ACROSS

- 1 A spare part refitted by soldiers (5)
- 6 Guess as much as approve? (3,2)
- 9 Baby dogs (3-4)
- 10 He'll be prepared to reconnoitre (5)
- 11 Imitating a sound (5)
- 12 Sends a manuscript out when there's trouble (5)
- 13 Animal that can make the vet reel! (7)
- 15 The kid laid one out (3)
- 17 In the end, I'll get a girl (4)
- 18 Met, for instance, Old Bill (6)
- 19 At a certain point, a Frenchman will start afresh (5)

DOWN

- 2 Location of an ache, possibly (6)
- 3 Was rude to a bus-man! (6)
- 4 It's almost a toss-up whether he's drunk or not (3)
- 5 Waste fluid? (5)
- 6 Just the bird to broadcast about a divisive barrier? (7)
- 7 Poisonous apple core consumed by a donkey (4)
- 8 Battle of broken lances (6)
- 12 Satisfied a fellow in measured manner (5)
- 13 Let a learner have respite! (5)
- 14 Woman attacked by Ted (5)
- 20 A seasoned couple (6)
- 22 River woman (4)
- 24 In general, it's a long time (3)
- 25 Should it come after the movie? (7)
- 26 Look displeased with the vessel on the left (5)
- 27 Revolutionary name for a tram, perhaps (5)
- 28 Simon, the masterly fellow! (5)
- 29 It's cooked in ovens and eaten (7)
- 30 The Avenger's horse? (5)
- 31 Thomas wrote in heady language (5)
- 15 To the Spanish, a political label is something illegal! (5)
- 16 Exclude new bread (5)
- 18 Her grey matter is a shining example (5)
- 19 Responded with care, perhaps, to Edward (7)
- 21 Downright hard-hearted bombast! (6)
- 22 Recital that brightened up no particular individual (6)
- 23 Something like a cloud in the sky (6)
- 25 Tip-top farm cart or two (5)
- 26 Be exceptionally thrifty? (4)
- 28 Like the cons of today? (3)

SOLUTION (26.5.26)

- ACROSS
8. Undoing
 9. Pipe dream
 13. Dwell
 14. Class
 15. Reserve
 16. R-elapse
 17. Serve
 18. Ex-tra
 20. Drive
 22. Dig-it's
 23. Topper
 25. Mi-nno-ws
- DOWN
1. Un-veil
 2. Col-lap-se
 3. Knocked down
 4. Firs-t rate
 5. Hear-ten
 6. Brassed off
 7. Fair
 10. Ad-or-ed
 11. Pass-age
 12. Rep-air
 19. Tape-red
21. I-m-it-ate
24. For-in-stance
26. Non-starter
28. Re-present
29. Oli-Erma
30. Creeps
32. Shutters
33. Sup-per
34. Past-i-me
38. Keeper
40. Even

Tata Sons board meet concludes in Mumbai

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

A board meeting of Tata Sons, the holding company of the salt-to-software conglomerate, concluded on Tuesday.

Directors of the board, including Tata Trusts' chairman Noel Tata, arrived at its headquarters Bombay House in the morning and left in the late afternoon.

N Chandrasekaran, the chairman of the group, did not speak to the waiting media on the decisions at the board meeting while exiting the group headquarters in South Mumbai. A discussion on Chandrasekaran's reappointment was unlikely at the board meeting, which comes amid rising frictions within the Tata group.

Chandrasekaran and Tata Trusts chairman Noel Tata, who is a nominee director on



Bombay House, Tata Group's global headquarters

the Tata Sons board, are understood to have met over the weekend to discuss the same matter on the performance of the group companies.

In FY25, Tata group's unlisted businesses posted a loss of Rs 10,905 crore, which is likely to go up to Rs 29,000 crore, according to reports.

It can be noted that the Tata group, which includes the Tata Trusts owning two-thirds of Tata Sons, the holding company of the group, has seen a lot of top-level friction lately, which has included expulsions or attempts to expel some members and also a deferment on a decision on Chandrasekaran's

continuation as the chairman of Tata Sons.

According to reports, Noel Tata is concerned about the mounting losses at Tata Sons, particularly from new businesses started under the helm of Chandrasekaran, such as Tata Digital and the electronics ventures, and also the financially struggling carrier Air India, which was bought from the government a few years ago.

Noel Tata is also reluctant to take Tata Sons public through an IPO. At present, Tata Sons, a core investment company, has been classified as among the top-15 non-bank finance companies (NBFCs) by the RBI, which are mandated to list.

Neville Tata, the son of Noel Tata, has already been inducted into a few of the trusts or foundations linked to the group.

Suryakumar Yadav's 'T60 Life' tweet sets social media abuzz, fans guess his next steps

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

India's successful 2026 T20 captain and explosive batting sensation, 'Mr 360' Suryakumar Yadav, has set social media buzzing after posting a cryptic tweet that has left fans intrigued and the internet flooded with speculation.

The star cricketer, who led India to victory in this year's T20 World Cup, surprised fans at the end of the IPL season with a message hinting at something 'big' on the horizon. In his tweet, Suryakumar Yadav wrote, "Hey Guys, I'm stepping into something bigger. A new chapter. At a different pace. It's called the #T60 Life. Stay Tuned!"

The post instantly went viral, triggering intense curiosity among cricket fans and followers across social media plat-



forms. With discussions already underway about whether Suryakumar Yadav will once again be entrusted with India's T20 captaincy for the upcoming

series, the timing of this mysterious tweet has only added fuel to the speculation. Fans are now wondering what direction the iconic batter is headed toward and what exactly 'T60 Life' signifies.

Suryakumar Yadav's fans have poured in rapidly, with many asking questions such as, "Where is Suryakumar heading?", "What major decision is he about to announce?", and "What's really going on in his mind?" The tweet has become one of the hottest talking points online, with thousands of reactions and discussions erupting within a short span of time.

Throughout the day, 'T60 Life' remained a trending topic among cricket enthusiasts, as anticipation continued to build around what message Suryakumar Yadav may reveal next.



BRIEFLY

Shiv Neel leads field as India join IAME karting movement



Shiv Neel, son of India's first F1 driver Narain Karthikeyan, will be the one to watch out for as the globally renowned IAME karting movement reaches the country in the guise of IAME Series India. The opening round of the five-round series, promoted by RA Motorsports, will take place at the CoASTT circuit here on May 31, featuring 34 entries.

The IAME, which stands for Italian American Motor Engineering, will give India's promising talents access to international-standard platforms such as Mini U10, Mini (X30 Water Swift 60cc Engine), Junior (125cc Junior X30 Engine), and Senior (125cc Senior X30 Engine).

Other than Neel, promising Rehan Khan Rasheed and Aaruthran Prabu (Asia-Pacific championship Gold Medalist) will also be part of the event.

The top two finishers in each category at the end of the Series will earn the opportunity to represent India at the prestigious IAME Asia Finals, scheduled to be held at the historic Macau International Circuit in December. (PTI)

Former Indian Archer Shyam Lal Meena dies



Former Indian archer Shyam Lal Meena, who represented the country at the 1988 Seoul Olympics, died after a prolonged illness. He was 61. Meena breathed his last on Sunday night at a hospital.

"Remembering Olympian and Arjuna Awardee Late Shri Shyam Lal Meena, who represented India at the 1988 Seoul Olympics," the Archery Association of India posted on X alongside a photograph of the former archer.

"His legacy in Indian archery will always be honoured."

Born in Kevadia village in Rajasthan's Banswara district, Meena was part of the Indian men's recurve team alongside Limba Ram and Rajat Haldar that won a bronze medal at the 1987 Asian Archery Championships in Kolkata.

That podium finish helped India qualify for the 1988 Seoul Olympics, marking the country's archery debut at the Summer Games.

Meena was conferred the Arjuna Award in 1989 for his contribution to the sport. (PTI)



Sindhu advances, Satwik-Chirag too win at Singapore Open

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Singapore

Star Indian shuttler PV Sindhu advanced to the second round of the women's singles competition with an impressive straight-game win over fifth seed Putri Kusuma Wardani at the Singapore Open on Tuesday.

The 30-year-old two-time Olympic medallist produced a composed performance to outwit the World Number 6 Indonesian 21-17 21-18 in the opening round of the \$10,00,000 Super 750 tournament. The former world champion will next face Japan's Riko Gunji.

Asian Games gold medallists Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty also progressed after battling past world Number 25 Malaysia's Chen Zhi Yi and Presley Smith 26-28 21-15 21-13 in the men's doubles opening round.

The world Number 4 Indian pair will take on



either Chinese Taipei's Lee Jhe-Huei and Yang Po-Hsuan or China's Liu Yang and Huang Di in the next round.

However, rising Indian shuttler Ayush Shetty, a finalist at Asia Championships, bowed out after going down 21-11 14-21 12-21 to world championships bronze medallist

Viktor Axelsen in a 65-minute men's singles clash.

Young Unnati Hooda, who has won three Super 100 titles in last four years, too suffered an early exit, losing 14-21 10-21 to former world junior champion and eighth seed Tomoka Miyazaki in women's singles. In women's doubles,

India's Kavipriya Selvam and Simran Singh went down 21-18 13-21 5-21 to Spain's Paula Lopez and Lucia Rodriguez to bow out in 48 minutes, while Ashwini Bhat K and Shikha Gautam lost 16-21 11-21 to Chinese Taipei's Chang Ching Hui and Yang Ching Tun.

Japan's seventh-seeded pair of Takuro Hoki and Yugo Kobayashi got the better of India's Hariharan Amsakarunan and MR Arjun 21-15 21-13 in another men's doubles match, while mixed doubles pair of Rohan Kapoor and Ruthvika Shivani Gadde lost 18-21 20-22 to Chinese Taipei's Yang Po Han and Hu Ling Fang in another first round clash.

Sindhu vs Wardani

It was a morale-boosting win for Sindhu, who had lost to the Indonesian twice last year at the World Championships and the Sudirman Cup.

Yogasana to be pushed for future Olympic Games, says Mandaviya

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ New Delhi

Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya on Tuesday said Yogasana would be pushed for inclusion in the future Olympic Games roster keeping in mind India's bid to host the 2036 Games as the sport geared up to make a statement with its maiden World Championship in Ahmedabad from June 4 to 8.

The World Championship will feature 529 athletes from over 60 countries with 114 of them being Indian yogasana practitioners. The Indian squad was picked after trials and is currently undergoing a training camp in Ahmedabad's Veer Savarkar Sports Complex.

"Yogasana will be among the traditional sports in the 2030 Commonwealth Games in Ahmedabad...We are bidding to host the Olympic Games in 2036 and when that happens, our sport should be there on the roster. Efforts are being made by both the government of India and the national federation (Yogasana Bharat) to ensure that Yoga becomes an Olympic sport by that time," Mandaviya said at an event to



launch the World Yogasana Championship.

"Procedure is to have 75 countries as your signatories to become an international federation, after which a plea to the International Olympic Committee can be made for a sport's inclusion in the Olympics," he added. World Yogasana vice President Udit Sheth echoed the view.

"Our vision is to have it as a demonstration sport in the 2032 Olympics and then make it a medal event in 2036 irrespective of whether the Games happen in Ahmedabad or anywhere

else," he asserted. At the upcoming world championship, 529 athletes have registered for the championship that will feature 12 events for six age groups starting from as young as 10 and then going up to 55 for both men and women. Pakistan, Bangladesh and Afghanistan would be missing from the Asian region.

World Yogasana Secretary General Jaideep Arya said the participation numbers could have been higher but a few other countries had to withdraw because of the ongoing military conflict in

the Gulf region. "Three-four countries had to withdraw because of the war but overall participation is quite good. Nepal and Sri Lanka have the biggest contingent after India but we have participation from countries like the Netherlands, Oman, Japan, Kenya and Mauritius," Arya told reporters.

"Yoga is a wellness technique but yogasana is physical posture that can be judged. We have divided the competition into artistic and rhythmic and points system to be implemented by nine judges around the field of play.

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ New Delhi

The Sports Ministry on Tuesday notified the rules of operation for the soon-to-be-formed National Sports Tribunal (NST) and the National Sports Board (NSB), stating that a dedicated portal would be set up for submission of disputes and maintenance of legal records.

In separate notifications addressing the roles of the two bodies, which will be formed under the National Sports Governance Act passed last year, the Sports Ministry reiterated that a search-cum-selection committee is in the process of being formed under the cabinet secretary.

The National Sports Board that will function as the central authority for granting recognition to National Sports Bodies and ensuring compliance with governance, financial and ethical standards will comprise a Chairperson and two members. It will have a three-year term.

The Tribunal's strength has not been specified by the government. The rules



for NST, however, have incorporated the provisions for techno-legal measures to ensure "digital implementation".

"(These include) notification of a dedicated portal by the Central Government for submission of disputes, notices, responses, documents and clarifications, as well as communication from the Tribunal, publication of orders, virtual hearings and maintenance of records related to proceedings and orders," the ministry stated.

The Tribunal will serve as a dedicated adjudicatory body for sports-related disputes in the country.

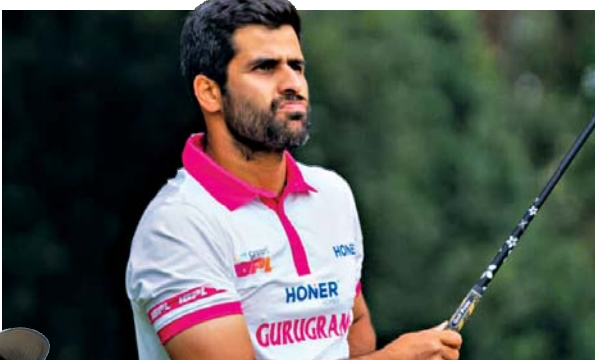
All eyes on Gill, Kochhar as IGPL Tour heads to Morocco

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ El Jadida (Morocco)

In-form golfers Pukhraj Singh Gill and Karandeep Kochhar will spearhead a strong Indian challenge when the IGPL Tour makes its North African debut at the inaugural Morocco Rising Stars beginning on Thursday.

The tournament opens a three-week golfing swing in Morocco, with the AM Green IGPL Bharath Classic scheduled from June 4 to 7 at the same venue, before the \$2 million International Series Morocco from June 11 to 14.

The \$160,000 event is co-sanctioned by the AM Green



IGPL and the ADT. Three of the four winners from the IGPL Tour and each of the four winners on the ADT this season, are in the field, making

it an extremely strong field. Nine of the Top-10 in the ADT Order of Merit have confirmed participation.

The field will be led by Gill, winner of the 2025 AM Green IGPL Order of Merit, who also won the last event on the ADT in Malaysia. Joining him in the field is Kochhar, who like Gill shuffles between the ADT and

the Asian Tour. Kochhar won the ADT event in Egypt last year.

India's Sachin Baisoya, IGPL's number one ranked player, is being joined by a star-studded field that includes his countrymen Veer Ganapathy and Aman Raj, ranked third and fifth respectively. Pukhraj Gill, last year's Number 1, is in sixth position.

The 18-hole world-class course, the Mazagan Beach & Golf Resort, in El Jadida City, on the Atlantic coast of Morocco, was designed by nine-time Major champion, Gary Player.

Other top Indian stars in the field will be Shaurya Bhattacharya, two-time Asian Tour winner, Rashid Khan, Shubham Jaglan, Kartik Singh and a former Asian Tour winner, Khalin Joshi.

Gukesh, Praggnanandhaa earn hard-fought Armageddon wins in Norway Chess

AJAI MASAND ■ Oslo

D Gukesh emerged victorious after a bruising, nerve-jangling marathon battle against Vincent Keymer, and R Praggnanandhaa outplayed Alireza Firouzja but world No. 1 Magnus Carlsen suffered a rare opening-round defeat at Norway Chess, which began amid towering bookshelves at the historic Deichman Bjorvika public library.

Thanks to his Armageddon triumph after a draining 144-move slugfest that lasted nearly five hours, Gukesh pocketed 1.5 points, while Keymer settled for one after the classical game had ended in a stalemate.

The marathon encounter saw the Indian world champion visibly rattled in the



closing stages, even seeking clarification from the arbiter over the move count as the game drifted towards an inevitable draw despite Keymer being a pawn up.

The German, however, remained ice-cool through-

out the classical battle, continuing to press on before eventually losing the Armageddon decider. But the tie-break itself ended swiftly, with Gukesh unleashing the decisive 15.Bh6, a move that sealed Keymer's fate.

Praggnanandhaa and American Grandmaster Wesley So produced a hard-fought classical draw in a finely balanced contest before the Indian Number 2 prevailed in the Armageddon tie-break with a sharp attacking display to pocket the extra point.

However, the biggest talking point of the day was defending champion Carlsen suffering a rare defeat in classical chess to Firouzja, who claimed all three points.

The Frenchman, confined to a wheelchair after recently injuring his ankle at the Superbet Chess Classic Romania and with his foot firmly strapped in a protective "moon shoe", showed remarkable grit and composure to stun home favourite and Carlsen on his own turf. (PTI)

Indian archers Jyothi and Dhiraj: Want to use World Cups to fine-tune equipment before ASIAD

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

Indian archers Jyothi Surekha Vennam and Dhiraj Bommadevara plan to use the upcoming Archery World Cup stages as testing grounds for equipment changes ahead of the all-important Asian Games later this year.

Both archers are part of the 12-member Indian squad for the Asian Games, scheduled to begin in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan from September 19.

"I have some things to figure. I want to try some new things with the equipment and World Cup would be a good place to see if things are moving in the right direction," Jyothi said in an online media interaction facilitated by Sports Authority of India.

"The arrows that I used to use their production has stopped and we have switched to other arrows. I had been using those arrows since 2017. So it was



easy and I knew what to do, how much to cut etc.

"But now with the new arrows I want to experiment and see what suits me, what length, closer groove etc. And since we have time before the Asian Games I can check all this at the World Cup," added Jyothi, who will be compet-

ing in her fourth Asian Games. The experimentation will take place during Stages 3 and 4 of the Archery World Cup in Antalya (June 9-14) and Madrid (July 7-12).

Dhiraj, meanwhile, said he too is in the process of tweaking his equipment, particularly his bow settings. "I have to change my bow settings



because every 3 months we need to change the limbs to get best outcome. We have been able to change it but doing that consistently is not great.

"Last December they have introduced new models. We were not able to try before as we didn't have time but now we have time to experiment at the

World Cups," he said. The Sports Ministry and the Sports Authority of India sanctioned a foreign training camp in Mexico from March 26 to April 5 under NTPC CSR support ahead of Archery World Cup Stage 1 at a total cost of ₹57.42 lakh.

The exposure camp featured several top Indian archers, including Jyothi, Dhiraj, Deepika Kumari and Atanu Das, who got access to advanced technology for the first time.

"We were there for a week ahead of the World Cup. There was new technology of spine to check arrows that archers from across the world were using. We got to use it for the first time," said Jyothi.

"There was also an indoor bunker where we could analyse our performance. It was a great experience working there as a team ahead of the World Cup.

India, however, will be without

seasoned campaigners Deepika and Atanu at the Asian Games after the duo failed to qualify through the selection trials held in Sonapat earlier this month.

"Yes they are not in team but they have been the team for so long and they always kept on sharing their experience in the camp, taught us a lot of things. What hurdles there might be.

"That sharing (of experience and info) will help us. We have time so we will make most of it," said Dhiraj.

Both Jyothi and Dhiraj are part of the Target Olympic Podium Scheme (TOPS) core group and have received close to ₹24.56 lakh and ₹66.28 lakh respectively so far in support.

Jyothi was also provided financial assistance towards a personalised Foreign Training Camp from July 20 to August 5 last year at Beiter Archery Centre, Germany.

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi and the brilliance of youth



SHAKYA MITRA

Across the world of sports, there have been several prodigies who have taken the stage by storm upon their arrival that it feels almost unreal. From the time Rajasthan Royals picked him during the Indian Premier League mega auction in November 2024 when he was still 13 for ₹1.1 crore, there was wide interest in Vaibhav Sooryavanshi. When Sooryavanshi first debuted in the 2025 season, it didn't go unnoticed, among his various exploits was a century against one of the league's best bowling attacks in Gujarat Titans. However it is his performance in 2026 which proves he is no one-tournament wonder and can be there for the long haul. 583 runs in 14 games in the league phase, at an incredible strike rate of 232 with 53 sixes, only six short of the IPL all-time record.

It is not that Sooryavanshi has made these runs against any other bowler. Genuine world-class bowlers like Jasprit Bumrah and Kagiso Rabada have been treated with disdain, with Sooryavanshi exuding a confidence unusual for someone who is just 15. What stands out about Sooryavanshi is that this isn't

about 2-3 games but a consistency that has been shown through the season. Is the question worth asking if the promise Sooryavanshi has shown as a 14-15 year old putting him on the same track as some of the greatest of all-time?

Sooryavanshi showing that he is no greenhorn against the highest quality of bowlers brings back the story of the great Sir Don Bradman. Indian audiences would be familiar with the Australian mini-series Bodyline which used to be occasionally broadcast in the 1990s. Based on information which is also publically available, Bradman as a young boy was shown competing and even doing better than opponents much older than him. Bradman was so good in the initial stages of his career, that the English team specifically designed the Bodyline strategy in the 1932-33 Ashes of a packed leg-side field and intimidating short-pitched bowling to curb his superiority even though the target was the whole

Australian team.

In our own country, how can we forget Sachin Tendulkar. Debuting at 16 in 1989, Tendulkar faced the fearsome Pakistan quicks like Imran Khan, Wasim Akram and Waqar Younis. By 18, he was scoring centuries on Australia's fast bouncy pitches including a brilliant hundred

at Perth widely known as the world's fastest pitch. Tendulkar's exceptional international career that lasted 24 years is a benchmark for early promise translating into sustained excellence.

At his age, Sooryavanshi is one of the finest talents to have ever emerged. The bright lights, constant spotlight and scrutiny, and facing top-class international bowlers in the IPL is no easy proving ground. Yet Sooryavanshi has shown not just competence and dominance, but also seems relatively unflustered while

taking them on. There is though a lot more that needs to be done for Sooryavanshi to translate this initial burst into a successful career. Red ball cricket remains a tougher challenge for all cricketers, Sooryavanshi's numbers in first-class cricket don't match up to his exceptional T20 numbers, an average of 17 in 8 matches. Sporting history reminds us that prodigious talent is a global phenomenon. Pele was 17 when he scored six goals to help Brazil win its first World Cup in 1958. Monica Seles dominated tennis as a teenager, winning eight Grand Slam titles by 19, till her tragic stabbing in April 1993 brought a halt to her winning momentum. These are two examples when age did not prove to be a bar when it comes to reaching the pinnacle of sporting excellence.

The older and more experienced Sooryavanshi gets, the smarter he will need to become because teams will undoubtedly come up with plans to contain him. Playing in different countries, surfaces and formats as and when he graduates towards becoming an international cricketer will test Sooryavanshi. Even within the IPL he will need to possess a level head as the lucre of money will grow as early as the 2028 season after the next mega auction. He will be one of the most sought after players and whether

THE QUESTION WORTH ASKING IS IF THE PROMISE SOORYAVANSHI HAS SHOWN AS A 14-15-YEAR-OLD PUTTING HIM ON THE SAME TRACK AS SOME OF THE GREATEST OF ALL TIME?

his current franchise retains him or he goes into the mega auction, a big payday is expected.

At 15, Sooryavanshi is already extraordinary. While predicting the arc of his career would be premature, the early signs are nothing short of electrifying. Fans, selectors, and cricketing purists can watch in anticipation as a young talent navigates the beginning of what could be a very successful journey.

Sooryavanshi's talent is extraordinary but sustaining it will be the challenge. That's what distinguished Bradman and Tendulkar from many others who showcased remarkable potential when young. At 15 there is plenty of time for Sooryavanshi to get better, whether it is improving his first-class numbers or reaching the national team.

Patidar leads RCB to second successive IPL final

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Dharamsala

Defending champions Royal Challengers Bengaluru marched into a second successive IPL final with a 92-run demolition of Gujarat Titans in Qualifier 1 here on Tuesday, powered by skipper Rajat Patidar's blistering unbeaten 93 off 33 balls and a ruthless pace assault that ripped apart their opponents' top-order inside the power-play.

Put into bat, RCB piled up a daunting 254 for five, with Patidar producing one of the most destructive knocks of the season, peppering the boundaries with effortless ease after being handed reprieves early in his innings.

The RCB captain tore into the GT attack in the death overs, ensuring his side crossed the 250-run mark in emphatic fashion. Patidar turned the game on its head, smashing nine sixes and five



fours after surviving two dropped chances, as RCB plundered 86 runs in the last five overs to seize complete control of the contest. In fact, they got 114 runs off last six overs.

Chasing a mammoth



target, Gujarat Titans desperately needed a flying start but their hopes were dented inside the powerplay as both in-form openers departed cheaply.

Sai Sudharsan's dismissal turned out to be a bizarre

one as his bat slipped out of his hands while attempting a shot off Jacob Duffy (3/39) and crashed into the stumps, leaving the batter stunned on 14.

GT suffered a bigger setback soon after when

skipper Shubman Gill was cleaned up by the red-hot Bhuvneshwar Kumar for just two, the seasoned seamer once again showcasing his mastery with the new ball.

Bhuvneshwar (2/28) showed that he still is an asset for any team. He is now a Purple Cap holder with 26 scalps. The twin blows pushed Gujarat firmly on the back foot against a fired-up RCB attack.

Josh Hazlewood (1/39) then got into the act by casting Jos Buttler (29) while Rasikh Salam struck twice in the final powerplay over -- dismissing Nishant Sandhu (5) and Jason Holder (0) -- to leave the Titans gasping at 51 for five.

The battle of equals soon turned into a lop-sided affair as a desperate GT seemed to have buckled under score-board pressure.

Washington Sundar (8) and impact player Rahul Tewatia (68) had an unenviable task at hand. The

game had already been reduced to a formality in the face of the challenge GT faced.

Eventually, GT were bowled out for 162, sending RCB into their fifth final (2009, 2011, 2016, 2025, 2026).

GT, the 2022 champions, will have another shot at making the final on Friday when they take on the winner of the Eliminator between Rajasthan Royal and Sunrisers Hyderabad.

Earlier, the RCB innings began at a furious pace with Venkatesh Iyer (19) taking on Mohammed Siraj with audacious strokeplay, including three early boundaries, before Kagiso Rabada dismissed him for 19 soon after being hit for a six.

During his lively spell, Rabada also tested Virat Kohli with sharp bounce and pace in an engaging duel, but the RCB talisman weathered the challenge to score a brisk 43.

Shahidi to lead Afghanistan in Test, ODI series against India

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

Left-handed batter Hashmatullah Shahidi was on Tuesday named captain of the Afghanistan squad which will play a one-off Test and three ODIs against India from June 6 to June 20.

While the ODI squad features top players including Rashid Khan, Rahmanullah Gurbaz, and Ibrahim Zadran, the Test team comprises a blend of experienced campaigners and emerging talent, with Rahmat Shah, Rahmanullah Gurbaz and Azmatullah Omarzai forming the core of the batting group.

Wicketkeepers Afsar Zazai and Ikram Alikhil have also been included, while the spin department will rely on Sharafudin Ashraf and Qais Ahmad. Bilal Sami, Zia Sharifi and Saleem Safi will spearhead the pace department. Interestingly, Afghanistan have opted for a slightly different combination in the ODI setup, bringing back seasoned stars Mohammad Nabi and Rashid Khan for the white-ball leg of the tour.

Young opener Ibrahim Zadran, Sediqullah Atal and Darwish Rasooli bolster the batting unit, while AM Ghazanfar and Bilal Sami add depth to the bowling attack.

Young spinner Ghazanfar was reward-



ed for his exploits in the IPL. He snapped 15 wickets in 11 games for Mumbai Indians. Afghanistan will start their tour with a one-off Test from June 6 to 10 at New Chandigarh before embarking on a three-match ODI series. The first ODI will be held on June 14 at Dharamsala, followed by the second game on June 17 at Lucknow and the third ODI on June 20 in Chennai.

Squad for one-off Test: Hashmatullah Shahidi (C), Abdul Malik, Sediqullah Atal, Rahmat Shah, Rahmanullah Gurbaz, Rahmanullah Zadran, Afsar Zazai (WK), Ikram Alikhil (WK), Azmatullah Omarzai, Sharafudin Ashraf, Nangyal Kharotai, Qais Ahmad, Bilal Sami, Zia Sharifi, Saleem Safi.

Kumar Mohit, Chandermohan strike gold in Vietnam

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Da Nang (Vietnam)

Indian freestyle wrestlers maintained their solid form at the U23 Asian Championships on Tuesday, adding four more medals to the country's tally on day four of the competition.

Kumar Mohit and Chandermohan led the charge by winning gold medals in their respective weight classes, while Deepak took silver medal in the 61kg division and another Indian grappler, also named Deepak, claimed a bronze in the 74kg category.

These finishes take India's freestyle medal count to six, building on the success from the previous day where Akshay T Dhere (57kg) and Vicky (97kg) both secured gold medals.

Mohit was in complete control during his 65kg gold medal bout, recording a comfortable 12-4 victory over Kyrgyzstan's Oskonbai A. Abdissamatov to finish on top



of the podium. Later in the session, Chandermohan pulled off a thrilling 7-6 win against Kazakhstan's Yerkan Abil to secure the 79kg title.

In the 61kg final, Deepak played out a closely contested 4-4 bout against Kazakhstan's Nurdanat Aitanov but eventually had to settle for the silver medal.

Meanwhile, India secured a bronze in the 74kg category as Deepak outclassed

Turkmenistan's Vatan Annairazov with a dominant 10-0 win.

"The freestyle squad has shown great consistency over the last two days. Winning four golds, two silvers and two bronze medals in freestyle so far is a very positive sign for us. Mohit and Chandermohan wrestled beautifully today to win their titles, and both Deepaks gave it their all on the mat.

Haroon Rasheed blames admin for Pak's decline



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Karachi

Former Pakistan Test batter and ex-head coach Haroon Rasheed believes the widening gulf between Indian and Pakistan cricket is rooted not in talent, but in structure, planning and long-term investment at the grassroots level.

Drawing a sharp contrast between the two systems, Haroon said India are now reaping the rewards of a robust domestic and age-group pipeline, while Pakistan continue to suffer from inconsistency, administrative instability and neglect of club cricket.

Speaking on hamaraivb.com, Haroon said India's depth of talent - especially in T20 cricket - has become so vast that selectors may soon struggle to settle on their strongest playing XI across formats. In contrast, Haroon lamented the decline of Pakistan's domestic structure, saying the lack of continuity in policies, captaincy, coaching and selection has severely hurt the national team.

"The recent Test defeats to Bangladesh and even before that in white ball cricket our performances tell the whole story of our cricket," he said.

Haroon, who worked in the Pakistan Cricket Board in different capacities, including as chief selector, coach of the senior and junior national teams and also headed the cricket academy, said that India right now was reaping the benefits of their investment and consistency. "Right now India has so

much talent to pick from, particularly in T20 cricket. The reason is all their players are coming through a proper system from various age groups."

Haroon said one of the main problems affecting Pakistan cricket was the absence of consistency, planning and continuity in major decisions.

"I don't think changing the board chairman so frequently has helped at all. I worked under at least six different chairmen at my time in the board and when a new chairman comes in, it means he brings in his own people, policies and mindset," Haroon said.

He pointed out that most of the PCB chiefs didn't have cricket backgrounds so they relied heavily on advice from others.

"In Pakistan there is a dire need to change the domestic structure which has survived competition between association and departmental cricket and come up with a new concept or we will be left behind. Even Bangladesh has now shown how they have improved."

The former Test batter also noted that the board never showed confidence in their captains.

"When you decide to appoint a captain in any format it would have been done with much thought process so how can you keep on changing captains, how will this allow the Pakistan team to be consistent and stable," he questioned.

Hungrier to go one step further: Captain Laura Wolvaardt eyes T20WC crown

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ London

Captain Laura Wolvaardt said successive near-misses have intensified South Africa's desire to clinch an ICC title, adding that the recent series win over India has significantly boosted the team's confidence ahead of the women's T20 World Cup.

South Africa head into the tournament as one of the favourites after reaching back-to-back T20 World Cup finals in 2023 and 2024. They also finished runners-up at last year's ODI World Cup, leaving

the Proteas eager to finally cross the final hurdle.

"Reaching back-to-back T20 World Cup finals has obviously been very special for us as a team, but I think it's also made us even hungrier to go one step further," Wolvaardt wrote in her column for the ICC.

In the run up to the World Cup, scheduled to begin in England and Wales on June 12, South Africa defeated India 4-1 in the five-match T20I series in April.

"The India series was another good test against one of the



strongest teams in the world. Winning that series gave the group a lot of confidence, but more

importantly, it showed the ability and resilience within the squad. Players stepped up at different



times and that's something you need at a World Cup," she added. South Africa have enjoyed an

impressive run in the T20 format this year, having beaten New Zealand 4-1 and Pakistan 2-1 before overcoming India.

"The preparation has been really good so far. We've had a lengthy run of cricket leading into the World Cup, especially with the tours against New Zealand and India, and I think those series gave us a great opportunity to test ourselves in different situations.

"The New Zealand tour challenged us in various ways, whether it was the conditions, our

execution or the opposition," she said. The SA skipper said those tours have given the team the confidence ahead of the ICC marquee event. "I think those tours also reinforced that we're moving in the right direction as a team. We've been super focused on being consistent over the last year and there's a strong belief within the group about what we're capable of achieving."

South Africa are clubbed alongside India, Australia, Pakistan, Bangladesh and the Netherlands in Group 1.